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Happening today

- **LEADING 2-1,** India will face the West Indies in the fourth of the five-match T20I series.

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LADAKH AN INTEGRAL PART OF INDIA: DELHI REJECTS BEIJING'S OBJECTION

KNIFE ATTACK BID ON MAMATA: TMC FILES POLICE COMPLAINT

THE BIG PICTURE

HOW THEY MOVED THE MONEY: INSIDE A SCAM RUN OUT OF GOA VILLAS PAGE 9

'QUESTION OF TRUST CONFRONTS WORLD AMID UNCERTAINTY'

India global growth partner, reform our conviction, not compulsion: PM

Flags tech, supply chains, energy, minerals as new tools of pressure and dominance

Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, October 13



Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum in New Delhi, Tuesday. PTI

POSITIONING INDIA as a "steady pillar" carrying everyone along in a world roiled by conflicts and uncertainty, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said Tuesday that the country's confidence is at an "unprecedented high" and reforms are being pursued with a clear policy direction born out of "conviction" and not "compulsion".

Speaking at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum 2026 in New Delhi, Modi said, "We do not grow at anyone's cost. We grow with the world, and for the world."

He said India offers the "assurance of reliability and stability" in a world filled with uncertainty. The country's growth, recorded at 7.8% in April-June, "rests on a strong foundation," he said.

His remarks came a day after the International Monetary Fund (IMF) raised its GDP growth forecast for India to 7% for 2026-27, up from 6.4% in July, on the back of "stronger-than-expected momentum, supported by resilient domestic demand and robust services activity". Last week, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) also raised its projection for India's GDP growth to 7.1%.

Modi said the world is confronted with the fundamental question of "trust" in these times, and that India is extending its hand in support and recognising its responsibility.

"Twelve to thirteen years ago, India's current account deficit was more than four per cent of GDP. Last year, it declined to approximately half a per cent, standing at 0.61 per cent. Today, our foreign exchange reserves exceed 700 billion dollars. Our banking

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPRESS special

States seek urgent funds to sustain women livelihood mission, no word on NULM 2.0 yet

TN CM writes to PM; Tripura, Karnataka, MP, Maharashtra too seek fund release

Damini Nath
New Delhi, October 13

AT LEAST five states cutting across party lines have written to the Centre warning that lack of clarity over financial support to the flagship urban livelihood mission, which has benefited more than one crore women over the last decade, will adversely impact social protection of the urban poor.

Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam-ruled Tamil Nadu, Congress-governed Karnataka and BJP-led Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh and Tripura have,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

e EXPLAINED

Mission covers nearly 1 cr women

NULM led to the creation of 10.02 lakh self-help groups, covering nearly 1 crore women across cities. The scheme provided the groups with a revolving fund of Rs 10,000 each, as well as training, interest subvention for bank loans and help in setting up micro enterprises.

INSIDE PAGE 4

CJP MEMBERS TAKE NARROW LANE, SCALE GATES TO ENTER JANTAR MANTAR

DELHI POLICE CITES INPUTS ON CJP PLAN, SEEKS CENTRAL FORCES UNTIL OCT 20



Nation is watching Rahul trying to save infiltrators and his vote bank, says Shah

If Opp had 'vote chori' evidence, why didn't it give it to SC, says Goyal

Vikas Pathak & Jatin Anand
New Delhi, October 13

IN FIRST remarks on the Opposition protests seeking the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and scrapping of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, Union Home Minister Amit Shah Tuesday accused Leader of Opposition and Congress MP Rahul Gandhi, who has been leading the protests, of shielding "infiltrators" for "vote bank politics".

"I want to tell Rahul Gandhi ji that the nation is well aware of your plan to save ghuspaithiyas (infiltrators) and now the people of Bharat are not going to fall for your ploy," he told reporters.



Home Minister Amit Shah in New Delhi, Tuesday. @AMITSHAH/X

He said the cleaning of electoral rolls was the responsibility of the Election Commission of India, and those opposing it were trying to save those they think are their "vote bank".

Also Tuesday, Union Minister Piyush Goyal targeted the INDIA bloc, saying if the Opposition had any evidence of "vote chori", why was it not producing it before the Supreme Court.

Shah said, "Our Constitution has given the ECI the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Be ready to mobilise, LoP to Opp parties as they plan to 'reclaim' Jantar Mantar site



INDIA bloc leaders at a press conference, Tuesday. ANIL SHARMA

Asad Rehman & Manoj C G
New Delhi, October 13

A DAY after petitioning the Supreme Court, the Opposition, seeking the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and the scrapping of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls, said Tuesday it would keep up its "resistance" in "the fight to restore democracy" irrespective of the role institutions play. The Opposition also plans to challenge the government's decision to cancel Jantar Mantar's status as a designated protest site.

Addressing the press after hosting Opposition leaders, student activists and civil society members for high tea at his residence, Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi said, "We have extreme respect for the Supreme Court, for the Chief Justice of India, for the judicial system. They have a role to play. We hope they will play that role. No matter what happens, no matter which

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

MoS Murugan resigns from Govt, Rajya Sabha, triggers reshuffle talk

Liz Mathew, Jatin Anand & Arun Janardhanan
New Delhi, Chennai, Oct 13



Union MoS L Murugan. MIB.GOV.IN

L MURUGAN, BJP MP and Minister of State for Information and Broadcasting and Parliamentary Affairs, resigned Tuesday from both the government and Rajya Sabha, triggering speculation of a possible reshuffle in the Union Council of Ministers.

Expressing the desire to work for the party in Tamil Nadu, a state where the BJP is still struggling to emerge as a

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



INSIDE PAGE 6

PUNJAB ANTI-DRUG ACTIVIST SHOT DEAD BY STORE OWNER

Why question paper, why not bank of questions: Task force chief Nilekani

Dheeraj Mishra & Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, October 13



Infosys co-founder Nandan Nilekani on Tuesday. @INFOSYS/X

HEADING THE high-powered task force on examination reforms, constituted in the wake of the NEET-UG paper leak row, Infosys co-founder Nandan Nilekani said Tuesday that one of the solutions is to create a bank of question papers and generate the question paper at the last minute for that day.

"Why do we need to have something called "a" question paper? Because the moment you have "a" question paper, then that creates an economic incentive for that to be sold or whatever. So the way to do that is to have a massive bank of question papers, and only at the last minute generate the question paper for that day. Then the question paper does not go away and there is no economic incentive for that," Nilekani said during an interaction at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum 2026 in New Delhi.

The six-member high-powered task force was

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

•MALLOJULA VENUGOPAL IS RELEARNING FOREST ACTS HE ONCE OPPOSED, TRAINS VILLAGERS

10-to-5 job, desk and a laptop: Once a feared Maoist, now university official

Ankita Deshkar
Nagpur, October 13



Mallojula Venugopal is a coordinator with Gondwana University's Ekal (Gramsabha) Project and Centre. ANKITA DESHKAR

HIS SPECTACLES broke on the way to work. Sitting in his small cabin at Gondwana University, Mallojula Venugopal chuckles as he reaches for them: "Now I will have to get a new pair made."

As the 70-year-old fusses over the glasses and his laptop, sitting behind a desk bare except for some newspapers, his crisp shirt firmly tucked in, his dark hair combed down, the difference from his previous life couldn't be starker.

It was almost exactly a year ago, on October 15, 2025, that Venugopal — a.k.a Sonu or Bhupathi, carrying a bounty of Rs 6 crore on his head — left the Maoist top ranks and walked out of the jungle to surrender. The Maharashtra Chief Minister was present for his surrender, and that of 60 other cadres with their weapons.

Venugopal is now a coordinator with Gondwana University's Ekal (Gramsabha) Project and Centre. The university has 60,000 students across its campus and affiliated colleges, and the Ekal Centre works in coordination with the district administration as an outreach to gram sabhas.

Two men with the Gadchiroli police posted outside Venugopal's cabin are the only hint of his past.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Modi

system is in its strongest position in many decades. It is because of this strength that India's sovereign ratings are being upgraded. Today, India's confidence is at an unprecedented high. We are pursuing reforms with a clear policy direction," he said.

Listing reforms such as GST, Insolvency Law, consolidation of 29 labour laws into four labour codes, decriminalisation of hundreds of minor business-related offences, he said India's Reform Express continues to move ahead at high speed. "For us, reforms are not a compulsion. Reforms are our conviction."

Underlining the unprecedented global challenges, he spoke on the importance of maintaining trust amid disruptions in trade and supply chains, saying "things that once connected the world are now being turned into weapons".

"Supply chains, energy, minerals, payment systems, and technology are increasingly becoming instruments of pressure and dominance. The routes created by globalisation over past decades have, in many cases, become chokepoints. Amid all this, Artificial Intelligence is transforming the way every sector functions. At the same time, many countries are facing rapidly growing challenges related to ageing populations. In such circumstances, the world is confronted with a fundamental question: Trust."

The question of trust, he said, relates to whether supplies will continue during times of need or whether promises made will also be fulfilled.

"Trust — that a partner country will stand by you during moments of crisis. And it is here that India stands before you with a different outlook and a different way of thinking," he said.

Citing examples of affordable medicines, generic medicines, solutions for digital identity and payments, skilled youth, and more than 2,000 global capability centres providing services to companies across the world, Modi listed the ways in which the world looks towards India. "It is clear that whenever the world needs a steady pillar, India extends its hand in support, recognising its responsibility. We do not grow at anyone's cost. We grow with the world, and for the world," he said.

He said the philosophy of "power to empower" has been visible in India's global engagement. Mentioning the Covid pandemic, he said vaccine manufacturing capacity became extremely important and the question at that time was whether the benefits of this capability would remain limited to only a few countries, or whether vaccines would also reach those nations and people who lacked such facilities and capabilities.

"India chose the path of empowering humanity. We supplied vaccines to more than one hundred countries. Our manufacturing capability became a source of assistance for other nations as well," he said.

"... The government possesses authority, but its purpose should not be to make citizens dependent on the system. Rather, its objective should be to ensure that citizens become capable and empowered. India is moving along this very path. Following this path, India has lifted 250 million people out of poverty over the past decade, a number greater than the population of many countries in the world."

Shah

responsibility to keep elections free and fair. Free and fair elections are possible only when we keep our voter list as per the definition of who is a voter."

"Our Representation of the People Act defines who is a voter. The first condition for being a voter is to be a citizen of India. If you are against this, bring a proposal in Parliament that anyone can be a voter. And the second condition is the minimum age to vote. The SIR will have to ask the age of each person. It will also ask whether you are a citizen of India," he said.

"They (Opposition parties) also understand that this has to be asked, but they are opposing it because the votes that are cut because of this are those of the ones they consider their vote bank... If the EC does not purify the voter list, will political parties do so? And if you still have an objection to any procedure of the ECI, you can go to court," he said.

Shah said taking out rallies against the SIR was a violation of constitutional propriety. "The SIR is happening under the monitoring of Supreme Court, still you are not accepting it," he said, adding that "in many places, 30 per cent, 20 per cent, 15 per cent, 11 per cent infiltrators were caught". Listing a string of Congress defeats in elections at different levels, he said the party had not been able to come to power in states like West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, Gujarat, UP and Bihar for decades, long before the start of the SIR.

Meanwhile, Goyal targeted Congress after the Supreme Court Registry flagged defects in the petition questioning the legitimacy of the SIR. He said the Congress "cannot even file a petition properly" — Congress leaders said the issues flagged were "procedural" and were being fixed. Goyal said, "If they really have some proof against the Election Commission, any evidence of vote chori, why did they not give it to the (Supreme) Court, to the EC?... They cannot even file a petition properly... despite giving so many Rajya Sabha seats to big lawyers."

"The petition they filed in the Supreme Court has 14 defects... so much so that they cannot even pay the court fee properly... I believe Congress itself is responsible for its failures," he said. Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh also accused Gandhi of "placing his family above everything else, discrediting constitutional institutions and staging an unprecedented protest before the SC to exert pressure".

Rahul

institution plays a role or not, political resistance will continue, people's resistance will continue and it will triumph."

At the meeting, the Opposition discussed its next steps. Gandhi told all present that their outfits should be "ready to mobilise" within 24 hours, if needed.

He said it was "not simple" to "destroy" the Constitution and get away with it, and reiterated that action would be taken against those involved in "vote chori". "It is our commitment that the people who have done this — Mr Modi, who is the main architect, Amit Shah, who is the implementer, Gyanesh Kumar and others — they need to understand that the net is closing around them... We assure you that all would be brought to justice," he said.

Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge and CPP chairperson Sonia Gandhi, RJD leaders Tejashwi Yadav and Manoj Jha, SP's Harender Malik, Anand Bhadauria and Mohibullah Nadvi, CPI(M) general secretary M A Baby, CPI general secretary D Raja and party MP P Sandosh Kumar, JMM MP Mahua Maji, AISA leader Neha Bora, CPI(ML) Liberation general secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya, Mamata AITC MPs Mahua Moitra and Sagarika Ghose, and Forward Bloc general secretary G Devarajan also attended the meeting.

Both Tejashwi Yadav and D Raja criticised the government's decision to cancel Jantar Mantar's status as a protest site. "The government's fear is evident in the denotification of Jantar Mantar as a protest site," Yadav said. Condemning the decision, Raja announced a fight to "reclaim" Jantar Mantar.

At the meeting, Opposition leaders agreed not to accept the decision to "de-notify Jantar Mantar as a protest site at any cost", it is learnt. All INDIA bloc events will include an attempt to march there, sources said. Earlier in the day, the CPI(M) alleged that the government removed Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site to "suppress dissent" and "weaken the right to hold peaceful demonstrations". NCP (SP) MP Supriya Sule said all democratic forces had "come together because the Constitution has been threatened". Sonia Gandhi, the sources said, told the leaders they should "keep the focus on people", and that "the people should not be inconvenienced". All present agreed to decide the next course of action after the SC hears their plea.

NULM

in separate letters, told Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) that a pause in funding will disrupt bank linkages and access to institutional credit.

In their letters, the states have sought the release of funds under the scheme, with Tamil Nadu demanding Rs 350 crore, Maharashtra Rs 81 crore, Madhya Pradesh Rs 101 crore and Tripura Rs 6.5 crore, among others.

The Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-National Urban Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NULM), ran from 2014 until October 2024, creating over 10 lakh women's self-help groups. After that, MoHUA carried out a pilot project, Deendayal Jan Aajeevika Yojana - Shehari (DJAY-S), until December 2025. This pilot was meant to pave the way for a new scheme, but sources said it was no longer under consideration.

With the new scheme in limbo, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay wrote to the Prime Minister on August 27 and noted that Chennai and Tiruppur were selected for the pilot from Tamil Nadu. "During the pilot period, around 1.26 lakh vulnerable occupational families have been identified and profiled and about 2,500 self help groups have been formed, creating a strong foundation for scaling up the programme. Further, the Ministry has advised all states to retain the existing Mission structure and workforce so as to ensure continuity of services and uninterrupted support to beneficiaries," he wrote.

Tamil Nadu has 1.72 lakh self-help groups with 18.70 lakh members under the National Urban Livelihood Mission. Vijay pointed out that NULM funds in the state had been completely exhausted as of April 2025.

"Promotion of the self-help group activities in urban areas is indispensable for realising the objectives of the Urban Livelihood Mission and ensuring sustainable livelihood opportunities, financial inclusion and social protection for the urban poor. The proposed assistance would also enable the states to sustain the existing urban livelihood ecosystem, protect and strengthen the community institutions already created, and ensure continuity of essential Mission personnel and services," Vijay wrote, seeking Rs 350 crore for 2026-27.

Tripura Chief Minister Manik Saha wrote to Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal on September 11 on the "critical financial situation affecting the implementation of the Tripura Urban Livelihoods Mission (TULM)". TULM had played an important role in the "socio-economic empowerment of the urban poor, particularly women" through self-help groups, area-level federations, community resource persons and bank sakhis, he said, adding no fresh funds had been received from MoHUA in the past two years.

"This financial constraint is seriously affecting the grassroots beneficiaries and the overall livelihood economy of Tripura. Lack of financial support to TULM may also disrupt bank linkage and access to institutional credit, resulting in the deterioration of the community-level institutional structure created over several years. Consequently, the benefits, outcomes, and progress already achieved through the Mission may be severely undermined," Saha said, requesting release of NULM funds.

In July, the Tripura government had written to MoHUA seeking Rs 6.50 crore in committed liabilities, saying that a total of 6,796 self help groups were formed in the state under NULM. These groups were working in mid-day meal services, canteen operations, school uniform stitching, municipal service delivery etc, it said.

Maharashtra's state mission wrote to MoHUA on September 29 seeking release of Rs 80.99 crore as Central share "so as to pay off previous dues and start new scheme afresh". It said the ministry had asked states to expand DJAY-S scheme and directed that the scheme be implemented from October 1, 2024, onwards on pilot basis. It said Maharashtra last received funds in March 2024 for NULM, which it had already exhausted. "As a result, we are facing an acute financial crunch. Staff remuneration, interest subvention and revolving funds liabilities are constantly piling up every month," the state mission wrote.

Madhya Pradesh too wrote to the MoHUA on September 7 seeking release of Rs 101 crore, particularly Rs 13.71 crore for interest subsidy under the self-employment programme of NULM. "The interest subsidy mechanism was linked to the bank loans and was intended to provide continuing relief to eligible beneficiaries during the applicable loan period... The closure/ non-extension of the scheme does not automatically extinguish the financial obligations relating to eligible interest subsidy accrued on loans sanctioned under the scheme. The beneficiaries continue to service their bank loans, and in several cases the loan tenure extends beyond the date of closure of DAY-NULM," the MP government wrote.

"Failure to settle these committed interest subsidy liabilities may adversely affect beneficiaries who had availed bank credit in good faith under a Government-supported livelihood programme," the state said.

Karnataka wrote on September 6 to MoHUA seeking clarity if the state can use the amount released for the pilot scheme, Rs 4.48 crore in case of Bengaluru, for "payment of staff salary". "... no funds are currently available to disburse salaries from July 2025 onwards...In view of the ongoing fund shortage impacting implementation at the field level, we seek guidance from the Ministry on utilizing the pilot implementation fund for payment of staff salary," Karnataka sought to know.

Though the scheme had ended and the pilot project started in 25 cities in 13 states, the Ministry had written to all states/UTs on December 4, 2024 saying that "in-principle approval" of the Department of Expenditure had been received to expand the pilot to all states and UTs. The remaining states were asked to prepare action plans for the smooth transition to the new scheme to be rolled out.

"Further, the existing administrative structure in the States/ UTs may be retained for ensuring continuity in beneficiary support and transition to new Mission. The cost of human resources must be must be met from own resources of ULBs and/or already approved...funds available with the state under schemes of MoHUA...Expenditure incurred on administrative structure and implementation by States/UTs during pilot/transition period from 1st October 2024 till approval of new Mission shall be proposed for recoupment under the new Mission," the letter said.

According to the MoHUA source, states were responsible for recruiting support staff for the functioning of the scheme, as per the operational guidelines under NULM. "Presently, various ongoing Missions such as PMSVANidhi and State government programmes have leveraged this existing staff," the source said.

When it comes to the self-help groups, the source said these groups were now being "leveraged by various ongoing missions of the government of India such as Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana, Swachh Bharat Mission, AMRUT, and PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana".

MoHUA sources said around Rs 9,000 crore was spent by the Centre and states in the 10-year NULM period. In the pilot scheme, 25 cities across 13 states were selected. "There is no pendency of any demand from any state. Due to various such government schemes, 24.82 crore Indians have escaped Multidimensional Poverty in last 9 years, as per NITI Aayog, 2024. Based on the learnings of the pilot initiative and emerging opportunities in urban sectors, new contours of a livelihood programme are being discussed and explored," the source said.

"Presently, over 1.5 lakh SHG women are engaged with Swachh Bharat Mission and 50,000 SHGs women as AMRUT Mitra. Some of the SHGs have been mapped with One District One Product and efforts are being taken to support them under the program through convergence. Similarly, around 38,000 SHGs have been supported under Pradhan Mantri Formalization of Micro Food Processing Enterprises scheme. Therefore, the Ministry is constantly working to involve SHGs in urban areas through various ongoing schemes," the source said.

Started in 2014 as the successor to the UPA-era Swarna Jayanti Shahari Rozgar Yojana, NULM led to the creation of 10.02 lakh self-help groups, covering about 1 crore women across cities. The scheme provided the groups with a revolving fund of Rs 10,000 each, as well as training and interest subvention for bank loans.

Nilekani

announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi a day after Dharmendra Pradhan resigned as Union Education Minister on July 25. The committee was given three months to submit its report.

While Nilekani did not disclose the content of the report, he said the PM is very keen on implementing their decision. He said the number of locations for computer-based testing should be increased.

"The other thing is to ensure how the exams are done on the basis of computer-based testing, and that requires a network of locations. We have 150,000 locations, where students take a test. That needs to be expanded. These are systemic issues, which we will address in our committee, and I think the Prime Minister is very keen to implement our suggestions," he said.

Nilekani said if the problem of paper leak is looked at systematically, going into the root cause, it is a solvable issue.

Asked if he imagined a scenario where AI spontaneously creates exam papers on the day of examination, he said, "Yeah, sure."

Ex-Maoist

He stumbled upon the job by chance, spotting a newspaper advertisement in May. The applicants needed to have cleared at least Class 12, possess knowledge of laws concerning tribal and rural areas, including PESA (Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act), the Community Forest Rights Act, MNREGS and Biodiversity Act, have experience with forest management and working with tribal and rural communities, and be willing to work in any taluka of Gadchiroli district.

Venugopal ticked all the boxes.

He admits the irony of tackling some of the same issues via legal means that the Maoists once rallied against, such as the PESA in parts and Forest Rights Act (FRA). The two laws are meant to give gram sabhas greater say in local governance as well as forest land and resources.

Venugopal says he now realises that the Maoist opposition to the Acts, uneven at times, was wrong, and claims that the CPI (Maoist) too had woken up to the resonance of land and forest rights issues among tribal communities. "If we had realised this earlier, people would have benefited," he says.

Sanjay Meena, who was Gadchiroli Collector when the Ekal Centre was conceived, says it was meant to bridge the trust and communication gap between gram sabhas and the district administration, and Gondwana University was brought on board to train gram sabha members in issues such as community forest rights, biodiversity registers and forest and water conservation.

Now Nagpur Metropolitan Region Development Authority Commissioner, Meena says: "The programme had four components: training gram sabhas, ensuring they had direct access to government schemes, promoting forest conservation, and enabling them to sell minor forest produce directly, without middlemen ... We signed MoUs with around 750 gram sabhas out of the 1,200 in Gadchiroli. It was a huge exercise."

Vice-Chancellor Prashant Bokare, who says they want the programme to continue, adds: "We formulated a special Board of Studies for the Ekal Centre, and it now has over 16 members." Since December 2022, they have trained approximately 3,500 people from around 600 gram sabhas, helped 232 complete forest management plans, and enabled more than 100 to secure community forest rights.

Gadchiroli SP M Ramesh says they wanted Venugopal to "settle". "Wherever surrendered cadres are found eligible, we help. Sonu was found eligible in the context of the university."

There has been some expected opposition to Venugopal's appointment. Datta Shirke of the Jan Sangharsha Samiti says, "They should rehabilitate him, but that does not mean giving him a high-ranking position... Police personnel and innocent tribals lost their lives in Maoist violence. Giving such a person a position is an insult to those affected."

Venugopal doesn't deny the charge, but urges that his present role be judged separately. "I am working with all my heart."

He expresses satisfaction with several aspects of Maharashtra's surrender and rehabilitation policy, including financial assistance. While he hopes arrested comrades are released by the government, he says he is above all grateful, never imagining that he would live in a house again, forget work at a university. He recalls that some had called him a "traitor" when he surrendered, before many others had followed him. "This one year has proved how right I was."

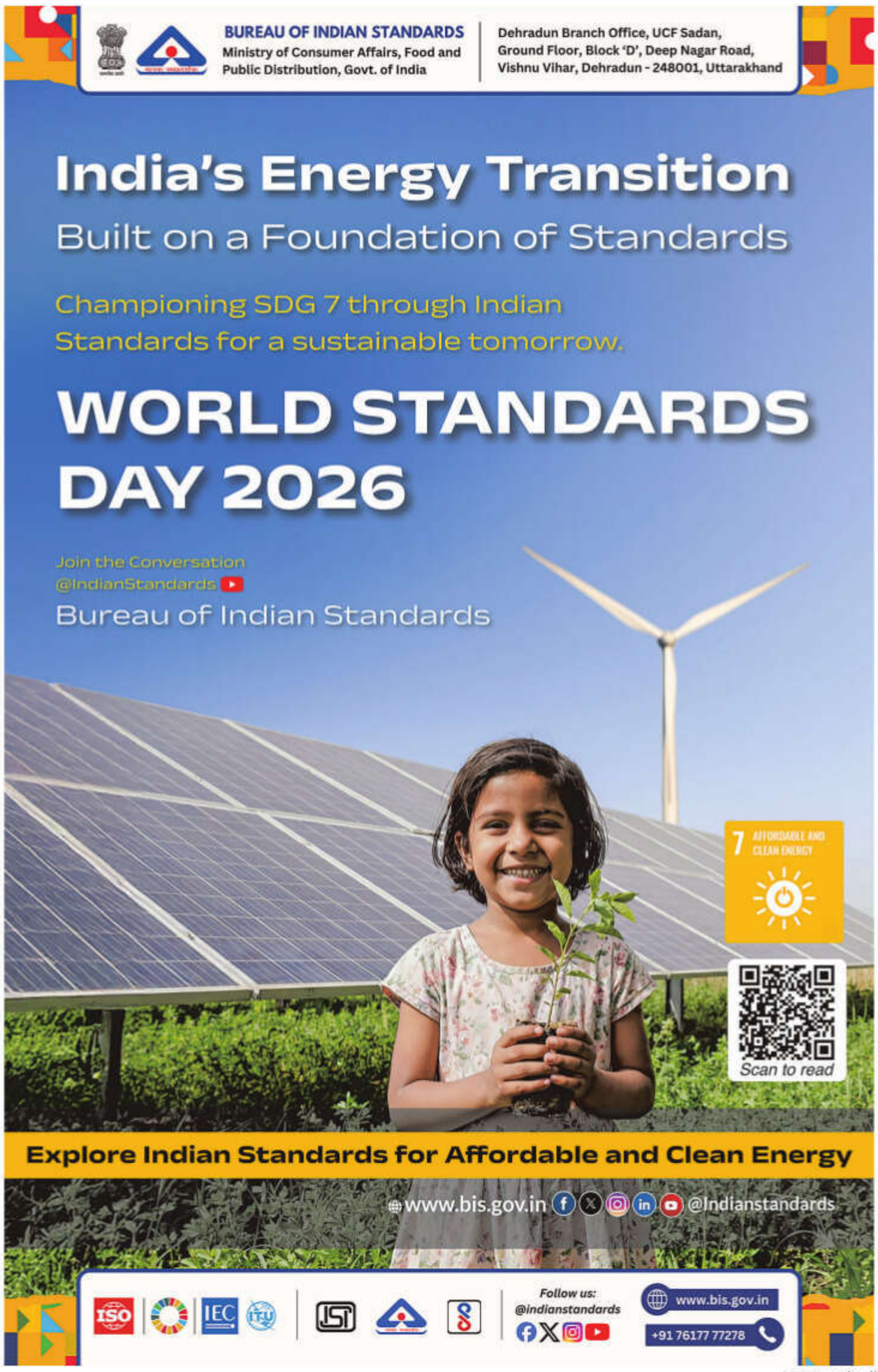
Murugan

formidable political force, Murugan said he would be dedicating himself "full time to strengthening the party" in the state. In a letter to PM Narendra Modi, Murugan said it was the "greatest honour" of his life to serve "Bharat Mata" and Tamil Nadu under his leadership.

"With humility and grateful heart, I therefore request you to relieve me of my responsibility as MoS and permit me to relinquish my membership of the Rajya Sabha, so that I may dedicate full time to strengthening the party in Tamil Nadu," he said. Murugan's resignation, which took even some in the BJP by surprise, reignited speculation about a possible reshuffle in the Council of Ministers in the coming days.

In the middle of his second tenure as RS MP, Murugan, who has been a member of the Upper House since September 2021, was elected in April 2024 with a tenure ending in April 2030.

In recent months, notable resignations have been that of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan in July after the NEET protests, Union Ministers George Kurian and Ravneet Singh Bittu after the BJP did not renominate them to Rajya Sabha.





CORRECTION & CLARIFICATION PAGE 1, 13.10.2026

● The first item in Happening Today published Tuesday incorrectly reported that Prime Minister Narendra Modi would inaugurate the 9th G20 Parliamentary Speakers' Summit. The event was in 2023. The error is regretted.

DU clears Rs 5,900-cr hostel expansion plan for 22,000 students

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, October 13


EXPRESS special

In shadow of student deaths, stark reminder: DU hostel projects are stalled, crawling

Only 1 of 24 Executive Council meetings in V-C Yogesh Singh's tenure discussed student housing, show records; it taken time, he says

THE BIG PICTURE

ONCE THERE WERE 5 STUDENTS

THE CITY

DELHI TO GET HOSTELS FOR 10,000 STUDENTS

• THE PROJECTS, THEIR STATUS

The Indian Express report published on September 16

The approval comes amid renewed scrutiny of DU's shortage of student accommodation after a building collapse in Satya Niketan last month that killed seven people, including five DU students

TO ADDRESS the shortage of student housing, a Rs 5,889-crore proposal to build new hostels and reconstruct two existing ones, which will accommodate 21,895 Delhi University students, has been approved at the varsity's Executive Council meeting on Tuesday. This was the first Executive Council meeting after Vice-Chancellor Yogesh Singh began his second term on October 8.

The approval comes less than a month after *The Indian Express* reported that several hostel projects announced during Singh's tenure had been delayed or remained at the planning stage, with some awaiting funding or statutory clearances. The report found that construction on a 1,456-seat hostel-cum-residential block at the Dhaka complex had begun only in April this year, despite the work being awarded in September 2023 and a scheduled completion date of March 2025.

Of the total outlay as per Tuesday's meeting, Rs 4,027 crore has been earmarked for new hostels to accommodate 15,758 students, while Rs 1,862 crore has been allocated for the reconstruction of two existing hostels, providing accommodation for another 6,137 students, the university's statement has said.

Further, DU has said additional multi-storey hostel buildings will be constructed at its Dhaka complex, Surajmal Vihar campus and Najafgarh campus. The reconstruction of Jubilee Hall and the PG Men's Hostel has also been approved. Singh has clarified that the names of the existing hostels will not be changed after reconstruction.

"The discussion at the EC meeting included building vertical hostels of up to 32 floors wherever space is available for students across DU. Funds for the projects would be sought from the Ministry of Education as grant-in-aid," an Executive Council member said.

"The designs for these buildings have been prepared keeping the requirements of the 21st century in mind," Singh has said, according to the university's statement. He has noted that the circumstances under which the university's earlier hostels were built differed from those expected in the future, and that planning is being done with the next 100 years in view.

Given the scarcity of vacant land for construction within DU, each hostel block will be designed to make maximum use of the permissible Floor Area Ratio (FAR) allocated for the respective campus, the statement has said.

The hostel blocks will include dining halls, shops, common rooms, reading rooms and residences for wardens, officials said.

Apart from the Dhaka complex, hostels for both men and women will be built at Veer Savarkar College in Roshanpura, Najafgarh. Hostels for men and women will also be constructed at the university's West Campus in Dwarka and East Campus in Surajmal Vihar, Karkardooma, according to the statement. Executive Council members have also urged colleges to prepare proposals for constructing new hostels on their own premises and submit them to the funding agency, officials said.

The approval comes amid renewed scrutiny of DU's shortage of student accommodation following the September 6 building collapse in Satya Niketan, in which seven people, including five DU students, died.

On September 7, a day after the incident, the Delhi High Court flagged the "absolutely inadequate number of hostels" at DU, observing that the shortage was forcing students to stay in unsafe paying guest accommodation, posing a threat to their lives and security.

Several projects announced during Singh's first tenure were either delayed or yet to begin, with some awaiting funds or approvals. At the Dhaka complex, construction on a 1,456-seat hostel-cum-residential block began in April 2026, although the work had been awarded in September 2023 and was scheduled to be completed by March 2025.

The Rs 318-crore project was at the basement stage and officials indicated that completion was unlikely before 2028.

Two other proposed projects at the Dhaka complex are a 1,050-seat girls' hostel and studio apartment complex and the Nirbhaya Residential Accommodation for 1,000 women students. These had been awaiting completion due to a delay in funds disbursal.

According to varsity officials, discussions on the projects are at a nascent stage and the process is likely to take time. There has not been a timeline set for the construction or completion of the projects. The total number of students enrolled in DU is over 2.6 lakh. Despite this huge student body, the varsity's hostel strength hasn't kept pace with the enrollment figures.

According to official figures, postgraduate hostel seats are 3,422 at the university level and another 3,788 across its colleges. The university had last month proposed an additional 1,622 university-level seats and 3,922 college-level seats.

GROUND report

For Delhi voters facing SIR notices, relief comes knocking on the door

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, October 13





Suhail verifies documents submitted by Khatoun during a door-to-door visit on Tuesday. DEVANSH MITTAL

MOHAMMAD SUHAIL rides his scooter through the narrow lanes of Sarai Kale Khan village in South East Delhi, stops outside house number T 112 and calls out, "Nasir *bhai*".

He knows these lanes well. He grew up here.

But this time, the booth level officer (BLO) is here to collect documents that could determine whether Nasir's name stays on Delhi's electoral roll.

Nasir, who works odd jobs at construction sites, has received a Special Intensive Revision (SIR) notice because his name could not be linked to the 2002 electoral roll, when the last SIR was conducted. This, despite having a voter ID and living at the same address with his wife, Khatoun, for years.

As Suhail had called ahead, Khatoun was ready with photocopies of everything she could think of – an electricity bill, bank passbook, Aadhaar card, ration card and more. She hands over the papers, and Suhail clicks a photograph of her with the notice before leaving on his scooter.

Nasir is away at work. He can afford to do so – he does not have to make a trip to the election office and appear for a hearing. Most importantly, he does not lose a day's wages.

Once Suhail uploads the documents on his app, the Electoral Registration Officer (ERO), if satisfied, will approve Nasir's inclusion in the final electoral roll.

The doorstep visits by BLOs reflect a series of measures the Election Commission of India (ECI) has introduced recently to speed up the disposal of SIR notices. These include automatic resolution of cases involving logical discrepancies and reduced scrutiny of documents.

Earlier, electors had to appear at a designated time at the local election office with documents to establish their eligibility. At its September 26 meeting – the first since *The Indian Express* reported on September 23 on the deep divide within the ECI – the poll panel simplified the process, directing BLOs to collect documents from electors at home instead.But door-to-door visits are not always easy. Another BLO in the Jangpura Assembly constituency, which includes Sarai Kale Khan, said that confusing house and street numbers as well as a high number of rented rooms, which are often not numbered, make locating voters difficult.

"I still call people to a central location because going to every house is very tough," he said, sitting inside the village's familiar Shiv Mandir.

Of the 116 electors marked for notices under his charge, 48 were flagged for "logical discrepancies", while 68 could not be mapped to the previous SIR roll. Such discrepancies arise when the ECI's software finds mismatches while linking a voter to a parent or grandparent on the earlier roll.

Since October 2, all his 48 cases have shown as "resolved" on his system, sparing him the task of collecting documents.

The reason: The ECI has updated its portal (ECINet/ERONET) to allow EROs to dispose of cases and mark electors as eligible without a formal hearing. Since September 30, just a letter by BLOs saying they were satisfied with the elector's details suffices, said sources.

The ERO did not confirm whether the nearly 15,000 logical discrepancy cases in the constituency had been resolved.

Delhi had 1.45 crore electors before the SIR. The draft roll published on August 31 retained 97.5 lakh names, while 47.5 lakh electors were marked uncollectible and removed. Around 33.1 lakh electors on the draft roll received notices – 13.79 lakh as they could not be linked to the previous SIR roll, and 19.33 lakh because of logical discrepancies.

On Monday, the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer said that around 20 lakh notices had been resolved. According to sources in the CEO's office, most logical discrepancy cases had been cleared.

For those still required to submit documents, scrutiny has also eased. Aila (32), received a notice because she could not establish a link to the previous SIR roll. She has only her Aadhaar card, her mother's Aadhaar card and her father's voter ID.

Those getting SIR notices have to furnish one of the 13 documents listed by the ECI, which includes birth certificate, passport, caste certificate and a permanent residence certificate. Aadhaar card alone cannot establish eligibility – it is the only document in the list that, by itself, will not suffice to prove one's eligibility.

Still, the BLO at the Shiv Mandir uploads Aila's documents. "It is best to have documents listed by the ECI. However, even if an elector does not have these documents, we have been told to try to include as many people as possible. I will upload these, let's see what happens," he said.

• Skywatch

Forecast: October 14, 2026
Partly cloudy sky becoming generally cloudy sky. No rain

MAX: 33-35°C
1.8°C below normal

MIN: 20-22°C
2.4°C above normal

- *Sunrise: 6:22 AM (October 15)*
- *Sunset: 5:53 PM (October 14)*
- *Moonrise: 10:41 AM (October 15)*
- *Moonset: 8:01 PM (October 14)*

• AQI Tracker

Anand Vihar
Moderate
AQI:156

JNU
Moderate
AQI:170

Burari
Satisfactory
AQI: 98

Narela
Moderate
AQI: 169

- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)





HC seeks govt stand on pleas by lawyers, traders on anti-CEC stir

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 13

DEALING WITH half a dozen petitions pertaining to the ongoing protests in the Capital against alleged irregularities in the SIR of electoral rolls, the Delhi High Court Tuesday sought records of submissions that the petitioners made before the Supreme Court.

The HC also asked the counsel appearing for the Centre and other authorities to seek instructions from the respective departments regarding contentions raised in the court on the pleas.

Among the plea that a division bench of Acting Chief Justice Nitin Sambre and Justice Sanjay Sharma dealt with on Tuesday was one by NSUI president Vinod Jakhar that sought the court's intervention and an independent probe into allegations of assault by alleged "anti-social elements" on October 10 near Jantar Mantar.

The Centre, through ASG Chetan Sharma and standing counsel Ashish Dixit, raised an objection on whether the plea can be heard since Jakhar is affiliated to NSUI, which he had not disclosed, as per HC norms.

The court granted the Centre three weeks to file its preliminary objections even as Jakhar requested that the authorities be instructed in the meantime to preserve CCTV footage, adding that he has filed the petition in his personal capacity and not representing NSUI. The request was not acceded to at this stage.

Meanwhile, a plea by law student Anshika Tripathi and another advocate has challenged various curbs imposed amid the protest, arguing that denial to protest at a particular site cannot be conflated to restricting persons from traveling to Delhi or assembling across the city. While the plea flagged "grave concern" in "the manner in which people have been placed under house arrest", it requested the HC to call on the state to "clarify as to how many persons are under house arrest and detentions, and under what order" on oath. The HC, however, did not issue any direction.

In two other pleas — one by a street vendors' association and another by a traders' association — both of which had not been formally notified and listed at the time of hearing, it was submitted that the protests near Jantar Mantar, despite denotification of it as a designated protest site, brought Delhi to a halt.

Senior advocates Sanjay Poddar and Sacchin Puri argued, "...We are seeking implementation of SC's order(s) and the SOP (for conducting protest)... Streets are being blocked, markets are being shut down, these are festival seasons; more than Rs 2,000 crore has been lost ..."

The HC's division bench will take up the petitions on Friday.



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa, Union Minister Bhupender Yadav and Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra at the flag-off ceremony in New Delhi on Tuesday. AFSHANA ALI

E-buses, charging points launched

New Delhi: Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, along with Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav, on Tuesday launched 150 electric buses as well as four charging stations, officials said.

Flagging-off 150 new zero-emission electric buses from the Swami Vivekanand ISBT Anand Vihar, the CM also inaugurated high-capacity charging stations at four Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) depots — Nand Nagri, Rohini Sector-37, Nangloi and Keshopur. PTI

Advertisement No. 110/2026
Government of India
Public Enterprises Selection Board
invites applications for the post of
Chairman & Managing Director
in
Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Limited (GRSE)
Last date of submission of online application by applicants is by 15:00 hours on
02nd November, 2026
Last date of forwarding of applications by the Nodal Officers on online system of PESB is by 17:00 hours on
11th November, 2026
For details login to website **https://pesb.gov.in**
Link for registration of Nodal Officers / Competent authorities is available on PESB website.

Man killed in bar brawl after beer-spill on manager's wife

Club manager and wife celebrating her birthday among five arrested, say police

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, October 13

A GROUP of friends had gathered for a drink at a nightclub in North Delhi's Inderlok when one of them accidentally spilled beer on the wife of the club's manager. An argument followed, and within minutes, the night of drinking and dancing turned violent.

The owner, manager and bouncers allegedly attacked the group, punching and kicking them around 3 am on October 11, police said. As some managed to escape, others were trapped inside. Among them was 29-year-old Daljit, who became unconscious. When his two friends carried him out, they too were allegedly assaulted.

According to the police, the accused then bundled all three into an autorickshaw and told them to throw Daljit into a drain.

Hours later, Daljit, a cab driver, was dead.

Five people – three bouncers, the manager and his wife, whose birthday was being celebrated – were arrested on Monday. DCP (North) Niharika Bhatt identified them as Dilawar, Sharvan Kumar, Sunny alias Gaurav, Vikas Balyan and Harshita – Sunny's wife, whose birthday was being celebrated.

The incident took place at Tor House nightclub near Ashok Park Metro station under the Sarai Rohilla police station area, said police.

Daljit, a resident of JJ clusters in Raghuvir Nagar and the sole breadwinner of his family, is survived by his wife Pooja and an eight-year-old son.

Police said the Inderlok police post in-charge has been sent to District Lines for dereliction of duty after the club was found operating until the early hours of the morning.

According to the FIR registered based on the statement of Daljit's friend Teenu – who was also present at the club – the group had planned to party on the night of October 10 but found bars in their vicinity closed since Navratri was about to begin. They decided to head to Inderlok after hearing about Armenia Bar and Tor House, two clubs located on the third and fourth floors of the same building.

"Around 3 am, Sahil Khan, Pawan and I reached the club in Sahil's car... We checked both clubs but chose Armenia Bar because Tor House was more crowded," Teenu said in his complaint. The police, however, said that the incident took place at Tor House.



Grieving relatives of deceased Daljit (right) on Tuesday. ANI/ EXPRESS



In the FIR, Teenu said that after ordering drinks, they were joined by more friends – Aabad, Nishant, Gautam Babu alias Bhopa, Kuljeet Singh alias Vinny and Daljit.

The group was allegedly drinking and dancing when beer spilled from Aabad's hand onto a woman. "This led to an argument between Aabad and a man... A waiter told us that the man was Gaurav, the manager of Armenia Bar, and that Tarsem alias Raja was the owner of the other club."

A woman accompanying Gaurav allegedly went outside and called the bouncers. "The bouncers and Gaurav's associates arrived and allegedly began beating all of us, kicking and punching us," Teenu said in his complaint. Daljit and Pawan were assaulted severely, he added.

"One of the men began closing the club's gate... Nishant, Pawan, Sahil, Aabad, Kuljeet, Vinny and Gautam Babu managed to escape by pushing open the gate. Pawan was badly injured. As I came out through the door, the bouncers followed me, pushed me back inside and started beating me again," Teenu said. He added that he saw Daljit lying unconscious on the floor while Gaurav and his associates allegedly continued the assault.

"Two of Gaurav's associates, one wearing a red T-shirt and the other a black shirt, used sticks to beat us repeatedly. A woman wearing a maroon dress struck Daljit with a bottle. One of the men pulled a pistol... pointed it at us and threatened us... Gaurav said, '...None of them should leave here alive'," alleged Teenu.

According to Teenu, they repeatedly kicked and punched Daljit in the head and chest until he could no longer stand. "Nishu (Nishant) and I carried Daljit out of the club. Even as we were leaving, one of the men kicked and punched us and pushed us into the lift. We carried Daljit out to the road. The men returned, stopped an autorickshaw and put all three of us inside. They told us to throw Daljit in a drain," he alleged.

Teenu said he and Nishu travelled with Daljit towards Rajouri Garden police station, where Teenu got off. Nishant allegedly later told Teenu that when they reached near Daljit's house, he said he would go home on his own.

Daljit's wife, Pooja, said she had repeatedly called him but could not reach him. As she prepared to step out to look for him, she found him lying on the ground near their house. She helped him upstairs and changed his clothes. Daljit allegedly vomited and went to sleep. The next morning, police said, she found him unconscious. Police said Pooja took him to Guru Gobind Singh Hospital where he was declared brought dead.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Teenu said, "A minor dispute escalated into a violent altercation and we lost our friend."

PROTESTS IN DEMAND OF CEC'S REMOVAL

'Intel inputs': Cops want Central forces until Oct 20



The Delhi Police said a law and order situation could arise without the additional strength. FILE

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 13

DELHI POLICE has asked the Union Ministry of Home Affairs to extend the deployment of 273 of the 301 Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) companies currently in the national capital till October 20. The police have cited inputs that activists of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and allied organisations are preparing a fresh round of protests at Jantar Mantar and the Election Commission to demand the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

A letter sent on Monday from the office of the Special Commissioner of Police (Operations) to the Home Ministry stated the deployment of forces in the national capital lapsed on Monday and a law and order situation could arise without the additional strength.

The Home Ministry sanctioned 301 companies of central forces for Delhi Police – 221 on October 6 and an additional 80 on October 8.

According to the letter, inputs suggest further escalation of protests by activists from the CJP and various other organisations towards Jantar Mantar and the Election Commission office. The letter says activists try to assemble at other vital installations in the national capital and march to the Election Commission office, Parliament, India Gate, offices and residences of ministers, potentially creating a law and order situation.

The letter adds that activists from other political parties and organisations, including the Bhim Army and student unions, may join the programme. It says demonstrations by anti-social elements and various political outfits at Jantar Mantar and other sensitive locations may create issues.

Delhi Police has said "the apprehension is further substantiated" by statements of prominent CJP members about a prolonged agitation.

Delhi Police's letter argues that adequate allocation of central forces is essential for quick deployment across the capital for any emerging situation.

In its communication, Delhi Police has also flagged that 28 of the 80 additional companies sanctioned for deployment in Delhi have not reported to Delhi Police. "In view of this, it is requested to extend the deployment period of only 273 companies out of 301 companies of CAPFs till October 20 beyond October 12," the letter states.

Narrow lane, locked gate: CJP's route to Jantar Mantar

Alok Singh
New Delhi, October 13

THE WAY into Jantar Mantar was blocked, the gates barricaded and police personnel deployed along the main roads. But Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) members allegedly found another way in – through a narrow lane behind the Janata Dal (United) office, over a locked iron gate and into the protest site, where they unfurled the Tricolour and raised slogans before being detained, sources in the police said.

CJP members had allegedly conducted a reconnaissance of the area on Monday night to identify a way into the site. The narrow lane, which connects to Janpath Lane, was relatively lightly guarded compared with the main approach roads, the sources said.

In the evening, the Delhi Police also booked all of them for trespassing after getting a complaint from the JDU.





Video grabs of CJP leaders Ashutosh Ranka, Saurav Das and Ajinkya Shinde entering Jantar Mantar on Tuesday. PTI

On Tuesday morning, a group of 14, including CJP leaders Ashutosh Ranka, Saurav Das and Ajinkya Shinde, allegedly used the lane to reach the JD(U) office premises and climbed over its locked iron gate to enter Jantar Mantar.

In a video shared by the CJP on social media, Ranka could be seen carrying the National Flag as other members raised slogans of 'Bharat Mata Ki Jai' and 'Inquilab Zindabad'. Soon after, they were detained by Delhi Police personnel.

The 14 members were taken to Jafrabad police station, around 40 km away, where they have remained in detention since the morning.

The action came a day after Delhi Police announced that Jantar Mantar was no longer a "designated site" for protests, while the CJP had given the police a 24-hour ultimatum to allot a date for an agitation against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar at the site.

Earlier in the day, advocate Pushp Sharma, who is representing the CJP members, told *The Indian Express* that he had been trying to contact police officers since morning to find out where they were being held and whether they would be formally arrested or released.

He added that he had been in touch with Ranka around the time of the detention. "However, in his last message, he said their phones were being taken away. Since then, I have been trying to contact them but their phones are switched off," Sharma said.

He said police officers told him that the group had not been arrested but cited their detention as the reason they were not being allowed to meet their lawyers.

Police, however, are yet to take a final call on the next course of action, said the sources. Officers are reportedly considering whether to register an FIR, initiate further investigation or continue the detention.

"Cockroaches with the Tiranga sneaked into Jantar Mantar early this morning before they were picked up by Delhi Police," CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke posted on X, adding, "You cannot denotify the resistance."

Along with Dipke, Ranka and Das were released Sunday following 24 hours in preventive detention after being picked up from the Delhi Airport. Their release was subject to a condition that they would not engage in any activity that could disturb public peace for one year.

SC calls in senior officer to explain detention of women journalists

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 13

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday sought the presence of a senior Delhi Police officer on Thursday to explain the allegations that women journalists covering the protests against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar in the Capital were heckled and some even detained despite identifying themselves as media personnel.

"We would like some senior officer to remain present here and explain," Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, presiding over a three-judge bench, said after senior advocate Indira Jaising mentioned a petition filed by the Network of Women in Media, India (NWMI), seeking protection for journalists, especially women, from arbitrary detention.

The court said it will hear the plea on Thursday along with other petitions challenging the detention of political leaders and suspension of rail services and shutting down of Metro stations in the wake of the protests.

The court was scheduled to hear the pleas against the detentions of political leaders and Metro closure on Tuesday, but the hearing was adjourned as one of the judges was unwell.

On October 9, the court had directed the government to ensure that there is "no complete prohibition on movement of Metro/trains", and "no inconvenience is caused to the citizenry of Delhi".

However, with the protests called by the CJP on Saturday leading to detention of lawyers and closure of gates of 45 Metro stations, petitions were filed before the court alleging contempt of its October 9 directions.

On October 11, the court asked authorities to ensure that there are no illegal detentions, free and smooth movement of people is allowed, Metro and train services function normally, and Internet services are not disrupted — all subject to law and order conditions.

Maintaining that the petitioners had made a prima facie case of contempt, the bench asked the Centre, Delhi Police and the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation to file affidavits and compliance reports by Tuesday.

With the proceedings adjourned, the bench on Tuesday allowed a request to extend the time for filing the affidavits till Thursday. The court also issued notice on a fresh petition by the Association for Democratic Reforms, challenging the constitutional validity of Section 16 of the Chief Election Commissioners and Other Election Commissioners Act 2023, which provides immunity to ECs for actions taken in discharge of their official duties.

The bench agreed to take up on Thursday a plea against unauthorised crowding and ruckus in the court premises, including its Registry, as Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi and other Opposition leaders marched to the court Monday to file a petition challenging functioning of the CEC and SIR process.

Jantar Mantar removed as protest site after SC orders: Delhi Police to HC

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 13

THE DELHI Police said that it denotified Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site and identified alternate protest sites following a Supreme Court's order dated October 9, where the top court had recorded that "suitable alternative sites" for protest "need to be identified and designated".

The admission by ASG Chetan Sharma, representing the government, was made before Justice Amit Mahajan of the Delhi High Court, who was hearing a plea by Indian Youth Congress president Uday Bhanu Chib, challenging denial of permission to protest at Jantar Mantar prior to its denotification.

On Monday, police said it had modified its standing order which had laid down guidelines for protests at Jantar Mantar, declaring that the site was denotified. It said three alternative sites — Burari Ground, Ramlila Ground and CBD Ground — were designated protest sites. The notification had justified the change in venue being effected owing to recommendations made by a committee under the Ministry of Home Affairs.

Chib, in his plea, also challenged the broader norm of denying permission to protest at designated protest sites as a disproportionate measure, instead of exercising the power narrowly and subject to reasonable restrictions only.

Earlier in the day, ASG Sharma had argued that Chib's petition has been rendered infructuous since Jantar Mantar was denotified.

But senior advocate Siddharth Luthra, appearing for Chib, exhorted, "It has not become infructuous. If this was the subterfuge that was sought to be played, then there is a lot to be said... Notice has to be issued and matter is to be taken up. We will amend the plea of course, but matters have to be taken up."

Luthra's remark had come following the Centre's request on Monday to the court to adjourn the matter for hearing by a day to get instructions. Hours later, Delhi Police had notified the change in designated protest sites.

Justice Mahajan recorded that the issue that now remains to be adjudicated is "academic" in nature. The bench issued notice to the Delhi Police, seeking its response by November 17 when it will hear the matter next.

ASG Sharma, while emphasising that the petition's cause does not survive, added, "As on today, for good or bad, we have denotified Jantar Mantar pursuant to SC orders."

He referred to the SC's October 9 order where the closure of metro and other services as a preventive measure in anticipation of the protest call given for October 10 was challenged.

ASG Sharma pointed to the SC's observation, where it had recorded, "During the course of hearing, it was suggested... that it is high time basic amenities were provided to those engaged in peaceful and lawful protest. To that end, suitable alternative sites capable of housing such infrastructure (for facilitating protest) need to be identified and designated. Let the competent authority consider this suggestion and take an appropriate decision..."

"We have precisely done that and now that has been challenged before the SC," ASG Sharma added.

NSUI stages dharna over 'assault' of women members by police



ANI

Security personnel intervene as a protester tries to stop a bus carrying detained NSUI members, Tuesday.

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 13

THE NATIONAL Students' Union of India (NSUI), the student wing of Congress, Tuesday staged a dharna outside Connaught Place police station alleging that Delhi Police personnel assaulted its women members amid the protest demanding resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Led by NSUI national president Vinod Jakhar, hundreds of activists first gathered at Gate 7 of the Rajiv Chowk Metro station to initially protest against Kumar. Subsequently, police detained Jakhar and several protesters, according to the student organisation.

The NSUI later called for a dharna outside the Connaught Place police station, alleging that police personnel had assaulted its women members while dispersing the protesters. The organisation said several activists had been taken to the police station and some were yet to be released.

A video circulating on social media purportedly shows a woman NSUI member being dragged by her hair by a female police officer and taken onto a bus carrying detained protesters. Police are verifying the authenticity of the video.

Condemning the detentions, NSUI national media incharge Ravi Hanuman Pandey said the organisation's movement against alleged "vote chori" would intensify until Kumar resigned. Jakhar said the detention of student activists would not deter their demand for accountability from the Election Commission of India.

Frame Ramlila Maidan booking rules every yr: HC

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 13

The Delhi High Court has directed authorities concerned to frame "comprehensive" policies every year on allotment of Ramlila Maidan for festivals, saying that with the current first-come, first-serve rule was not reasonable.

Delhi Police has designated the ground as a protest site, although no detailed SOP has been issued.

The order was issued by Justice Amit Mahajan last week and made public on Monday. The court was hearing a plea by an NGO, whose application to conduct Dussehra festivities on the ground was rejected on the ground that it had already been allotted to another party.

Meanwhile, the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB) submitted that in case of multiple applicants, it decides allotment on a first-come, first-serve basis.

Justice Mahajan said, "...merely because a policy is mechanically ascertainable does not translate to mean that the same is also constitutionally reasonable and in consonance with public policy ... the policy of first-come, first-serve does not find favour with this court..."

• FOUR FIRs OVER 'RUMOUR-MONGERING'

DELHI POLICE has lodged four FIRs against social media handles allegedly spreading false narratives, misleading information regarding the October 10 protest.

CROSS BORDER efforts to circulate 'anti-India' content and disturb public order are also being investigated, sources said.

SEVERAL PAKISTAN-based social media handles have been identified during the prove and over 500 posts were taken down, sources also said.



Police presence near Bangla Sahib Gurdwara, Saturday. FILE

CLAIMS CIRCULATED on social media platforms alleging deaths among protesters, police firing, and other instances of violence.

SAKSHI CHAND

4 FIRs filed over INDIA bloc march

Alok Singh
New Delhi, October 13

THE DELHI Police has registered four FIRs over Monday's INDIA bloc protest march in Central Delhi, citing that it was held without permission and that barricades were damaged with a truck. The march was held to demand the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and the scrapping of the SIR of electoral rolls.

The FIRs were registered at three police stations.



The march saw a major show of Opposition unity. FILE

Delhi' protest saw a major show of Opposition unity, with almost the entire top leadership of the INDIA bloc participating. Those present included Rahul Gandhi, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, Trinamool Congress chief Mamata Banerjee, RJD leader Tejashwi Yadav and CPI(M) leader M A Baby.

Thousands of supporters marched from Barakhamba Road to the Supreme Court. Senior Opposition leaders also jointly filed a petition in the Supreme Court. Monday's march followed days of street protests, first by the Opposition and then, on Saturday, by the Cockroach Janta Party.

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL



High Praise

THE HIGH tea at Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi's Sunehri Bagh residence on Tuesday was a pleasant break from the street protests being staged by INDIA bloc leaders against CEC Gyanesh Kumar since last week. The refreshments served at the high tea were a big hit with the leaders who attended it. Catered by Moets restaurant, which also runs a canteen at the new AICC headquarters at Indira Bhawan, the menu included a good mix of north Indian snacks and desserts. The Gandhis had ordered samosas and chaat from an Old Delhi shop, which is a favourite of Rahul Gandhi. The samosas remained the pick of the snacks, with many MPs inquiring about the shop they came from. The hosts also served chilla, golgappas, falafels, cakes and eclairs. The menu was all vegetarian. The beverages included different kinds of sodas, kulhad tea and coffee. Old Bollywood melodies, including Lata Mangeshkar's Ajeeb Dastan Hai Yeh, played in the background, and the guests were heard praising the hosts for the vibe set for the gathering.

Cultural Treat

A DELEGATION of 50 students from academic institutions in Punjab's Chandigarh, Mohali and Amritsar were in for a cultural treat while visiting Gujarat Central University during the ongoing Navratri festivities. The students were hosted for lunch, which included various local delicacies, by Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha president Hemang Joshi. The leader also discussed Punjab's drug abuse problem with the students and sought their opinion on how to tackle it. Later, Joshi made arrangements for festive clothing for the students and took them for a Garba night, where they tried their hands at the state's traditional folk dance.

BEIJING OPPOSES STANDARD NAMES OF 28 PLACES AND FEATURES IN THE UT

Ladakh integral part of India: Delhi rejects China objection

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, October 13

INDIA ON Tuesday rejected China's objection to the government announcing standard names of 28 places and features in Ladakh, asserting that the Union Territory of Ladakh is an integral part of India.

The reaction came hours after China opposed the Indian Government's announcement, saying it has never recognised the UT of Ladakh.

New Delhi said identifying the 28 places on the Indian map is aimed at accurate recognition.

China raised the objections over a week after the Union Home Ministry announced on October 2 that "the government, in consultation with the UT of Ladakh, has identified a total of twenty-eight (28) places/features, located in the UT of Ladakh, by standard place and feature names on the official map of Survey of India (SoI)". It said that "identifying them formally on the Survey of India map of UT of Ladakh is aimed at facilitating their accurate recognition and better awareness among the public at large".



No amount of denial by China can change this fact, says MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal

On Tuesday, Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Mao Ning said, "China has never recognised the so-called 'Union Territory of Ladakh' unilaterally and illegally established by India and firmly opposes #India's announcement of so-called standard names." India's move to issue standardised names in Ladakh is "illegal and invalid and cannot change the fact that the relevant areas in the western sector of the China-India boundary have always belonged to China".

Hours later, Ministry of External Affairs' official spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said, "It is reiterated that the UT of Ladakh is an integral and inalienable part of India. No amount of denial by the Chinese side can change this established fact."

"As for the press release by the Ministry of Home Affairs, GOI, which is being referred to, it is self-explanatory... Identifying these places formally on the SoI map of UT of Ladakh is aimed at facilitating their accurate recognition and better awareness among the public at large," Jaiswal said, reiterating the Home Ministry's statement.

The "tit-for-tat" naming of places on the map has been ongoing for the last few years, as both sides have sought to establish their claim on the territory on the map. Since 2017, Beijing has issued several lists of "standardised" names of places along the Line of Actual Control (LAC), claiming them to be in accordance with regulations issued by the State Council, the equivalent of the Chinese Cabinet.

India has described them as "inventions" by China and has consistently and unequivocally dismissed them. Delhi has also issued its names of places along the LAC. This has happened at least six times in the last nine years or so. The most recent face-off happened in August 2026.

What has irked New Delhi this time is the forceful tone with which Beijing has once again rejected India's abrogation of Article 370 and the UT status granted to J&K and Ladakh. China had opposed the move in August 2019, and even brought it up for discussion at the informal consultations at the UN Security Council, at the behest of Pakistan. However, the Chinese move didn't find takers from the remaining permanent members of the UNSC, including the US, France, the UK and Russia.

Shivakumar vows accountability after anti-EC protesters detained

Atiya Firdos
Bengaluru, October 13



Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra with Karnataka CM D K Shivakumar in New Delhi on Tuesday. PTI

AMID THE Congress's vocal opposition to the large-scale detention of protesters in Delhi and mounting criticism over the detention of more than 200 anti-SIR demonstrators in Bengaluru, Karnataka Chief Minister D K Shivakumar on Tuesday reiterated his government's commitment to the right to peaceful protest, saying there would be "no double standards".

"The right to peaceful protest is fundamental to our democracy. We cannot demand that right for ourselves in Delhi and deny it to others in Bengaluru," Shivakumar said in a statement on Tuesday.

He said he had sought a report on the police action. "If there has been any unnecessary use of force or excess, accountability will follow. Disagreement with the Election Commission (EC), disagreement with my government, or disagreement with me personally does not diminish anyone's right to peacefully express it," the statement read.

Earlier in the day, state Home Minister Priyank Kharge said the handling of Monday's protests would be reviewed. In a post on X, Kharge said, "The right to peaceful protest is fundamental to our democracy. It must be respected, protected and never suppressed. I have issued instructions to the police to ensure that no peaceful demonstration is disrupted..."

"The police are here to protect your rights, not to stand in the way of your voice. Our responsibility is not merely to maintain law and order, but to create an environment where every citizen can express dissent freely, peacefully and without fear. In a democracy, peaceful dissent is not a threat to law and order. It is a right that law and order must protect," he added.

R Ashoka, Leader of the Opposition in the Assembly, told *The Indian Express* that the detentions exposed the "glaring hypocrisy of the Congress. "They lecture the country on democracy, Constitutional rights and freedom of expression when it suits them. But people protest against their own government, suddenly there are restrictions, detentions and lessons on where they should protest," he said.

One of the protesters who was detained around 5 pm on Monday said, "Did the High Court order the police to assault us? They could have asked us to leave peacefully... They released us around 7 pm," she said.

Advocate Nelson P, who was present as the protesters marched to the CEO's office on Monday, said, "It is important that ordinary citizens raise issues. Protest is the last resort when other avenues fail. We must stand by people who protest."

Meanwhile, a group of advocates staged a protest outside the Karnataka HC, demanding the scrapping of the SIR of electoral rolls and condemning the detention of lawyers and activists by the Delhi Police. This protest came in the wake of two rounds of detentions of anti-SIR demonstrators. Around 125 students were detained on Saturday, followed by 100 protesters on Monday, as they attempted to march towards the EC's office.

On both occasions, the police cited Karnataka High Court directions restricting demonstrations to designated venues. They said the protesters had been taken into preventive custody for attempting to march without permission.

DCP (Central) Akshay M Hakay said the protesters had assembled on Monday without permission. They were asked to move to the designated protest venue, but refused to comply, following which they were detained, he said.

Mamata AITC alleges knife attack attempt on her, files complaint

Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, October 13

THE MAMATA AITC lodged a police complaint alleging that former West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee faced an attempted knife attack outside her Kalighat residence in Kolkata on Tuesday.

Police said the alleged accused, Anusua Saha (38), a civic volunteer, has been detained.

In the complaint, Mamata AITC MP Dola Sen alleged that the incident took place around 6 pm on Tuesday when Banerjee was returning from a Durga Puja pandal in her neighbourhood. "This is to inform you that at about 06:00 PM today, a lady, reportedly a civic volunteer... came in a violent mode and attacked Mamata Banerjee with a knife and furthermore claimed herself as her niece. She was hurling abusive language and in an intoxicated manner tried to violently approach Mamata Banerjee and even lied down on the road to hurt the 8th Chief Minister of West Bengal," it read.



Mamata Banerjee addresses mediapersons on Tuesday. ANI

Sen said it was concerning that someone allegedly carrying a weapon could approach the residence of Banerjee, a Z-plus category protectee. "It is concerning that someone like the attacker could approach gates of the residence of a Z plus category security protectee raising questions in the larger conspiracy."

Stating that the incident could be the result of a conspiracy, Sen requested the police to examine photographs and video footage submitted with the complaint and take appropriate legal action. "In view of the above you are requested to record this as information under Section 173 BNSS and take cognisance of the photos and videos enclosed herewith as reference," it read.

A senior police officer said, "An incident occurred at the former CM's residence when she was exiting the residence... a complaint was lodged by TMC members. Action is being taken."

Mamata camp protest thwarted by police, party hits back at govt

Kolkata: Members of the Mamata AITC held a demonstration in Kolkata's Rajabazar area on Tuesday, demanding the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar over the SIR exercise.

Party workers were planning to march to Park Circus from Rajabazar, but police did not allow them to move forward, stating that no permission was taken for the programme. Subsequently, the party workers demonstrated at Rajabazar, raising slogans against the BJP and the CEC.

Beleghata MLA Kunal Ghosh, part of the Mamata Banerjee-led faction, claimed that the party's student and youth wings, which organised the march, had informed the police via e-mail. **ENS & PTI**

Madras HC upholds resignation of 6 MLAs who joined Vijay's TVK

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, October 13

THE MADRAS High Court on Tuesday upheld the Tamil Nadu Assembly Speaker's decision to accept the resignations of six AIADMK legislators who subsequently joined the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam, but ruled that their resignations would not bring pending disqualification proceedings against four of them to an end.

A Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G Arul Murugan directed Speaker J C D Prabhakar to conclude the disqualification proceedings within two months, drawing a distinction between a legislator's resignation and proceedings under the anti-defection provisions of the Constitution.

The court held that the resignations, tendered between May 26 and June 29, were genuine and voluntary. It rejected the contention that the Speaker should have conducted a more extensive inquiry before accepting them, observing that he was not required to undertake a "roving" or detailed investigation into the legislators' motives.

The Speaker told the court that each MLA submitted a handwritten resignation in person and was individually questioned to establish whether the decision was voluntary and free from coercion. The Bench accepted the "limited inquiry" met the constitutional requirement.

But the court said resignation and disqualification were distinct constitutional processes. "The Speaker can still finally adjudicate and decide the disqualification proceedings, and such determination shall carry the consequences as described under Schedule X of the Constitution," the Bench said. It also held the High Court could intervene under its writ jurisdiction if the Speaker failed to decide such proceedings within a reasonable period.

The legislators had quit the AIADMK after the Assembly elections and joined Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay's TVK.

BJP retains Gandhinagar civic body, wins 38 of 44 seats

Ahmedabad: The ruling BJP retained power in the Gandhinagar Municipal Corporation, winning 38 of the total 44 seats as the poll results were announced by the State Election Commission on Tuesday.

The Congress won five seats while one was secured by a woman Independent candidate in the urban local body governing the state capital. The AAP, which had one member in the previous GMC body, drew a blank as all 32 of its candidates lost in the elections. Voting was held on October 11 and 59.25% voter turnout was recorded. Total 130 candidates were in the fray. **ENS**

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, पटना
All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna
Phulwarisharif, Patna- 801507

No.: FTS-15070(XVIII)/Deputation/2026 Dated: 10.10.2026

VACANCY NOTICE ON DEPUTATION

Applications are invited in prescribed pro-forma from eligible Officers of Central/State Government/ U.T. /Autonomous Bodies / Universities / Public Sector Undertaking /R&D Organization / Statutory / Local Self Government Bodies as applicable for filling up the following **Group 'B' Posts on Deputation Basis** at All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna. The essential qualification, experience etc. required for applying for these posts are as under:-

Sl. No.	Name of Post	Pay Matrix & Level	No. of post(s)
01.	Librarian Grade-I (Documentalist)	Level-7 (₹ 44900- 142400)	1
02.	Manager /Supervisor/ Gas Officer	Level-7 (₹ 44900- 142400)	1
03.	Laundry Manager	Level-6 (₹35400- 112400)	1

The number of posts is tentative and is liable to change based on the Institute's requirement. The period of deputation will be for a period of three (3) years and extendable for a maximum period of five years as per DoPT guidelines. Maximum age limit for applying for the aforesaid posts on deputation is 56 years as on last date of posting of application. The eligibility criteria will be regulated as per the relevant Recruitment Rules/DoPT instruction as applicable. The officers who fulfil the above qualifications/eligibility criteria may submit their application in the prescribed proforma at Annexure-I through proper channel to the **Recruitment Cell, All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Phulwarisharif, Patna-801507** through Speed Post/Registered post only. Application received through any other medium will not be accepted.

The last date for receipt of the completed application in the prescribed proforma along with required documents through proper channel is up to 45 days from the publication of the advertisement in the Employment News. The format of application and details regarding age, qualifications, experience and other information to the posts are available on the official website of AIIMS Patna i.e. www.aiimspatna.edu.in. All further addendum, corrigendum and notifications, if any, will be available on the Institute's website www.aiimspatna.edu.in.

Sd/-
Executive Director
AIIMS, Patna

Ministry of Culture
Government of India

Centre for Contemporary Studies
Prime Ministers Museum and Library
Cordially invites you to a **Talk**
on
Manipur during the Second World War: Refuge, Labour Mobilisation, and Local Responses
by
Dr. L. Gitarani Devi
Junior Fellow, PMML
15 October 2026 at 3:00 pm
Venue:
Seminar Room
Prime Ministers Museum and Library
Teen Murti House, New Delhi
All are Welcome
Those wishing to have their names added to the email list may please email us at:- **ccspmml@gmail.com**

CBC- 09142/11/0027/2627

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, पटना
All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna
Phulwarisharif, Patna- 801507

No.: FTS-15070(XIX)/Deputation/2026 Dated: 10.10.2026

VACANCY NOTICE ON DEPUTATION

Applications are invited in prescribed pro-forma from eligible Officers of Central/State Government/ U.T. /Autonomous Bodies / Universities / Public Sector Undertaking /R&D Organization / Statutory / Local Self Government Bodies as applicable for filling up the following **Group 'C' Posts on Deputation Basis** at All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna. The essential qualification, experience etc. required for applying for these posts are as under:-

Sl. No.	Name of Post	Pay Matrix & Level	No. of post(s)
01.	Manifold Technician (Gas Steward)	Level-5 (₹ 29200- 92300)	2
02.	Senior Plumber	Level-4 (₹ 25500-81100)	4

The number of posts is tentative and is liable to change based on the Institute's requirement. The period of deputation will be for a period of three (3) years and extendable for a maximum period of five years as per DoPT guidelines. Maximum age limit for applying for the aforesaid posts on deputation is 56 years as on last date of posting of application. The eligibility criteria will be regulated as per the relevant Recruitment Rules/DoPT instruction as applicable. The officers who fulfil the above qualifications/eligibility criteria may submit their application in the prescribed proforma at Annexure-I through proper channel to the **Recruitment Cell, All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Phulwarisharif, Patna-801507** through Speed Post/Registered post only. Application received through any other medium will not be accepted.

The last date for receipt of the completed application in the prescribed proforma along with required documents through proper channel is up to 45 days from the publication of the advertisement in the Employment News. The format of application and details regarding age, qualifications, experience and other information to the posts are available on the official website of AIIMS Patna i.e. www.aiimspatna.edu.in. All further addendum, corrigendum and notifications, if any, will be available on the Institute's website www.aiimspatna.edu.in.

Sd/-
Executive Director
AIIMS, Patna

Wabtec
Wabtec India Industrial Private Limited
ITC Green Centre, 6th Floor, Southwest Tower
Banaswadi Main Road, Bangalore - 560005, Karnataka, India

PUBLIC NOTICE

Important Warning Regarding Fraudulent Recruitment Communications

It has come to the attention of **Wabtec India Industrial Private Limited** ("Wabtec") that certain unauthorized persons or agencies may be falsely representing themselves as employees, representatives or recruitment partners of Wabtec and offering fictitious employment opportunities in exchange for money or sensitive personal information.

Wabtec does **not** charge candidates any fee or authorize any person to collect money for job applications, interviews, offer letters, training, background verification, onboarding or securing employment.

Candidates are advised to observe the following precautions:

- Verify vacancies and recruitment communications through Wabtec's official careers website.
- Do not transfer money in response to any purported Wabtec recruitment communication.
- Do not disclose banking credentials, passwords, OTPs, credit-card information or other sensitive financial information.
- Carefully verify the sender's email address, website domain and contact details.
- Do not click suspicious links or download attachments from unknown sources.
- Preserve copies of suspicious emails, messages, offer letters, phone numbers, website links and payment requests.

Where Wabtec uses an authorized recruitment agency or service provider, candidates should independently verify the agency's authority through **Indiacareers@wabtec.com.**

Suspicious communications may be reported to Wabtec at **Indiacareers@wabtec.com** and to the competent cybercrime or law-enforcement authorities.

Disclaimer of Liability

Any recruitment communication issued by an unauthorized person is fraudulent and does not create any obligation or commitment on the part of Wabtec. Wabtec shall not be responsible for unauthorized representations or transactions undertaken by third parties without Wabtec's knowledge or authorization.

Any candidate who transfers money, provides sensitive financial details, or engages with unauthorized individuals does so strictly at their own risk. Wabtec Corporation accepts no responsibility or legal liability for any financial loss, fraud, or damages resulting from unauthorized recruitment activities.

Date: 13th October, 2026
Issued by: Human Resources Department

GOVERNMENT OF NATIONAL CAPITAL TRERRITORY OF DELHI
DIRECTORATE OF GURDWARA ELECTIONS
2ND FLOOR, F- BLOCK, VIKAS BHAWAN,
I.P. ESTATE, NEW DELHI-110002
Phone No. 23370225, Email ID: dge.2011@gmail.com

FORM 16
(See Rule 22(1)(b))

NOTICE OF FINAL PUBLICATION OF ELECTORAL ROLLS

It is hereby notified for public information that the list of amendments to the draft electoral roll for Ward No. 1 to 46 have been prepared in accordance with the Delhi Sikh Gurdwara Management Committee (Registration of Electors) Rules, 1973 and a copy of the said roll together with the said list of amendments have been published and will be available for inspection at ERO/AERO offices of respective wards and also on the website of this Directorate i.e. **https://gurudwara.delhi.gov.in**

Place: Delhi **ELECTORAL REGISTRATION OFFICERS**
Date: 09.10.2026 **WARD 1 TO 46**
DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0252/26-27 **DIRECTORATE OF GURDWARA ELECTIONS**

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, पटना
All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna
Phulwarisharif, Patna- 801507

No.: FTS-15070(XVII)/Deputation/2026 Dated: 10.10.2026

VACANCY NOTICE ON DEPUTATION

Applications are invited in prescribed pro-forma from eligible Officers of Central/State Government/ U.T/Autonomous Bodies/Universities/Public Sector Undertaking/ Ministries /R&D Organization/Police Departments of Central/State/U.T/Armed Forces including Para Military Forces as applicable for filling up the following **Group 'A' Posts on Deputation Basis** at All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna. The essential qualification, experience etc. required for applying for these posts are as under:-

Sl. No.	Name of Post	Pay Matrix & Level	No. of post(s)
01.	Superintending Engineer	Level-13 (₹ 1,23,100 - ₹2,15,900)	1
02.	Chief Librarian	Level-13 (₹ 1,23,100 - ₹2,15,900)	1
03.	Senior Analyst (System Analyst)	Level-12 (₹ 78,800 - ₹2,09,200)	1
04.	Hospital Architect	Level-11 (₹67,700 – ₹2,08,700)	1
05.	Senior Procurement-cum-Stores Officer	Level-11 (₹67,700 – ₹2,08,700)	1
06.	Chief Medical Social Service Officer	Level-11 (₹67,700 – ₹2,08,700)	1
07.	CSSD Officer	Level-11 (₹ 67,700 – ₹2,08,700)	1
08.	Senior Dietician (Assistant Food Manager)	Level-10 (₹ 56,100 - ₹1,77,500)	2
09.	Chief Medical Record Officer	Level-10 (₹ 56,100 - ₹1,77,500)	1
10.	Supervising Medical Social Service Officer	Level-10 (₹ 56,100 - ₹1,77,500)	1

The last date for receipt of the completed application in the prescribed proforma along with required documents through proper channel is up to **45 days from the publication of the advertisement in the Employment News.** The format of application and details regarding age, qualifications, experience and other information to the posts are available on the official website of AIIMS Patna i.e. www.aiimspatna.edu.in. All further addendum, corrigendum and notifications, if any, will be available on the Institute's website www.aiimspatna.edu.in.

Sd/-
Executive Director
AIIMS, Patna

Three-member panel set up to probe IIIT Ranchi student's death

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 13

THE MINISTRY of Education on Tuesday constituted a three-member panel to examine the circumstances surrounding the death of a first-year student in his hostel room at IIIT, Ranchi last Saturday.

The incident came to light after hostel inmates alerted the institute administration that the student was not opening his room's door. The student was found hanging from the ceiling fan. Several students staged a protest on IIIT Ranchi campus, alleging that the college authorities did not take the victim to hospital on time.

The three-member panel is headed by Delhi University South Campus director Professor Rajni Abhi and includes a senior psychiatrist and a senior officer from the Ministry of Education. "The Ministry of Education has taken cognizance of the unfortunate death of a student at the Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT), Ranchi campus. In order to examine the circumstances and related issues in detail, a three-member committee headed and chaired by Prof. Rajni Abbi... has been constituted," the MoE stated on Tuesday.

The committee has been mandated to examine the circumstances surrounding the incident.

Live on social media, Punjab anti-drug activist shot dead

Kamaldeep Singh Brar
Mansa, October 13





Parminder Singh Jhota's mother (left) outside the hospital in Mansa, Tuesday. ANI

ANTI-DRUG ACTIVIST Parvinder Singh alias Jhota, who had been running a campaign against the illegal sale of addictives at chemist stores, was shot dead Tuesday in a busy market in Punjab's Mansa district, with the victim recording the incident as he was live on social media at the time, police said.

A manhunt has been launched for medical store owner Ashwani Kumar, who opened fire at Jhota (42), and his companions after allegedly being confronted over selling synthetic drugs to an elderly man. The alleged killing, witnessed live by hundreds, sparked an outrage with family members and locals staging a protest outside the Civil Hospital where Jhota was taken after being fatally wounded. Doctors at the hospital declared him brought dead.

The protesters refused to allow the postmortem and said they will not cremate the body. Among others they are demanding that the postmortem be conducted at PGIMER in Chandigarh, a probe by the CBI, and resignations of Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and Director General of Police Gaurav Yadav. They have also called for a Punjab shutdown on October 15.

A heavy police force has been deployed outside the Civil Hospital. Police said no FIR has been lodged as the family was yet to give a written complaint.

"We will register an FIR and proceed accordingly if the family refuses to submit a complaint," a police officer said.

Jhota had formed a task force and had been active against the drug traffickers since 2021–2022. In July 2023, Jhota and his supporters had caught a man allegedly selling banned capsules, The man had allegedly procured the capsules from the medical store owned by Kumar. Jhotha and his aides had then blackened Kumar's face, garlanded him with shoes and paraded him on a donkey. An FIR was registered against Kumar, while Jhota was booked for assault and trespassing, police said, adding the latest incident may have its genesis in that episode.

Police said Jhota was live on Facebook when he and some others arrived at Kumar's medical store and alleged that he was selling synthetic drugs to an elderly man. In a 5.49-minute video, he is purportedly heard saying that the store owner has a pistol in his hand.

As the argument ensues, Jhota asks the store owner why he has taken out a pistol and says he will call the drug inspector. "He is holding a pistol and selling drugs...Maar, maar, tun saade fire maar (Open fire at us)," he is heard challenging Kumar who opens fire, injuring Jhotha and one of his aides. As Jhota and his companion run of the shop, Kumar follows. In another video that surfaced on soc ial media, Kumar fires two more shots at Jhota, before closing the shop and fleeing the scene.

The activist had sustained three gunshots, two to his abdomen and one in his thigh, while four of his companions were also injured after being shot at. At the hospital, activist's father Bhim Singh slammed the AAP government alleging that drugs were sold openly in the state and his son was killed while fighting the menace.

"This is the failure of the Punjab government. The system has collapsed. My son had saved thousands of lives. He was killed by drug traffickers. His two innocent children have been orphaned. We demand the Government of India dismiss the Punjab government," he said.

Bhim Singh said the family will not cremate Jhota's body, and urged the public to assemble for a dharna in Mansa.

Police have mobilised units, including the CIA and counter-intelligence teams led by Bathinda Range Deputy Inspector General Harjeet Singh and Mansa Senior Superintendent of Police Vaibhav Chaudhary, to track down Kumar. "The shooting was carried out using a licensed pistol. We detained some family members of Kumar for questioning," the DIG said.

Jhota's counsel, Advocate Lakhwinder Singh Sidhu, said that the activist and his father had approached the Punjab and Haryana High Court in September 2023, seeking protection after facing threats from drug traffickers and local elements. According to the lawyer, the state government had opposed the petition by calling Jhota a habitual offender and arguing that there was no genuine threat to his life or property.

The murder drew widespread condemnation from political leaders, who questioned the law and order situation in the border state under the AAP government.

BJP national president Nitin Nabin said the incident exposed "the alarming state of law and order" in Punjab. He said, "The AAP came to power promising a drug-free Punjab. Today, those who stand up against drugs are themselves at risk. This is a serious failure of governance. If those fighting the drug mafia are not safe, who is safe in Punjab? The people of Punjab deserve answers and accountability."

Shiromani Akali Dal leader Bikram Singh Majithia asked Mann if anyone who dares to speak out will be killed. "People of Punjab, unite and demand answers and the resignation of this government!" he said.

Congress MP Amrinder Singh Raja Warring described Jhota's murder as a direct result of "failed law and order" and the AAP government's "failed anti-drug drive Yudh Nashyean Virudh". "Parvinder stood up against Punjab's drug menace, but the AAP government never supported his initiatives. His broad daylight murder exposes serious failures of the AAP government," Warring said.

AAP leader Baltej Pannu, however, promised strict action. "No one is permitted to take the law into their own hands. Strict action will be taken against the guilty," said Pannu.

BRIEFLY



Gujarat Deputy CM Harsh Sanghavi distributes the citizenship certificate to a woman at SAL Institute in Sola on Tuesday. PTI

GUJARAT

158 refugees receive citizenship certificates in Ahmedabad

GUJARAT DEPUTY Chief Minister Harsh Sanghavi on Tuesday presented Indian citizenship certificates to 158 refugees at a ceremony in Ahmedabad. Those who received the certificates comprised 126 beneficiaries under the Citizenship (Amendment) Act and 32 registered through the district collector's office. An amendment in the CAA empowered collectors to grant citizenship in seven states and Union Territories. Sanghavi thanked PM Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah for helping Hindu, Sikh, Buddhist, Jain and Parsi families who had faced religious persecution in Pakistan begin a new life in India. ENS

Honours for three IcfaiTech professors

IcfaiTECH, a constituent of the ICFAI Foundation for Higher Education (IFHE), Hyderabad, has achieved a significant milestone in research excellence with the recognition of its three professors in the prestigious Stanford–Elsevier World's Top 2% Scientists List 2026, the foundation said. Dr Sandeep Kumar Panda, Professor, IcfaiTech, has received this recognition for the third consecutive year, it added. The two other IcfaiTech professors who have joined the list are Dr Asisa Kumar Panigrahy and Dr Dileep Kumar Murala, the IFHE said. ENS

UP to top officers: Be at Kovind's book launch

THE UP government's Secretariat Administration Department has asked senior IAS officers to attend the launch of former President Ram Nath Kovind's book, directing them to ensure their presence "under all circumstances". Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath is slated to inaugurate the programme on Wednesday. The book, '*Bharatiya Ganatantra Ki Vijaygatha: Mera Jeevan, Mera Sangharsh*', authored by Kovind, is scheduled to be launched at 10.30 am. The book traces Kovind's journey from a village in Uttar Pradesh to the presidency. ENS

INAUGURAL EVENT

Sitaram Yechury Foundation invites students to send essay abstracts

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 13

THE SITARAM Yechury Foundation (SYF) has invited undergraduate and postgraduate students from across India to submit abstracts for essays on the broad theme of 'Imperialism in the Present Age'.

The abstracts, to be written in English and limited to 600 words, can address any aspect of the theme.

A committee constituted by the foundation will shortlist eight entries on merit. The selected students will then develop their proposals into 3,000-word essays and present their work at the Foundation's inaugural event on November 22. The last date for submitting abstracts is October 26.

The Foundation has also proposed publishing the eight essays as a book.

SYF, a not-for-profit registered trust established in memory of the late CPI(M) general secretary and parliamentarian, will hold its inaugural event at the East Zone Cultural Centre in Kolkata on November 22. The day-long programme will focus on the theme 'Imperialism Today'.

The trust is chaired by eminent economist Prabhat Patnaik. Journalist Seema Chishti, Yechury's wife, is its secretary and CPI(M) general secretary M A Baby, Asian College of Journalism, Chennai, Chairman Sashi Kumar and economist C P Chandrasekhar are its trustees.

KPSC jobs racket: SC allows Karnataka police to pick SIT chief

Express News Service
Bengaluru, October 13

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday modified a Karnataka High Court order of September 21 for a fresh probe by a police Special Investigation Team (SIT) of two cases of fraud in job recruitments by the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) — by leaving the onus of picking the SIT chief to the head of state police and reverting the case to the High Court.

A bench of Justice Manoj Misra and Justice Vijay Bishnoi modified the Karnataka high court order for 'de novo' investigations into KPSC recruitment frauds after the Karnataka government challenged the unilateral selection of members of the SIT and the direction for fresh investigations despite the state CID unit conducting a probe and carrying out arrests.

The SC in its order on Tuesday said that it "deems it appropriate to give liberty to the state to suggest the replacement of two members" of the SIT.

The Karnataka government had opposed the appointment of a DGP rank officer as the head of the SIT and had suggested a possible conflict of interest in the appointment of the directors of the state forensic sciences lab as a member of the SIT by the HC in its September 21 order.

"The state has suggested a change in composition of the Special Investigation Team by requiring the state DGP to nominate an officer not below the ADGP rank," the SC noted while modifying the High Court order.

The SC has said that the SIT should be constituted in 10 days and that Karnataka HC should subsequently review the constitution of the SIT. On October 1, the SC had stayed the September 21 decision of the Karnataka High Court to constitute a SIT comprising specific police officers to begin fresh investigations of two cases of recruitment frauds in the KPSC.

The Karnataka government has argued that the SIT was created by the HC without finding any fault with ongoing investigations of the KPSC scam by the CID unit. The two controversial cases in the KPSC which were registered in July were handed over to the CID unit of the Karnataka police in late July by the Congress government.

In the second case in which the SIT probe was ordered by the Karnataka HC the daughter of the suspended KPSC chairman Shivashankarappa Sahukar is accused of furnishing a fake income certificate of family earnings of Rs 40,000 per annum to be selected as an industrial extension officer in the State Industries Department under an OBC reservation category.

EXPRESS special

Siddaramaiah gets relief, sting video row simmers

Bengaluru court grants interim injunction on circulation of alleged sting video

Akram M
Bengaluru, October 13



Karnataka Congress leader & former CM Siddaramaiah

A DAY after senior Karnataka Congress leader and former chief minister Siddaramaiah moved a Bengaluru civil court to seek a stay on the broadcast of an alleged sting operation video about him, the court on Tuesday granted an interim injunction in this regard.

The court restrained certain media organisations and digital platforms from broadcasting or publishing allegedly defamatory content and viral videos linking Siddaramaiah.

The court's order came on the row, which has roiled state politics currently, even as Union Minister and JD(S) leader H D Kumaraswamy said that he would meet Union Home Minister Amit Shah to demand a CBI probe into this matter.

After filing a petition in the Additional City Civil and Sessions Court Monday, Siddaramaiah said, "There is false publicity against me on social media. I am seeking a stay."

In his plea, Siddaramaiah rejected the allegations concerning the video as false, calling it a politically-motivated move to tarnish his image.

The development came less than a week after Chief Minister D K Shivakumar warned his Cabinet colleagues of possible sting operations or traps to lure them and discredit the Congress-led government.

This had prompted Kumaraswamy to attack Shivakumar and seek a probe into alleged sting operations carried out in the state.

The purported sting video on social media, filmed in 2023, and broadcast by some local TV channels recently, is related to discussions about unverified incidents from 2011 when Siddaramaiah was the Leader of Opposition in the state Assembly during the B S Yediurappaled BJP government.

Speculations have made the rounds in state political circles as to whether the sting video was allegedly used as a leverage for a change of guard that saw Shivakumar replacing Siddaramiah as the CM in June this year.

Congress MLA and ex-minister K N Rajanna, considered close to Siddaramaiah, told reporters that the ex-CM had sought the stay "because of the sting operation". On whether it impacted the transition of power in the state, Rajanna said "It might have been (a factor). (It is) possible. We cannot rule out such possibilities."

Addressing a news conference Tuesday, Kumaraswamy alleged that four retired police officials were working to gather information about ministers through phone tapping. "This has started after Shivakumar became CM," he said, adding that "I am not saying that the CM has ordered the unit to be set up".

Hitting back at Kumaraswamy, Shivakumar said, "Time will answer" and that he would collect information about the sting operations and share it with the JD(S) leader.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

RSS-linked group wants Govt to block Starlink, cites security challenges

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, October 13

Referring to protests in the Capital, the Swadeshi Jagran Manch argued that Starlink's tech could make Internet curbs and security-related surveillance difficult

AT A time when protests against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar have put the national capital's law-and-order machinery under pressure, the RSS-affiliated Swadeshi Jagran Manch (SJM) on Tuesday asked the Government to block Elon Musk's Starlink from launching commercial satellite broadband services in India.

SJM argued that Starlink's technology could make Internet curbs and security-related surveillance difficult. "Currently, India is grappling with law-and-order challenges. In such situations, Internet-based social media often fuels rumours and anti-national narratives," SJM national co-convener Ashwani Mahajan said in a statement.

Mahajan further argued that disrupting Internet services is often essential to maintain law and order during "instances of separatism, terrorism, riots, protests, and similar events", and urged the Government not to grant Starlink permission to operate.

The demand comes days after Musk publicly targeted Reliance Industries chairman Mukesh Ambani over delays in Starlink's India launch. Musk first alleged "certain oligarchs" were blocking Starlink to preserve their "monopolistic chokehold" and subsequently asked on X, "Is Ambani the real boss of India?"

The Government rejected the allegation, saying its regulatory framework was "fair and non-discriminatory" and that suggestions of discriminatory treatment were "baseless and misconceived". Significantly, the Government has clarified that Starlink, Reliance Jio and Bharti-backed Eutelsat OneWeb have received licences, but must demonstrate compliance with security conditions before proceeding to spectrum assignment and commercial operations.

Security assessments of all three are underway and they are "broadly at the same regulatory stage", the Ministry of Communications has said. Union Minister for Communications Jyotiraditya Scindia said that the security clearances fell within the home ministry's domain.

SJM's statement assumes significance amid the ongoing protests in Delhi, where authorities have taken a series of preventive measures aimed at restricting mobilisation and maintaining public order. SJM contrasted Starlink's technology with existing telecom networks, arguing that incumbent operators can suspend or restrict internet services in specified areas when directed by the government and cooperate with security and investigating agencies.

Starlink's satellite architecture presented a particular challenge because its satellites can communicate with one another through laser links, allowing data to move between satellites before reaching a ground station, SJM further said.

As per the organisation, the Government must ensure that Internet traffic originating in India cannot bypass domestic gateways and that Starlink can precisely restrict its services in a specified geographical area if directed to do so during a security or law-and-order situation. "A key regulatory condition is that Starlink must be able to precisely restrict its services at the government's behest; however, Starlink has not committed to meet this requirement, or its technology may not permit it," SJM claimed.

It also alleged that Musk was trying to create public pressure on the Government.

DRONE STRUCK COMMERCIAL VESSEL 'MT PETRO DOLPHIN' IN OMAN ON SUNDAY

'Hoping for safe return': Kin of UP sailors missing after attack

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, October 13

ON SUNDAY morning, 21-year-old Preeti Singh received a message from her elder brother, Amit, 25, asking her to check whether his salary had been credited to his bank account.

She checked, it had not. She tried calling her brother but his phone was unreachable and her message went undelivered.

Worried, the family in Uttar Pradesh's Kushinagar contacted the shipping agent, company officials and Amit's colleagues and finally learnt the news — a drone had struck the commercial vessel, MT Petro Dolphin, on which Amit was working at Sohar Anchorage in Oman. Amit and another crew member, Veer Bahadur, from Deoria district, have been missing since the incident.

Just a day earlier, Amit had told his family he would be home for Diwali. "He spoke to his mother, Poonam Devi, on Saturday, telling her he would return home this month to celebrate the festival with us," said Amit's uncle Rajendra Singh, also in the Merchant Navy. "We are desperately hoping for good news and his safe return."

Amit, who is unmarried, went to sea for the first time in January this year after completing a General Purpose Rating course. He joined the vessel as an Able Seaman. "He had always wanted to join the merchant navy... like several members of our family who are in the profession," said Ravindra.



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Amit Singh was on board MT PETRO DOLPHIN, a commercial vessel, when the drone struck at Sohar Anchorage in Oman

He said when Preeti told him Amit's phone was unreachable, he sent a message but it went undelivered, prompting him to reach out to people in Oman for information. "I was told that the vessel had been stationed at Sohar Anchorage for days. On Sunday, all 12 crew members, 11 Indians and one Bangladeshi national, had been called aboard for maintenance work," he said. "Later, 10 crew members left the vessel to eat food. Amit and Veer Bahadur stayed back, telling the others that they would join them shortly. Then the drone struck."

Amit, from Gopalpur village, is the only son of farmer Dev Prakash Singh and Poonam.

The other missing crew member, Veer Bahadur Yadav (26), hails from Deoria's Barhaj area. His elder brother Mantu Yadav said that Veer was posted as a wiper and had joined the ship about five months ago.

"This was his first assignment. He used to talk to the family regularly, and the last time he spoke to us was on Saturday evening...," said Mantu, who works in Dubai and returned to India recently. He added that everyone in the house is worried about him and praying for his safe return.

Veer is unmarried and the youngest of four siblings. "The shipping company has informed me by email that efforts are being made to trace him. We are also requesting the government and other authorities for help," said Mantu.

The SHO of Barhaj police station, Vishal Kumar, said he had learnt about the missing youth from Badka village and has informed the district authorities.

Sunday's incident is the latest in a series of attacks on commercial vessels since the West Asia war broke out.

India on Monday condemned attacks on two ships with Indians on board in the Strait of Hormuz. "We condemn attacks on commercial vessels in the Strait of Hormuz region on 11 October 2026. MT Petro Dolphin was reportedly struck by a drone, with two of the 11 Indian seafarers onboard reported missing. MT Valthera, a Marshall Islands-flagged tanker, was struck by an unknown projectile, resulting in a fire onboard. All 11 Indian seafarers onboard MT Valthera are reported to be safe," the Government said.

Rs 15 lakh per acre land sold for Rs 3 cr per acre: ED flags Punjab cricket body land deal, seeks FIR

Express News Service
Chandigarh, October 13

TWO REAL-ESTATE developers bought agricultural land in a village in Punjab's Amritsar at around Rs 15 lakh an acre between August and November 2025 and sold the same the Punjab Cricket Association (PCA) in February 2026 for nearly Rs 3 crore an acre — a nearly 20-fold jump in a few months, it has been learnt. Subsequent land transactions between the same developers in the village, however, were recorded at Rs 31 lakh to Rs 33 lakh an acre in July 2026.

The transactions involving 19.5 acres, purchased by the PCA for a proposed sports facility, have now come under the scanner of investigating agencies with the Enforcement Directorate (ED) recommending the Punjab Police to register an FIR and probe the land deals.

"It is apparent that land acquired by the PCA was purchased by various individuals/entities shortly before and thereafter sold to PCA within a few months at multiple times their purchase price and that cognizable offences, including criminal conspiracy and cheating have been committed," the ED wrote to Mohali Senior Superintendent of Police Varun Sharma. "The information is being shared under Section 66(2) of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) for registration of an FIR, under appropriate sections...," the ED wrote.

The Indian Express analysed multiple sale deeds and subsequent mutations relating to the 19.5 acres in Bhalla village, as cited by the ED in its October 12 communication to the Mohali SSP. The same transaction details had earlier been obtained under the Right to Information Act by RTI activist Rajiv Vashisth.

The sequence of events raises questions about the timing of the purchases and the sharp escalation in the price paid by the PCA. On August 2, 2025, the PCA's apex committee met to discuss the purchase of land for a stadium in Amritsar. Five days later, on August 7, Future Homes bought 19.5 acres in Bhalla village from Kashmir Singh for Rs 2.95 crore (sale deed No. 1085). On August 20, the PCA issued an advertisement seeking land for a stadium.

On September 4, AGM Heights purchased 5.7 acres from Angrej Singh for Rs 86 lakh (sale deed No. 1221). On November 28, the company bought another two acres from Satwinder Singh and Sahibjeet Singh for a total of Rs 50 lakh (sale deed No. 1761).

On February 16, 2026, AGM Heights and Future Homes sold 19.5 acres of land to the PCA for Rs 58.22 crore through two sale deeds (Nos. 2324 and 2325). Four subsequent transactions between the two developers in Bhalla village on July 6 and 7 recorded prices ranging from Rs 31 lakh to Rs 33 lakh an acre.

Former first-class Ranji cricketer Rakesh Handa moved the Punjab and Haryana High Court, alleging irregularities in the land purchase by the PCA management. His petition raised questions over the purchase of 18.5 acres in Bathinda and 19.5 acres in Amritsar. He also alleged that mandatory approvals from the PCA Governing Body or its Annual General Meeting had not been obtained for these purchases.

On August 18, 2026, the High Court issued notices to the ED and the PCA management, seeking their response. On Tuesday, the matter came up for hearing again, and the ED submitted its preliminary investigation report.

PCA president Amarjit Singh Mehta said the land had been purchased following the advertisement issued by the association in August 2025 and that any interested landowner could have approached it.

PRIME MINISTER LIKELY TO VISIT CANADA IN DECEMBER

Economic pact to tech on agenda, Modi speaks to Canada's Carney

Canadian Foreign Minister Anita Anand to meet Jaishankar today

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, October 13



Prime Minister Narendra Modi



Canada PM Mark Carney

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi spoke to his Canadian counterpart Mark Carney on Tuesday and discussed "trade, energy, technology, security and defence".

The two leaders reaffirmed their commitment to conclude negotiations on a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) at the earliest opportunity, supporting efforts to double two-way trade by 2030.

After the phone conversation, PM Modi posted on X: "Had a warm and productive conversation with Prime Minister Mark Carney. We agreed to build on the positive momentum in India-Canada ties and work towards concrete outcomes across key areas of our Strategic Partnership, including trade, energy, technology, security and people-to-people ties."

"Together, India and Canada are contributing towards a more stable and prosperous world," he said, tagging Carney.

The Canadian PM's office said, "The prime ministers welcomed the increased engagement between Canada and India over the past year, including in areas such as finance, defence and security, people-to-people ties, and artificial intelligence. They underscored the opportunity to build on this renewed momentum."

"To that end, the leaders reaffirmed their commitment to conclude negotiations on a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement at the earliest opportunity, supporting efforts to double two-way trade by 2030. They welcomed the historic Team Canada Trade Mission currently taking place in India, led by the Minister of International Trade, Maninder Sidhu, as well as a visit to New Delhi this week by the Minister of Foreign Affairs, Anita Anand, to advance shared priorities, including trade, energy, and people-to-people ties," the Canadian PMO said.

It also said that the leaders discussed the "impacts of geopolitical instability for the Indo-Pacific region and the need for trusted partners in the areas of energy and agriculture. Prime Minister Carney thanked Prime Minister Modi for his leadership in seeking a peaceful resolution to Russia's war on Ukraine".

"The prime ministers welcomed the bilateral security dialogue that took place in India last week as part of ongoing security and law enforcement engagement at the national security advisor level," it said.

According to the Canadian PMO, the leaders agreed to remain in close contact ahead of PM Modi's visit to Canada in December. Modi and Carney had met on the sidelines of the G7 Summit in Evian, France, in June this year.

The two Canadian ministers, Maninder Sidhu and Anita Anand, are in India this week to prepare for PM Modi's visit in December and conclude the trade pact, as Delhi is considering inviting PM Carney as a possible chief guest for the Republic Day Parade in 2027.

Sources said Anand will hold a bilateral meeting with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, while Sidhu will meet Union Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal.

Modi is expected to visit Canada just before his likely visit to the US to attend the 21st G20 Leaders' Summit on December 14–15 at the Trump National Doral Miami resort in Florida.

Anand and Sidhu are expected to speed up negotiations for the trade pact between India and Canada, pushing the process closer to signing.

This is a huge turnaround in India-Canada bilateral ties, which took a severe hit after Carney's predecessor Justin Trudeau alleged in September 2023 that Indian government agents were involved in the killing of Khalistan separatist Hardeep Singh Nijjar. India rejected the charges, calling them "politically motivated" and "absurd".

No gutka, pan masala allowed in Uttarakhand now; FDA prohibits sale for next one year

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, October 13

THE UTTARAKHAND government has prohibited the manufacture, storage, distribution and sale of gutka, pan masala and other food products containing tobacco or nicotine across the state for one year.

The order issued by Uttarakhand FDA commissioner Vinay Shankar Pandey invokes the provisions of the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006, in the interest of public health.

Section 30(2)(a) of the Act empowers a state Food Safety Commissioner to prohibit the manufacture, storage, distribution or sale of any food article across the state for up to one year, if necessary in the interest of public health.

Explaining the rationale for the prohibition, the order states: "Since tobacco and nicotine are being used as ingredients in gutka and pan masala, and a large quantity of tobacco and nicotine is being used as ingredients in food products, it is necessary, in the interest of public health, to prohibit (them)."



Future Ready

Indigenous multi-purpose vessel Samarthak, fitted with weapons and electronic systems specifically optimised for operations in challenging maritime environment, is set to be commissioned into the Navy at Karwar naval base in Karnataka on October 16. The first of four such vessels, it will mark another significant milestone in India's drive towards defence self-reliance and the vessel will form an "important component of the Navy's future and ideal 'utility' ship for strategically important operations", the Defence Ministry said. PTI

11 minors die as boat capsizes in Ganga in Bihar's Vaishali dist

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, October 13

AT LEAST 11 minors, mostly teenagers, died after a boat overturned in the Ganga in Bihar's Vaishali district on Tuesday evening.

Seven people, including the boat owner, were rescued, while several others were reported missing in the incident that took place near Rampur Shyamchand village, officials said.

The accident took place in the Raghopur Diara area when the boat was carrying people between two villages along the river. Most of the passengers were reportedly on their way to attend a feast in a nearby village.

The number of people aboard the boat remained unclear.

While initial reports suggested that between 25 and 30 people were travelling on the vessel, a district administration official said the owner had claimed 15-20 passengers were present.

Officials said the boat capsized after losing its balance.

Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary expressed grief over the deaths and announced compensation of Rs 4 lakh for the family of each victim.

In a post on X, Choudhary said the deaths were "extremely sad and heartbreaking".

The CM said the administration had been instructed to expedite rescue and relief operations and ensure better treatment for the injured.

Tejashwi Yadav, the Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) working president, Leader of the Opposition in the Bihar Assembly and MLA from Raghopur, also expressed grief over the incident. Yadav, who was in Delhi in connection with a protest against the Chief Election Commissioner, shared a video on X.

SC stays defamation trial against Rahul over remarks on PM

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 13

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday stayed the trial in the defamation case against Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi over his comments calling Prime Minister Narendra Modi "choro ke sardar (head of thieves)" and "commander-in-thief" in 2018 over the Rafale fighter jet deal.

Hearing the Congress leader's appeal challenging a September 8 Bombay High Court order refusing to quash the defamation case, a bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Aparesh Kumar Singh issued notice to the Maharashtra government and sought its reply in four weeks.

Gandhi had challenged a Mumbai magistrate's August 2019 order to initiate proceedings against him on a complaint that the remarks had "hurt the sentiments of PM Modi's supporters". The high court found no "manifest illegality" in the magistrate's order, which was issued following BJP member Mahesh Shrishrimal's complaint.

"On a prima facie reading of the defamatory statement, inter alia describes the Prime Minister, who is also the prominent face of the said political party, as having engaged in the acts of theft, while being the Commander of Thieves. Therefore, at this threshold stage, it cannot be said that the alleged defamatory imputation is incapable of extending to those clearly identified with the party and its leadership, including its office bearers," Justice N R Borkar of the Bombay HC had held.

The bench also held that whether the allegations affected only the prime minister or also other BJP members depended on the evidence and must be decided by the trial court, not the high court.

"For the aforesaid reasons, and in the absence of any manifest illegality or perversity in the impugned order, it is not a fit case for interference in exercise of inherent jurisdiction under Section 482 of the CrPC. This court finds no infirmity in the impugned order," the high court had said.

Rs 8-crore gold vanishes in 12 minutes from Gujarat showroom ahead of launch

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, October 13

IT TOOK just 12 minutes for 5.5 kg of gold jewellery worth Rs 8.28 crore to disappear on Sunday from a showroom in Gujarat's Vadodara city that was set to be inaugurated. The consignment had arrived for the proposed inauguration ahead of Dussehra. By the time a Mumbai-based company's sales manager returned from a washroom break, two bags of gold were gone.

The police filed a case of cheating and criminal breach of trust at the Bapod police station following a complaint by Himanshu Jain, a sales manager with Yugan Gold Private Limited, which operates from Zaveri Bazaar in Mumbai. Four teams have been formed to trace the businessman named in the complaint and two unidentified men allegedly seen carrying away the jewellery.

According to Jain's complaint, he handles the supply of gold ornaments to jewellery merchants across Gujarat and collects payments for his company. Jain told the police that he had been conducting business with the main accused, Bhavikkumar Soni, who runs a jewellery shop in Dakor, since 2017.

Soni allegedly told Jain that he had opened a new showroom, Shri Ambika Jewellers, at Sai Ganesh Complex near Zavernagar on Waghodia Road in Vadodara city. He subsequently sent a list of ornaments required for the showroom's proposed inauguration ahead of Dussehra.

Acting on the order, Jain arrived in Vadodara on Sunday with approximately 5.5 kg of gold jewellery valued at Rs 8.28 crores, the complaint states. The incident occurred while the jewellery was being displayed at the showroom. According to the complaint, Soni and Jain's brother, Neil, left the premises for lunch, while Soni assured them that the two bags containing the gold would remain safe. They locked the shop from outside before leaving. Jain, meanwhile, went towards the washroom.

Unlocked shop, missing gold

When he returned about 12 minutes later, Jain found the shop unlocked. A check inside revealed that both bags containing the gold jewellery had disappeared, although other ornaments remained at the premises. The CCTV footage from the area allegedly shows two unidentified men arriving on a blue two-wheeler and leaving with the bags. The police are examining the footage to identify the men and establish how they gained access to the showroom.

The complaint has also raised questions about Soni's whereabouts after the incident. According to the account given to the police, Soni, who had gone out with Neil Jain, had subsequently complained of dizziness and excused himself while his mobile phone was switched off.

Pre-planned operation suspicion

G B Babhaniya, Assistant Commissioner of Police, said, "We suspect that the order for a large quantity of gold, ostensibly for a new showroom opening ahead of Dussehra, may have been part of a pre-planned operation."

"The four police teams are using CCTV footage and technical surveillance to trace the suspects and have begun raids at various locations. We are working to piece together the sequence of events leading to the disappearance of the consignment and determine the roles of those involved."

Umar Khalid support cited as reason for Goa police denying protest permission

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, October 13

DENYING PERMISSION to Cockroach Janata Party protesters to gather inside Azad Maidan in Panaji on Sunday, the Goa police cited "past history of protesters violating conditions imposed by the authorities" and a specific instance of a protester "patronising Umar Khalid" during the NEET-related protest at the same venue in July, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Khalid, an activist and a former JNU student, is facing charges of criminal conspiracy under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act in connection with the 2020 Northeast Delhi riots.

Seven protesters were detained from Azad Maidan on Sunday evening. The protest was organised by a CJP affiliate in Goa to demand the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

After a habeas corpus petition was filed seeking their release, the High Court of Bombay at Goa on Sunday night directed the police to release all of them, observing that "the detention may not have been authorised".

The organisers had applied for permission from the authorities on October 7. An order by the office of the District Magistrate, North Goa, dated October 9, addressed to the organisers, stated that the permission sought for public assembly at Azad Maidan on October 11 has been rejected "based on the report of the Superintendent of Police North, wherein the permission is not recommended for public assembly..."

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

HOSPITAL AUTHORITIES ATTRIBUTE DEATHS TO PREMATURE BIRTHS, LOW-BIRTH WEIGHT AND COMPLICATIONS AMONG CRITICALLY ILL INFANTS; MLA ALLEGES NEGLIGENCE

80 newborn deaths at Madhya Pradesh hospital in 6 months, BJP MLA calls for probe

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, October 13

AT LEAST 80 infants have died at the Special Newborn Care Unit (SNCU) of the district hospital in Madhya Pradesh's Seoni over a six-month period, with the local BJP MLA calling for an investigation into the mortalities.

While hospital authorities have attributed the deaths to premature births, low-birth weight and complications among critically ill infants, BJP MLA Dinesh Rai Munmun on Tuesday alleged that doctors were unavailable at night to attend to the patients.

Civil Surgeon Dr Vinod Kumar Navkar said the SNCU receives critically ill newborns referred from remote rural areas across the district.

"Many a times, these babies are born at six, seven or eight months. They have complications and require specialised care," Navkar said.

He said the risk of death was particularly high among premature and low-birth-weight infants.

"According to the World Health Organization (WHO) and Government of India data, a baby's normal birth weight should be 2.5 kg. When a baby is born prematurely and weighs less than this, the mortality rate can be as high as 48 per cent," he said.

Navkar also cited complications during labour and delivery.

Navkar said the district hospital had treated 1,188 newborns over the preceding six months, of whom 642 – more than half – had a birth weight below normal. He said 582 infants with substantially low birth weight had received treatment, including babies weighing 1,100 grams, 900 grams and even 500 grams.

Hospital officials said approximately 34 deaths took place between April and June, followed by 46 deaths between July and September.

Defending the hospital's performance, Navkar said the neonatal mortality rate at the SNCU was below 7.5 per cent and lower than that of other districts in the Jabalpur division. He referred to 10% as a recommended mortality benchmark for neonatal units.

Navkar also flagged the need for greater support from the paediatrics department of the medical college attached to the district hospital. He said the hospital had sought assistance from the department but the required duty arrangements had not been made.

The hospital's explanation comes amid allegations by families that their newborns did not receive adequate or timely treatment.

Manish Warkade, a resident of Dungariya village in Barghat block, alleged that his wife did not receive timely attention after being admitted to the hospital in July. He said, "She (his wife) had been referred from Barghat to Seoni. The newborn died after being admitted to the SNCU."

Sanjay Uikey, a resident of Jawarkathi, said his wife was referred to Seoni after developing complications during pregnancy. The baby was born in the seventh month and weighed around 1.6 kg, he said. Doctors told the family that the newborn's heartbeat was weak. "After several days in the SNCU, the baby was shifted to another machine and died a few hours later," Uikey said.

Rai told *The Indian Express* that he decided to conduct a surprise inspection after receiving complaints about doctors' absence, allegations of demands for money from the patients, and a high number of infant deaths.

Rai said when he arrived at the hospital, the outsourced staff there initially attempted to stop him from entering the premises, telling him that a departmental inquiry was under way and an audit was being conducted.

According to Rai, no doctor was present at the time of his visit.

"Forty-six children died because of difficulty in breathing. The hospital has a ventilator for children who have difficulty breathing, and a doctor is supposed to be appointed for this. But the doctor does not remain there at night. The nurses are not trained for this work," Rai alleged.

"Tell me, who goes to a district hospital? Poor people. If these children are dying because of doctors' negligence, criminal action should be taken against those responsible," he said.

Rai also questioned the administration's contention that the hospital's infant mortality rate was lower than that of other districts. He argued that the recorded deaths might not reflect the full extent of the problem because critically ill newborns were being referred elsewhere.

Waqf bats for uniform sermons in J&K mosques, climbs down after backlash

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, October 13

THE WAQF board's idea of a uniform sermon in Jammu and Kashmir mosques on Fridays and other important religious occasions has triggered a backlash in the Valley.

In a video of the board's meeting held on Saturday, discussions could be heard about constitution of a committee of imams and senior religious scholars to choose topics for the uniform sermons.

However, after the discussions sparked outrage, Waqf board chairperson Darakshan Andrabi said on Tuesday that no such directions were passed. "The move was discussed by imams and religious scholars associated with the Waqf, who should be allowed to function independently," she said.

CM Omar Abdullah posted on X: "This is an unacceptable attempt by the BJP to interfere in the religious affairs of Muslims and will not be accepted under any circumstances. The BJP-appointed chairperson must immediately halt this misplaced attempt to please her masters."

Former J&K CM Mehbooba Mufti questioned the rationale behind such directives. In a video statement, she said that Friday sermons are primarily shaped by the issues and circumstances confronting a particular region or locality, while also addressing wider social and national concerns. Imposing a uniform template on these sermons, she said, disregards the diversity of local realities and the role of religious scholars in guiding their communities.

Drawing parallels with the BJP's push for a Uniform Civil Code (UCC), Mufti said opposition to such measures stems from the concern that uniformity cannot be imposed on a diverse society without disregarding its distinct religious practices, customs and traditions. "India's strength lies in its pluralism, where different communities have freedom to follow their respective faiths and traditions, and not in forcing them into a single framework."

Kashmir's head cleric Mirwaiz Umar Farooq also expressed displeasure at the proposed move. The Muttahida Majlis-e-Ulema (MMU) Jammu & Kashmir, a representative amalgam of leading religious and socio-religious organisations of the Union Territory, headed by Mirwaiz said on Tuesday that even the suggestion that a statutory body could determine or regulate what is to be preached from the mimbar (pulpit) is "ridiculous, and will never be accepted by the Muslims of Jammu and Kashmir."

Issuing a clarification during a press conference on Tuesday, Waqf chief Andrabi cautioned political parties against "politicising" the board in J&K. "This isn't about politics. The decision on the contents of Friday sermons is up to the imams themselves. I head a religious body and our contention is that we should be able to discuss issues and concerns of our society," she said.

BIMSTEC HOME MINISTERS' MEETING

Should ensure that terror networks are not allowed safe havens: Shah

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 13



Union Home Minister Amit Shah during the first BIMSTEC Home Ministers' meeting in New Delhi on Tuesday. PTI

INDIA ON Tuesday hosted the first meeting of BIMSTEC Home Ministers here under the chairmanship of Union Home Minister Amit Shah, with the seven member states adopting the Delhi Declaration and approving a clutch of pacts to tighten cooperation against terrorism, drug trafficking, human trafficking and illicit financial flows.

The meeting, preceded by a senior officials' gathering led by the Union Home Secretary, was attended by delegations from all seven BIMSTEC member states – Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka and Thailand.

Addressing the meeting, Shah described BIMSTEC as an essential platform for regional integration, economic cooperation and collective security.

Carrying forward Prime Minister Narendra Modi's formulation at the 6th BIMSTEC Summit in Bangkok on April 4, 2025 – "For us, BIMSTEC is not just a regional organisation. It is a model for our inclusive development and security" – Shah said it was now the responsibility of Home Ministers "to translate our cooperation into practical mechanisms that strengthen the safety of our citizens and the capabilities of our agencies."

Reiterating India's Zero Tolerance policy towards terrorism, the Home Minister called for enhanced cooperation against cross-border organised crime, drug trafficking and human trafficking, as well as emerging cyber threats, stressing timely intelligence sharing, financial investigations, mutual legal assistance and extradition so that criminals and terrorists are brought to justice.

"Our shared resolve should be to ensure that terrorist networks are not allowed to find safe havens, recruit members, provide training, raise funds, or carry out activities against neighbouring countries from any part of the region," Shah said, adding that cooperation in mutual legal assistance and extradition, in accordance with national laws and applicable treaties, could strengthen efforts to bring criminals to justice.

He identified five priority areas – drug control, counter-terrorism and legal cooperation, repatriation of fugitive criminals, cyber-security and cybercrime investigations, and institutional cooperation and capacity building – and underlined the need for a coordinated regional approach.

On narcotics, Shah said drug trafficking was essentially death trafficking. "This is not merely the drug trade, but an attack on the lives of our youth, society, culture, and the future of coming generations," he said, arguing that no single country could tackle it alone and that a regional approach was needed.

Shah also said that the BIMSTEC Disaster Management Centre – planned in Jamnagar, Gujarat – underscores India's role as a first responder in the region, and urged member countries to participate actively in making it operational. "The security of one member state strengthens the security of the entire region," Shah said.

IRCON INTERNATIONAL LIMITED
NAVRATNA COMPANY
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
Website: www.ircon.org, CIN - L45203DL1976GOI008171

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST Tender ID: 2026_IRCON_294195_1
Ref. No.: IRCON/BD/NHAI/Ujjain_Jhalawa/Pkg-1&2/2026 Dt.: 12.10.2026
Expression of Interest (EOI) invited for association as JV Partner from Experienced Agencies for 1. Construction of 4-Lanning of Ujjain-Jhalawar Section of NH-552G from Ch.0.000 Village Khilchipura to Ch.86.500 Village Aakli-Kadiya (Package-1) in the State of Madhya Pradesh on Engineering Procurement & Construction (EPC) Mode under NH(O) through an Engineering, Procurement and Construction (EPC) Contract & 2. Construction of 4-Lanning of Ujjain-Jhalawar Section of NH-552G from Ch.86.500 Village Aakli-Kadiya to Ch. 159.263 Jhalawar (Junction with NH52) (Package-2) in the State of Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan on Engineering Procurement & Construction (EPC) Mode under NH(O) through an Engineering, Procurement and Construction (EPC) Contract.
For further details and updates, please visit tender section on IRCON's website www.ircon.org & www.etenders.gov.in. Amendments/Corrigendum, if any, would be hosted on the website only.
Chief General Manager/Business Development

IRCON INTERNATIONAL LIMITED
NAVRATNA COMPANY
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
Website : www.ircon.org, CIN - L45203DL1976GOI008171

e-Procurement Notice
e-Tender No.: IRCON/e-Tender/B1100009/MSME/TC/IE/ET-65 Dated : 09.10.2026
On behalf of Ircon International Limited, tenders are invited from bidders meeting qualifying requirements for "Independent Engineer Services for Development of MSME Technology Centres at 20 Locations across India under the Scheme "Establishment of New Technology Centres/Extension Centres."

Estimated Cost of the Work	Rs. 7,89,40,500/- (including GST)		
Tender Document Fee	Rs. 20,000/-	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Rs. 15.79 Lakh
Completion Period: 24 months (During Construction period-18 months, During DLP period-6 months)			

Tender Documents will be available on e-tender portal website https://etenders.gov.in/eprocure/app w.e.f. 14.10.2026 and last date of submission of above tenders is 04.11.2026 upto 15.00 hrs. Corrigendum, if any, would be hosted only on the website.
Executive Director/VME
C-4, District Centre, Saket, New Delhi-110017, email - masood.ahmad@ircon.org

कार्यपालक अभियंता (यांत्रिक) का कार्यालय
सिंचाई यांत्रिक प्रमंडल मोहनियाँ
(Email: imd.mohania@gmail.com)
बिहार सरकार
शुद्धि पत्र
प्रमंडलीय कार्यालय द्वारा विज्ञापित कार्य (बहुआरा पंप कैनाल परियोजना के जीर्णोद्धार कार्य) हेतु पत्रांक 727 दिनांक 16.09.2026द्वारा आमंत्रित ई० कोटेशन आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या–11/2026–27 जिसका PR No.012035(W R D) 2026–27 है, को अपरिहार्य कारणों से निम्नवत् संशोधित किया जाता है –

विवरण	पूर्व में अंकित सूचना	संशोधित सूचना
कंडिका संख्या–1 (कार्य का विवरण) में कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	12 महीने।	06 महीने।
कंडिका संख्या– 3 कोटेशन कामजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की अवधि	दिनांक 16.10.2026 से दिनांक 27.10.2026 के 3.00 बजे अपराह्न तक	दिनांक: 22.10.2026 से दिनांक 31.10.2026 के 3.00 बजे अपराह्न तक
कंडिका संख्या– 4प्री–बिड मीटिंग का समय, स्थान एवं तिथि	दिनांक–22.10.2026के 4.00 बजे अपराह्न में, मुख्य अभियंता (यांत्रिक) का कार्यालय, जल संसाधन विभाग, पटना।	दिनांक–28.10.2026 के 4.00 बजे अपराह्न में, मुख्य अभियंता (यांत्रिक) का कार्यालय,जल संसाधन विभाग, पटना।
कंडिका संख्या–5 तकनीकी बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक: 30.10.2026 समय 3.30 बजे अपराह्न।	दिनांक: 02.11.2026 समय 3.30 बजे अपराह्न।

शेष नियम एवं शर्तें यथावत रहेंगी।
कार्यपालक अभियंता (याँ.)
सिंचाई यांत्रिक प्रमण्डल, मोहनियाँ
मो. 91–8285653609
PR- 013576 (WRD) 2026-27
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

Bihar Medical Services & Infrastructure Corporation Limited, Patna
A Govt. of Bihar Undertaking
2nd & 3rd Floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura, Bihar, Patna
Phone: - +91 612 2283289, Fax: - +91 612 2283289
Govt. of Bihar
निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या–BMSICL/Infra/14/2026
बिहार चिकित्सा सेवाएँ एवं आधारभूत संरचना निगम लिमिटेड, पटना द्वारा निम्न कार्यों हेतु प्रतिशत/मद दर निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। कोई भी संवेदक जो केन्द्रीय/राज्य सरकार/लोक उपक्रम के किसी भी श्रेणी में निबंधित हो, निविदा में भाग ले सकते हैं, परंतु उक्त कार्य का लेटर ऑफ एक्सेप्टेंस प्राप्त होने के पश्चात एवं एकरारनामा के पूर्व BMSICL में निबंधन कराना अनिवार्य होगा:–

क्रम संख्या	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख में)	अग्रधन की राशि (लाख में)	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य (रू० में)	बिड प्रोसेसिंग शुल्क (रू० में)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1.	मुंगेर जिला अंतर्गत अनुमंडलीय अस्पताल, तारापुर के मरम्मति कार्य।	250.02	05	11,800/–	As per Eproc-2	3 माह

2. निविदा समय–सारणी (Tender Schedule)

SL No.	Activity	Date & Time
1.	Start Date of Bid Submission	From 22/10/2026, 11:00 AM on https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
2.	Last Date of Bid Submission	Up to 11 /11/2026, 05:00 PM on https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
3.	Pre-Bid Meeting Date, Time & Place	On 28/10/2026, 11;00 AM in 3rd Floor Conference Hall of BMSICL, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura, Bihar, Patna
4.	Technical Bid Opening Date	12/11/2026, 03:30 PM on https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
5.	Financial Bid Opening Date	To be announced later
6.	Tender Bid Validity	120 Days (As Per SBD Provision)

निविदा की विस्तृत शर्त वेबसाईट https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर देखी जा सकती है।
मुख्य महाप्रबंधक (परियोजना)
BMSICL, पटना
PR- 013637 (B & C) 2026-27
For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

Govt. of Bihar
GOVERNMENT ENGINEERING COLLEGE, SHEOHAR
Chhatauna, Bisunpur, Block-Piprahi, Sheohar, Bihar Pin Code-843327
E-MAIL ID: sce.sheohar@gmail.com
Tender Ref. No.- GECS/26-27/03
Requirement of Electrical & Electronics Engineering lab Equipment's
Government Engineering College, Sheohar has been constituted under the Department of Science, Technology and Technical Education, Government of Bihar to cater to the needs of technical education. The Government Engineering College, Sheohar intended to invite bids from eligible entities **Requirement of Electrical &Electronics Engineering labEquipments**in the institute Premises as mentioned in the tender document.
Bidder may download the tender documents (System Tender no: 141392/ College Tender no: GECS/26-27/03) available on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in from 12/10/2026 and submit the tender by using the downloaded document, on or before 03/11/2026 upto 4:00 PM.Least Cost Selection (LCS) method will be adopted for each group of Machines and Equipments forElectrical &Electronics Engineering lab Equipments. The tender shall be accompanied by a Non-Refundable Tender Cost: Rs. 3000/- (Three Thousand only) through Online mode and by Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of Rs 1,17,000/- (One Lakh Seventeen thousand only) through offline modein the shape of Demand Draft from any Schedule Bank in favour of Principal Government Engineering College, Sheohar on or before 03/11/2026 upto 4:00 PM Through Speed Post/ Registered Post only. The bidders shall submit their eligibility and qualification details, certificates as mentioned in the tender document. Last date of submission of Bid is 03/11/2026upto 04:00 PM.
The technical and financial bids must be submitted through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in before the date and time specified in the tender document, the processing fee may be applicable as per www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in The Government Engineering College, Sheohar doesn't take any responsibility for the delay/ Non-Submission of Tender/ Non-Reconciliation of online Payment caused due to Non-availability of Internet connection, Network Traffic/ Holidays or any other reason.
Note: Interested bidders may obtain further information about this Notice inviting Tender (NIT) from Institute website. No tender will be accepted after closing date and time in any circumstances.
Principal
Government Engineering College, Sheohar
PR- 013548 (Sci & Tech) 2026-27
नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

DIRECTORATE OF TOURISM
1st Floor, 1st Floor, B Block, Extension Bhawan, Main Secretariat, Patna 800015
Phone – 0612-2217045; E-mail – dir-tourism-bih@nic.in
Govt. of Bihar
Short Term Tender Notice
Request for Proposal for Selection of agency GRANT OF LICENSE FOR NAKHAS KSHETRA OF SONEPUR MELA 2026

Department Name	Directorate of Tourism, Bihar.
Name of work	INVITATION FOR GRANT OF LICENSES OF NAKHAS KSHETRA FOR ALLOTMENT TO PRIVATE PARTIES FOR SETTING UP STALLS AND OTHER ACTIVITIES IN SONEPUR MELA 2026
Event Duration	22 November to 23 December, 2026
Tender Currency Settings	Indian rupees (INR)
Joint Venture/Consortium	Not Allowed
Bid Document Fee	Rs. 10,000/- (Rupees Ten Thousand Only) Non-refundable, payable vide Bank Demand Draft with the Bid.
Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 10,00,000/- (Rupees Ten Lakhs Only), Refundable, payable vide Bank Demand Draft with the Bid.
Bid Document Fee/EMD in favour of	Director, Tourism, payable at Patna
Portal for Downloading Tender	https://tourism.bihar.gov.in
Date & Place of Pre-Bid Meeting	21.10.2026 at 11.30 AM Directorate of Tourism, 1st Floor, B Block, Extension Bhawan, Main Secretariat, Patna-800015
Last Date & Time for Receipt (Submission) of Bids	26/10/2026 at 11.00 AM
Date and Time of Opening Technical Bid	26/10/2026 at 12.00 AM
Date and Time of Opening of Financial Bid	To be informed later
Bid Validity Period	120 days
Submission of Bids	Directorate of Tourism, 1st Floor, B Block, Extension Bhawan, Main Secretariat, Patna-800015
Phone	0612-2217045
Officer Inviting Bids	Director, Directorate of Tourism, 1st Floor, B Block, Extension Bhawan, Main Secretariat, Patna-800015

Sd/-
Director Tourism
PR- 013627 (Tourism) 2026-27
For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

IAS officer, 3 others booked for assaulting cops at Bengaluru pub

Express News Service
Bengaluru, October 13

AN IAS officer from Andhra Pradesh and three others were booked for allegedly assaulting and threatening police personnel and obstructing them from discharging their duties during a late-night inspection at a Bengaluru pub on October 10.

An FIR was registered against the IAS officer, Vikas Marmat, serving as special officer of the Kuppam Area Development Authority, and three others — Abhay Uday Singh, Nitish and Roshan, at the Cubbon Park police station. The complaint was filed by inspector Arun Salunke of Central Crime Branch's Special Enquiry Wing.

National Fertilizers Limited
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
Vijaipur Unit, Dist. Guna (MP)-473111
(An ISO-9001,14001 & OHSAS 18001 Unit)
A Navratna Company
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
NFL Vijaipur invites online GeM bidding in Two Part Bid System for GeM ID No. GEM/2026/B/8088252 for **"ARC for Miscellaneous Mechanical Maintenance Jobs for 2026-27"**. Submission of tenders documents of last date is 26.**10.2026, 18.00 PM.** For further details and downloading of Tender Documents visit websites:http://gem.gov.in, http://nationalfertilizers.com. For any clarification, please intimate on: **skrai@nfl.co.in**, Mob.9463834587. Any amendment/ modification to the NIT will be displayed only on above websites. Bidders are advised to visit the above websites regularly.

डॉ0 भीमराव आंबेडकर विश्वविद्यालय, आगरा
(पूर्ववर्ती: आगरा विश्वविद्यालय, आगरा)
Website: dbrau.ac.in, Email: registrar.dbrau@dbrau.ac.in
पत्रांकः प्रशा0/जेम/567/2026 दिनांकः 12/10/2026
GeM Bid Notice
डॉ.भीमराव आंबेडकर विश्वविद्यालय, आगरा हेतु एक **स्मार्ट मोबाइल मेडिकल यूनिट** (चिकित्सा वैन) क्रय करने हेतु जेम पोर्टल पर कस्टम बिड संख्याः **GEM/2026/B/8135693** अपलोड की गयी है। इच्छुक एवं पात्र निविदादाता/एजेंसियां नियत तिथि तक उक्त बिड में प्रतिभाग कर सकते हैं। **कुलसचिव**

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HVPNL	NIET NO. 04/XEN/TS/MNS/2026-27 DATE: 07.10.2026 FOR THE WORK OF REPAIRING THE DAMAGES OF 220KV 1000SQMM XLPE POWER CABLE B PHASE GIS TERMINATION CABLE SEALING END AND ATTENDING SF-6 GAS LEAKAGE IN D06 BAY AND REFILLING OF 1000SQMM GIS INDOOR CABLE TERMINATION OF 220KV GIS TRANSPORT HUB TO MAU CKT.-2 BAY AT 220KV GIS SUBSTATION, TRANSPORT HUB, MANESAR TENDER ID- 2026_HBC_552693_1.	07.10.2026 03.11.2026	322.18 LACS	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
2	HVPNL	SPECIAL ESTIMATE TO CREATE 132KV BAY FOR FEEDING ADDITIONAL 20/25MVA 132KV T/F AT 132KV S/STN. BEER BY HVPNL IN 1ST HALF OF 2024-25. DISTRICT NAME - HISAR	07.10.2026 22.10.2026	10,38,469/-	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
3	HVPNL	SPECIAL ESTIMATE FOR AUGMENTATION OF 132 KV S/STN. JAKHAL FROM 1X20/25MVA, 132/33KV PLUS (1X16/20 PLUS 1X10/16) MVA, 132/11KV T/FS TO 2X20/25MVA, 132/33KV PLUS (1X16/20 PLUS 1X10/16) MVA, 132/11KV T/FS FOR THE YEAR 2025-26. DISTRICT NAME - HISAR	08.10.2026 22.10.2026	14,02,802/-	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
4	HVPNL	SPECIAL ESTIMATE FOR AUGMENTATION OF 132 KV SUBSTATION BHATTU KALAN FROM 1X20/25 MVA, 132/33KV PLUS (1X10/16 PLUS 1X16/20) MVA, 132/11KV T/FS TO 2X20/25 MVA, 132/33KV PLUS (1X30/16 PLUS 1X16/20) MVA, 132/11KV TFS AT 132KV S/STN. BHATTU KALAN BY HVPNL FOR REDUNDANCY IN 1ST HALF OF FY 2024-25. DISTRICT NAME - HISAR	08.10.2026 22.10.2026	10,00,469/-	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
5	HVPNL	SITE SURFACE DRESSING, PCC, SUPPLY AND SPREADING OF GRAVELS AT ONE NO. THE 132KV BUS COUPLER BAY B-7 AT 132KV SUBSTATION RAJOUND. (DISTRICT KAITHAL)	08.10.2026 15.10.2026	4,19,806/-	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
6	HVPNL	REPAIR AND MTC OF CEILING AND WALL PLASTER, REPLACEMENT OF CHOWKHATS AND DOORS AND WHITE WASH OF QUARTERS AT 220/132KV S/STN PHC HVPNL KARNAL.	09.10.2026 21.10.2026	4,23,432/-	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No.50168/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, HISAR	SUPPLY, CARRIAGE AND COLLECTION OF STONE METAL IN SIZE 53MM TO 22.4MM IN MAIN STORE HISAR IN PROVINCIAL DIVISION NO.I, PWD BANDR BRANCH, HISAR IN HISAR DISTRICT + 1 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 16.10.2026	6.52 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9878384499 pwd-eepd1-hissar@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, AMBALA	IMPROVEMENT OF ROAD FROM AMBALA-BARAULA ROAD (KM 10.00 TO 16.00) BY PROVIDING STRENGTHENING OF ROAD IN AMBALA DISTRICT (ROAD ID 9) (UNDER NABARD SCHEME RIDF-XXXII)	09.10.2026 21.10.2026	313.20 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9417362462 pwd-eepd2-ambala@hry.nic.in
3	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR PROVIDING CAFETERIA SERVICES AT KCGMC, KARNAL	15.10.2026 27.10.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8295340665 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
4	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING,MANDI DABWALI	KALANWALI STP:- PROVIDING AND INSTALLATION / REPLACEMENT OF EQUIPMENT AND ELECTRIC INSTALLATION AT 9.50 MLD STP KALANWALI DISTT. SIRSA. CH. TO :- KALANWALI:- ESTIMATE FOR REPLACEMENT/ UPGRADATION OF EQUIPMENT AND ELECTRICAL ITEMS AT 9.50 MLD STP AT KALANWALI TOWN DISTT. SIRSA	09.10.2026 21.10.2026	58.07 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8730000001 ee.mandidabwali@gmail.com
5	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, HISAR	STRENGTHENING /REHABILITATION OF EXISTING DAMAGED 500 MM I/D RCC NP3 PIPE UPSTREAM TO 4.00 MLD STP KAIMRI ROAD BY CIPP (CURED-IN-PLACE PIPE) TECHNOLOGY	CLOSING DATE 27.10.2026	521.40 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662-247033 eephisar@gmail.com
6	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, HISAR	A/MTC. ESTIMATE FOR SEWERAGE SCHEME HISAR TOWN AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENT THERETO. FOR THE YEAR 2026-27	CLOSING DATE 16.10.2026	8.30 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662-247033 eephisar@gmail.com
7	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, HISAR	FIXING OF HYDRANT AT VARIOUS STPS UNDER DIVISION NO.3 HISAR.	12.10.2026 19.10.2026	5.39 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662-247033 eephisar@gmail.com
8	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, FATEHABAD	SPECIAL REPAIR/WDG./STG. OF 02 NO. ROADS UNDER RATIA CONSTITUENCY IN FATEHABAD DISTRICT (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (GROUP-11) 1. STG. ON BHIRDANA TO BHUTHAN KALAN ROAD KM 0.0 TO 4.245 (ROAD ID 10178) 2. WDG. AND STG. AND IPB ON RATIA FATEHABAD ROAD TO DHANI TALIWALI KM 0.0 TO 0.78 (ROAD ID 5602) (WITHOUT GST) + 1 WORKS	12.10.2026 22.10.2026	563.26 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01667-220120 pwd-eepd-fatehabad@hry.nic.in
9	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, FATEHABAD	REPAIR OF WATER CROSSING OVER HISAR GHAGGAR MULTIPURPOSE CHANNEL X-ING AT RD 183300 AND185200	CLOSING DATE 17.10.2026	0.94 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466751554 xenwsdivisionfbd@yahoo.com
10	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, KARNAL	CONSTRUCTION OF LINED DRAIN FROM RD 4300-7700 AND 01 NO. BRIDGE ON CONNECTING MAIN DRAIN NO. 1AND2 AT VILLAGE KHOTPURA TO PROTECT THE ABADI AREA AFTER FLOOD 2024	08.10.2026 16.10.2026	100.79 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0184-2258008 xeninddivn@yahoo.in
11	PANCHAYATI RAJ, KURUKSHETRA	VARIOUS DEVELOPMENT WORKS AT BRAHMA SAROVAR KURUKSHETRA FOR IGM 2026. + 6 WORKS	12.10.2026 17.10.2026	75.90 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896224357 prexeeng.krk@hry.nic.in

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SC seeks IB input on Beant murder convict Hawara's transfer request to Punjab prison

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 13

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday sought an assessment from the Intelligence Bureau (IB) on a request by Jagtar Singh Hawara – serving a life sentence in the Tihar jail for the 1995 assassination of former Punjab CM Beant Singh – seeking transfer to a prison in Punjab.

"How do we ignore the Punjab state's objection...The larger problem is still alive. It is not a simple case of murder, A killing B, B killing C...It's based upon certain ideology, certain views. And the counter of Punjab state says it's still alive and there is possibility of it being increased. That's the concern we have to satisfy...Anyway, we will find out from the IB," Justice M M Sundresh, presiding over a two-judge bench, said.

The Punjab government has opposed Hawara's request. It said in an affidavit that the move "may not be considered for upkeep of peace and tranquillity, communal harmony and law and order in the State of Punjab as well as in the country."

Citing reports from central and state agencies, the affidavit said, "the transfer of petitioner may increase the risk of his escape, potentially in collusion with his associates."

It added, "Furthermore, the continuous protest from 2023 at the Mohali-Chandigarh Border demanding the release of Bandi Sikhs indicates heightened sensitivity around such issues. As per the report, transfer of the petitioner may lead to an increase in radical activities and public unrest in Punjab."

The state added: "shifting of the petitioner to any prison of the State of Punjab may escalate tensions and could potentially lead to a law and order situation in the State..."

To outsiders, they were just vacationers living it up during Goa's off-season — lounging in the pool or going to casinos. Until the police blew their cover. MOHAMED THAVER & PAVNEET SINGH CHADHA on the team that played a key part in a cyber crime chain: moving defrauded money at lightning speed into thousands of accounts

HOW THEY MOVED THE MONEY

INSIDE A MULTI-CRORE SCAM RUN OUT OF GOA VILLAS



ILLUSTRATION: SUVAJIT DEY

CASA DE Nicole is a picture of North Goa's laid-back charm — two storeys tall, with off-white walls and garden beds. Just the kind of villa vacationers in Goa prefer during the monsoon, when off-season prices plummet. So when a dozen young men lived it up here for days, lounging by the pool or stepping out to visit casinos and nightclubs, none of the neighbours paid any attention.

Until August 4, 2026, when a team of the Mumbai Police's Crime Branch raided Casa De Nicole. The 'vacationers', it turned out, were a key cog in a much larger cybercrime machine, one that spanned Gujarat, Goa, Mumbai, Dubai and beyond.

The cybercrime chain is by now all too familiar: conmen pose as law enforcement and terrorise the victim into transferring their life savings into a specified bank account, from where the money splits and gets transferred into thousands of bank accounts — a blitzkrieg operation that leaves banks with little time to react.

It's for the first time, police say, that they have cracked down on the latter part of the operation — the team involved in moving money at lightning speeds into smaller accounts.

What stunned the police was that the men carrying out these fraudulent transactions weren't those working in the shadows in Jamtara, Nuh or many of the other cybercrime hubs, but living it up in Goa's villas. When the Mumbai Police team cracked down on the Candolim villa, they found 12 youngsters, 11 from Gujarat and one from Jogeshwari in Mumbai. "Some whose 'working hours' were over were lounging on the terrace. Others were in the pool," says Inspector Prashant Gawde, who was part of the team that conducted the raid.

Since then, police have cracked down on at least one more villa in Goa and arrested 10. Police have filed two FIRs across both cases, estimating that the two gangs defrauded people of a combined Rs 900 crore.

A trail from Mumbai

It all began in Mumbai.

In July this year, DCP (crime) Raj Tilak Roushan received a tip-off that something suspicious was going on at a company in South Mumbai — Office No. 303 at Parsvnath Chambers, Masjid Bunder. On July 3, a Mumbai Crime Branch team raided the office that bore an adhesive sticker for 'G.D. Overseas'. The company turned out to be a sham; it existed nowhere except on that single piece of paper.

The investigators found 10-12 employees whose job was to open new current accounts across banks in Mumbai. Upon checking the transactions, a peculiar trend stood out: while the accounts were opened in Mumbai banks and activated by 'G.D. Overseas' employees, they were later operated from Goa. The investigators also found that the 'G.D. Overseas' employees bought the SIM cards that were linked to the bank accounts — typically for OTPs and banking authentication — and sent them to Goa, where the accounts were later operated.

During interrogations, Mohammad Shabbir Sheikh, one of the arrested employees from the south Mumbai office unit, told the police that while he was employed in Dubai, he met a 'Ranveer Kapoor', who advised him to go to Mumbai and create the bank accounts. The bank welcome kits and account-linked SIM cards were to be handed over to another person who would take them to Goa. The FIR in the case, filed at the Pydhonie police station, quotes Ranveer Kapoor as telling Sheikh, "In return, I will give you Rs 50,000-70,000 per account."

Following the Goa trail, the police reached Casa De Nicole, which falls in the jurisdiction of Goa's Calangute Police Station. The Mumbai Crime Branch team, led by Senior Inspector (Unit II) Dilip Tejankar, conducted the raid. They seized 15 laptops, 128 ATM cards, 85 mobile phones, 76 SIM cards, 22 cheque books, 77 passbooks, six routers, and three keyboards from the villa.

The account numbers the youth had with them were used in 186 cybercrime cases across the country, it was found. The police went on to freeze Rs 120 crore spread across 7,500 bank accounts. The police believe nearly Rs 500 crore were moved by the accused living in the villa.

The good life in Goa

Mumbai Crime Branch officers say that Casa De Nicole appeared to be a villa from outside, but was an office space inside. "Every room had five to six laptops, and they had created a cabin-type setup, where they would sit and transfer money," says Inspector Prashant Gawde.

It was a 24x7 operation, with the youth working in three eight-hour batches. At any time, at least four men were ready to move money from a victim's account to thousands of others. This was required, as it could not be predicted when a cybercrime victim would take the bait and transfer money, say officers.

Gawde says that some of those arrested at the Goa villa said their workdays were taxing, with some days extending to 12 hours. But there was a pay-off: they could step out of the villa and splurge in their free hours. "They would go to nightclubs and casinos; sometimes, they would even bring people over to the villa," he says.

The men earned Rs 35,000 a month and a three per cent share of the money they moved each day.

Casa De Nicole owner Francis says he had no idea a cybercrime racket was being run from the villa until a police call in August.

"They rented the villa for two months for Rs 1 lakh. Initially, when they approached me, I told them I rent the villa only for short durations. But I changed my mind later. They paid rent for two months upfront, but had stayed only for one month when the police raided the premises. I had no clue that they were involved in cyber fraud," says Francis.

A resident, requesting anonymity, says, "They were a noisy bunch. They had rented vehicles. I would see them coming and going at odd hours, but did not think much of it."

The villa has since been locked.

A Mumbai police officer said that an absconding accused in the case, whose identity they refused to reveal, had approached the villa owners claiming to be the manager at a multinational company and saying he wanted to book the villa to enable his employees to "work from home" in a relaxed environment.

But something still puzzled the officers: moving money manually across thousands of accounts would require far more people. This, they soon found, was where the 'company' stepped in.

Casa De Nicole, the villa from which the youth operated; (inset) one of the accused, Bua Smith or 'Ashwathama', who was tracked down in Jaipur

It was a 24x7 operation, with the youth working in three eight-hour batches. At any time, at least four men were ready to move money, as it could not be predicted when a victim would take the bait

The gang, the network

The youth, police found, reported to a Dubai-based Indian who called himself 'Ranveer Kapoor'. Police claim to have identified him, and they are trying to get him back in coordination with the authorities in Dubai. He, along with other Dubai-based operators, ran what the accused called the "company".

The "company", police found, was at the head of the cyber fraud pyramid, followed by the "administrators" (the men arrested in Goa), the "masters", "super masters" and the "customers".

At the bottom, or the first level of the fraud, were the "customers", people who, in exchange for money, handed over their accounts for fraudulent transactions. These were the mule accounts into which the "administrators" would, at the click of a button on their app, transfer the money.

A level above them were the "masters", essentially agents working on the periphery of the banking system in Mumbai, who would procure the 'mule' accounts from customers, either by force or lure.

The "supermasters" were the ones responsible for keeping the bank accounts ready for transactions. They collected welcome packs for newly opened accounts, activated the accounts, and set up OTPs.

"A regular flow of mule accounts was needed to run this network," a police officer says.

"Administrators", the youth arrested in Goa whose job was to move money between accounts, formed the next level and held 'franchises' of the "company" they reported to. The arrested administrators told police they paid Rs 50 lakh upfront to obtain the 'franchise'.

As they probed further, police realised that the men in the Goa villa could not realistically have logged into and operated thousands of bank accounts one by one. They found that the Dubai-based company had given their administrators in Goa access to an app especially developed for cybercrime, called Banker Panel.

On the app, the youth entered the account into which the victim was made to transfer money in one box and listed the accounts to which the money would be sent in another. "Once the set-up was ready, they only needed to click once, and the money would be transferred to thousands of accounts in an instant. The chain continues," the police officer says.

This ensured the victims' money would be untraceable, even if law enforcement officials were alerted within the "golden hour", the first one to two hours immediately after a fraud, when banks can block or freeze the money.

The money transferred to different accounts was eventually withdrawn at ATMs or through cheque-books.

Another group, police say, would send the money onwards to Dubai via the 'angadia' network — an unofficial, trust-based courier system, often used to send unaccounted money without alerting authorities.

The cybercrime network, the officer says, had a unique method to pay commission to 'franchises' like the Goa one in 'white'. For this, the Dubai-based 'company' operated gaming platforms. On these platforms, a youth in Goa would pay Rs 1,000 to bet on a race. The 'company' would return Rs 900 and add Rs 100 to the bet, creating a legitimate-looking transaction through which the franchise could receive its commission in 'white'.

The police found gaming portals like 'XXX247', '900 Panel' and 'Rudra' linked to the cybercrime network. "Though online gaming has been banned in India (the Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act was passed in 2025 and came into effect on May 1, 2026), it is not banned abroad, so they would use that loophole. We have since blocked the gaming websites," the officer says.

As they dug deeper, the Mumbai Police team kept bumping into a shadowy figure, 'Ashwathama', on several WhatsApp groups the youth used.

"Since the accused would ensure one 'level' did not meet another, no one knew who this person was," an officer says. "This person played an important role in these WhatsApp groups, in organising mule account holders and telling those on the lower levels what was to be done."

In the first week of September, the police tracked down 'Ashwathama' in Jaipur. He was identified as Bua Smith, who hailed from Ahmedabad. He told police that he was sure that he, like Ashwathama, the immortal warrior in the Mahabharata, would not be found out, even if all others were arrested.

Beyond Casa De Nicole

Police say Casa De Nicole, run by the Dubai-based 'company', is not an isolated case. Other 'companies', they say, have begun to operate from countries such as Sri Lanka. They eventually convert money into cryptocurrency and send it to a third country, like China, using crypto wallets.

After the raid on Casa De Nicole in August, there was a similar raid at a Goa villa called Sea Coast in September. Investigators uncovered the same modus operandi: men in their thirties operating out of a villa, moving money across thousands of accounts. The accused, police found, changed villas when owners or neighbours suspected that something was amiss. The police suspect they moved around Rs 400 crore of fraudulently obtained money.

In September, the Mumbai Crime Branch (Unit V), led by senior Inspector Rohini Potdar, raided Sea Coast villa and arrested the accused. "They were given a monthly salary of Rs 25,000 and a percentage of the money they moved. Every person ended up earning anywhere between Rs 1 and 1.5 lakh a month," says a police officer.

The youth, police found, reported to a Dubai-based Indian who called himself 'Ranveer Kapoor'. Police say they have identified him and are trying to get him back in coordination with the authorities in the UAE

"Unlike the lot in Casa De Nicole who splurged on casinos and nightclubs, police say the men arrested from Sea Coast were older and told them that they wanted to send money back home," says Assistant Police Inspector Sachin Barate, who was part of the team that raided Sea Coast villa.

For Goa Police, which assisted their counterparts from Mumbai in the raids, the shadowy activities in the villa are a growing headache. "The ease of 'working' from a villa, close to the beaches and casinos, is what draws young men to take up this job," says a Goa officer posted in the cyber cell.

The operation

TRICKING VICTIMS: Conmen posing as law enforcement officials intimidated victims into transferring money into bank accounts controlled by them

OPENING THE ACCOUNTS: For this, others in the network opened accounts across Mumbai banks, collected the bank welcome kits, arranged SIM cards for OTPs and banking authentication, and sent them onward to Goa

MOVING THE MONEY: In Goa villas, young men worked around the clock, moving defrauded money to thousands of accounts almost instantly

OPERATION CENTRAL, DUBAI: Dubai-based operators gave the Goa team access to Banker Panel, an app that distributes money across accounts

WITHDRAWING THE MONEY: The stolen money was withdrawn through ATMs or cheques and sent to Dubai through the informal angadia network

MAKING THE MONEY 'WHITE': Gaming platforms were used to pay the Goa operators through transactions that appeared legitimate

WEB EXCLUSIVE
'Israel and the US see Navi Pillay's Peace Prize as a verdict against them — rightly so' — *Saptarshi Basak*
Log on to www.indianexpress.com

WORDLY WISE
The ultimate weakness of violence is that it is a descending spiral, begetting the very thing it seeks to destroy.
— Martin Luther King Jr

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RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

In Manipur, the work of peace is still to be done

REPORTS THAT at least nine people were killed in the latest outbreak of violence across Manipur's hill districts on the night of October 9 point, yet again, to the state government's incapacity to heal or contain schisms in the state. By all accounts, the violence between the Kuki and Naga communities spanned three districts — Kamjong, Kangpokpi and Ukhrul — and involved ambushes and gunfights by armed groups. It is disturbing that even after three-and-a-half years of ethnic violence, there is only a fragile calm, and little progress seems to have been made towards an enduring end to the conflict.

After the N Biren Singh government was dissolved in February 2025, it was hoped that President's Rule would make space for an administration seen to be less partisan to stabilise the situation. But while large-scale violent clashes declined, normalcy remained elusive, and the deep divides that had taken hold since May 2023 persisted. As calls for an elected government grew louder, Yumnam Khemchand Singh, a Meitei like his predecessor, was chosen as chief minister. The appointment of a Kuki and a Naga deputy CM gave hope that political representation would pave the way for a lasting settlement. But the old Kuki-Naga fault line that fuelled bloodshed in the 1990s has been reopened. Since February, dozens of people from both communities have been killed and houses torched. The Meiteis, Kukis and Nagas are now caught in overlapping conflicts, with civilians bearing the brunt not only of the violence but also of blockades across the hill districts that restrict access to essential supplies.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi met CM Y Khemchand Singh on Saturday and promised all possible assistance to the embattled state government. But a return to normalcy will remain out of reach without a concerted effort, first, to demilitarise society and re-establish the state's authority. In August, Singh issued a 15-day ultimatum for the voluntary surrender of illegal firearms, thousands of which have been looted from state armouries since the conflict began. This was not the first such appeal: Soon after President's Rule was imposed in February 2025, Governor Ajay Kumar Bhalla had also called for the surrender of weapons. The continued prevalence of gun violence suggests that such appeals have not worked. Disarming armed groups and punishing those responsible for the killings must be an immediate priority. But the government must also create the conditions for sustained dialogue. Restoring the freedom of movement and making it possible for people to live safely alongside one another will have to be step one in a long process of reconciliation.

Inflation inches up, can rate hike be far behind?

RETAIL INFLATION continues to inch upwards, rising to 5.54 per cent in September, up from 4.83 per cent in August, according to data from the National Statistics Office. With this print, inflation came in at 4.9 per cent in the second quarter, in line with the central bank's most recent projection. Much of the increase in the headline inflation number is being driven by food prices. But price pressures are being felt in non-food categories as well. And with expectations of inflation firming up in the months ahead, it increases the odds of a tighter monetary policy.

Food inflation has surged to 7.74 per cent in September, up from 6 per cent in August, driven by items such as onions, ginger, garlic and lemon. The FAO food price index has also jumped 5.8 per cent, pointing towards an uptick in international prices. Weak rainfall will weigh heavily on output. The outlook remains uncertain. According to Crisil, "concerns over the rabi crop are also mounting amid low soil-moisture levels and elevated temperatures". Early indicators for October point towards continuing price pressures. Rating agency ICRA expects food and beverage inflation to exceed 8 per cent in October. Alongside, global crude oil prices remain elevated. As on October 12, the price of the Indian crude oil basket was $125.7 per barrel. This will add to the pressures in the economy. Core inflation is also moving upwards to 4.3 per cent, which indicates the pass-through of higher costs. Higher food and cooking fuel prices have kept inflation in the restaurants and accommodation services category elevated.

Over the coming months, inflation is likely to rise further. Economists at SBI have projected CPI at 6.5 per cent in the third quarter and 5.6 per cent in the fourth quarter, while ICRA expects inflation at around 6 per cent in the third quarter. This raises the possibility of another rate hike when the RBI's Monetary Policy Committee meets next, in the first week of December. While most expect the MPC to hike rates by 25 basis points, some suggest the likelihood of a 50 basis points hike. To what extent the committee tightens over the coming months will depend on its expectations of how inflation will evolve going forward.

There are plenty more fish in the sea

IF BEING omnivorous gave human beings an advantage in the high-stakes game of evolution, what is to be made of the growing evidence that the species' palate has, in this age of plenty, narrowed rather than expanded? Consider, for example, the British palate, which according to research published this week in *People* and *Nature*, enjoys so little of what it once prized that fish and seafood consumption has effectively been reduced to a small group of fish. Gone are the plaice, herring and oysters, replaced almost entirely by the "Big Five": Cod, haddock, salmon, prawns and tuna.

This is a paradox of the modern age, where a mindboggling diversity prevails everywhere, from fashion and pastimes to media and medicines, but the dinner plate — whether one is in New Delhi or New York — looks increasingly the same. There is of course, as there always is in the tangled web of the global economy, a range of reasons, including the dominance of monocultures. Humans now get the bulk of their calories from just eight crops: Rice, wheat, maize, potatoes, barley, palm oil, soy and sugar.

Beyond its implications for health — and there are many, given the ballooning global obesity crisis — the restricted diet of the contemporary human blunts the very evolutionary edge that helped ensure *Homo sapiens*' success. The lessons are clear, especially in light of the monoculture-related food disasters of the modern age, such as the great banana epidemic that once wiped out entire plantations in South and Central America or the African swine fever that swept through Asia in 2018, leading to the culling of millions of pigs and disruption of the global food supply: There are plenty of fish in the sea, if only humans would pick a wider variety.

The other G2, and three lessons for India



RAJA MANDALA
BY C RAJA MOHAN

FEW IDEAS cause greater anxiety in the Indian strategic community than a "G2". It invokes fears of a US-China partnership that might produce geopolitical duopoly over Asia. But Delhi should also reflect on another G2 — a strategic accommodation between America and Russia. India has fewer reasons to fear it, although it would bring complications of its own.

US President Donald Trump's decision last week to ease sanctions on Russian diesel puts that possibility, distant though it might be, back in focus. After a telephone conversation with Russian President Vladimir Putin, Trump announced Russian supplies for American and global markets. Washington authorised diesel imports until April 2027. With diesel above $6 per gallon and the question of inflation hovering over congressional elections on November 3, cheaper fuel for farmers and truckers is an urgent political priority for Trump.

The irony is plain. Just weeks ago, Trump signed legislation giving him sweeping powers to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries like India buying Russian oil. Hypocritical? Of course. But hypocrisy is part of international life. For all the grandstanding on global issues by major powers, we know that all politics is local.

For Delhi, better US-Russia relations could reduce the friction its Russian partnership creates with Washington. Many would hope that, having carved out an exemption on diesel for himself, Trump would hesitate to impose fresh oil sanctions on India. More interesting, though, is the prospect of an entente between Washington and Moscow that Trump has long championed.

Trump's desire for better relations with Russia is hardly a secret. In his first term, he pressed for Moscow's return to the G8, which suspended Russia after its annexation of Crimea in 2014. At Helsinki in 2018, he resisted calling Russia an adversary. He has repeatedly invoked the US-Soviet alliance in World War II as a sensible precedent for a new partnership.

But Trump's first term also showed how difficult it is to build an internal American consensus on engagement with Russia. Democrats devoted considerable energy to portraying Trump as "Putin's puppet" and arguing that Russian interference had helped put him in the White House. After taking the House in 2019, they pursued investigations into his Russian connections. If Democrats regain Congress, or even the House, they could use investigations, sanctions legislation and control over spending to obstruct a rapprochement with Moscow. Entrenched Republican opposition to concessions for Putin adds another constraint.

Some on America's Christian right favour engagement with Putin, whom they see as a defender of traditional Western values against liberal cultural extremism. But that support cannot overcome the wider opposition.

Despite Washington's well-known resistance to Russian engagement, Trump wasted no time in his second term pursuing better relations with Russia. Talks in Riyadh in February 2025 reopened high-level engagement. Putin's investment envoy, Kirill Dmitriev, offered opportunities in energy, Arctic development and minerals. The Alaska summit that August brought the two presidents together but failed to end the war so far.

> Just weeks ago, Trump signed legislation giving him sweeping powers to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries like India buying Russian oil. Hypocritical? Of course. But hypocrisy is part of international life

Trump's envoys, Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, met Putin in Moscow last month. Trump could meet Putin at November's APEC summit in Shenzhen, where the Kremlin has floated a meeting including China's Xi Jinping. He might also host Putin at December's G20 summit in Miami. Moscow has yet to accept that invitation. Neither encounter is assured, but the diplomatic possibilities are expanding.

Commerce is central to Trump's outreach to Russia. He wants economic cooperation to open a path to peace, rather than follow a settlement. Profitable ventures, he believes, can soften political antagonisms. American access to Russian energy and minerals could create a constituency for better relations. Trump also sees the Ukraine war as an obstacle to business and has pressed Kyiv to stop attacking Russian refineries.

Putin has reasons to bargain. Sanctions relief promises revenue, investment and technology. Engagement with Washington restores standing and could reduce dependence on China. A settlement recognising Russian territorial gains would let him claim victory at home. But translating these shared interests into concrete results has proved difficult. Ukraine will resist a bargain that rewards invasion or compromises its security. Just as Asian countries worry about a US-China compact, Europeans fear that a Trump-Putin bargain could leave them exposed to Russia's geopolitical assertions.

Three lessons follow for India. First, US-Russia relations are not static. Their confrontation need not last forever. Delhi should consider the opportunities from US-Russian cooperation as carefully as the costs of hostility. A thaw could ease American pressure on India's Russian energy purchases and defence ties.

Second, Moscow does not see confrontation with America as a "sacred ideological obligation", as some in Delhi might believe. Russia values engagement with America as a great-power peer, even if it is no economic equal. In the early 1990s, Russia's eagerness to build relations with America pushed India down Moscow's priorities. Delhi should remember that experience.

Third, India's stakes in Europe have risen dramatically. Trade, technology, investment and defence give Delhi a direct interest in European stability. Even if Trump and Putin strike a deal, Russia's confrontation with Europe could continue. An American-Russian accommodation would therefore meet only part of India's needs.

Delhi should contribute wherever it can to peace in Ukraine. It should also encourage direct dialogue between Russia and Europe on ending the war in Ukraine and shaping a sustainable security order in Europe and more broadly in Eurasia.

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When the state paints dissent as disorder



FAIZAN MUSTAFA



AYAN ADITYA GIRI

EVERY DEMOCRACY, sooner or later, confronts the same difficult situation: A crowd on a public road, a police battalion, and a vehicle at the kerb. The mass detention of Opposition leaders, students and other demonstrators in the ongoing protests in Delhi seeking the resignation of the Chief Election Commissioner, Gyanesh Kumar, has brought that scene into Indian lives now. We do not weigh the protestors' grievance, nor the necessity pleaded by the authorities. We ask the prior question: What does the Constitution say about the street and about the detention cells?

Peaceful assembly is a settled commitment of constitutional democracies, but like other rights, it is never an absolute right. The First Amendment to the US Constitution protects the right to "peaceably assemble". American courts permit reasonable regulation of time, place, and manner, yet since *Brandenburg vs Ohio*, they punish advocacy only when it is directed at, and likely to produce, imminent lawless action. Article 8 of the German Basic Law protects assembly "peacefully and without arms". In the *Brokdorf* decision (1985), Germany's federal constitutional court treated demonstrations as integral to democratic order and required that restrictions be proportionate, with outright bans a "last resort". Our Supreme Court, too, on October 9, clarified that only regulation, not prohibition, is permissible.

The common thread is simple: Protest is presumptively protected; peacefulness is the condition of that protection.

The framers of India's Constitution confronted the same tension — many of them had been detained without trial themselves. Draft Article 15A, which became Article 22, was debated in September 1949. H V Kamath and Pandit Thakur Bhargava, among others, warned that a Constitution should not authorise detention on mere executive whim. B R Ambedkar's answer was that a young state facing the violence of Partition could not be denied a power of preventive detention, but that the power should be hedged. The Assembly settled on safeguards: Grounds must be communicated, and detention beyond three months requires an advisory board's approval. Preventive detention entered the Constitution as an acknowledged exception, not as an ordinary instrument of governance. Unfortunately, the 44th Constitutional Amendment of 1978 providing additional safeguards has not yet been notified.

The Supreme Court has since policed that exception. In *Ram Manohar Lohia vs State of Bihar* (1960), it held that even the detention on the call not to pay irrigation rates was illegal. In *Ram Manohar Lohia* (1966), the SC distinguished between "law and order", "public order" and "security of the State" as three concentric circles, so that not every disturbance of peace justifies drastic measures. Only an aggravated situation of law and order can be termed a public-order issue. The peaceful Delhi protests are at best a question of maintaining law and order. The way the police have treated MPs, lawyers and journalists despite the SC's directions cannot be justified in the name of public order.

In *Himat Lal K Shah* (1973), the Court held the right to assemble peaceably to be fundamental yet regulable, but not subject to an official's arbitrary refusal. *Ramlila Maidan Incident* (2012) affirmed that peaceful protest cannot be extinguished by arbitrary executive action. Justice D Y Chandrachud's opinion in *Arnab Goswami* (2020) reminded us that even a day's deprivation of liberty is a grave matter, while Justice H R Khanna's dissent in *ADM Jabalpur* (1976) remains the standing answer to any suggestion that liberty rests on executive grace.

In the light of this jurisprudence, three questions follow: Was the assembly peaceful? Was the apprehension of disorder specific and imminent rather than vague and general? And was the police response proportionate, with custody limited in duration, grounds communicated, and production before a magistrate within 24 hours as Article 22(1) and (2) require? Unlawful detention, even for an hour, is deprivation of one's liberty. This right cannot be restricted to just one Arnab Goswami.

A democratic state shows its strength in tolerating the dissent it hears, and a democratic citizenry in keeping that dissent peaceful. Our Constitution asks both to remember that order and liberty are not rivals but cotenants of one republic, and that each is safest when the other is respected.

> The peaceful Delhi protests are at best a question of maintaining law and order. The way the police have treated MPs, lawyers and journalists despite the SC's directions can't be justified in the name of public order

Mustafa is a constitutional law scholar, and Giri is a scholar at Chanakya National Law University, Patna. Views are personal

CSR is at Rs 40,000 crore. Now, count the impact



PURVI MEHTA

INDIA HAS quietly created one of the world's largest pools of private sector-led development finance through its Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) law. What began as corporate compliance legislation in 2014, where companies crossing any of the three thresholds — Rs 500 crore in net worth, Rs 1,000 crore in turnover or Rs 5 crore in net profit — are mandated to spend 2 per cent of their net profits on CSR, has mobilised Rs 2.6 lakh crore in 10 years. Reports indicate an annual CSR spend of Rs 40,794 cr in 2024-25, contributed by 29,500 companies supporting 72,000 projects. This is perhaps the world's largest example of mandatory private-sector contribution.

India Inc. deserves credit. This is is a significant source of development capital. The success of the CSR experiment in mobilising money must now evolve to maximising impact across the country and sectors. The latest numbers show why: Maharashtra received Rs 8,631 crore, Gujarat Rs 4,549, Karnataka Rs 3,395 and Delhi Rs 2,753 crore of CSR funds last year. Together, these four states accounted for more than Rs 20,000 crore. Where companies are located can become a stronger determinant of CSR deployment than where India's development deficits are greatest.

Optimising the impact of the CSR funds will be a crucial opportunity. The issue is not that CSR money is being poorly spent; much of it is extremely valuable in supporting education, health, and livelihoods. The larger question is what the thousands of individual projects are adding up to. That requires greater attention to where the money goes and what outcomes are ultimately deliver. This points to three reforms for the next decade.

First, the accountability framework that measures the amount spent will have to be combined with stronger outcome indicators and standardisation of what they measure.

Second, 72,000 projects provide enormous innovation and effort. But fragmented activities must turn into longer-term, strategic interventions. The CSR law permits companies to collaborate. India Inc. should build on this by creating aggregations and combining funds and efforts around major themes and geographies. Ten companies investing Rs 10 crore individually on unrelated projects may each produce useful outputs without changing the underlying system. Ten companies together investing Rs 100 crore against a common results framework can potentially change a district system and have a much larger impact.

Third, CSR is likely to create greater impact when companies deploy not just money, but also their knowledge, networks and managerial capabilities. An agriculture or food company may be better placed to support farmer productivity, value chains or climate-resilient agriculture than to fund an unrelated education programme. Aligning CSR more closely with a firm's core competency can make each rupee more strategic and scalable.

The real headline is not simply that Indian companies now spend over Rs 40,000 crore annually on CSR. It is what this could achieve to move national indicators — not as a substitute for public expenditure, but as a supplement to it. It comes as a reminder that profit and purpose reinforce each other in creating value not only for the country but also for the companies standing by it.

> This is a significant source of development capital. The success of the CSR experiment in mobilising money must now evolve to maximising impact across the country and sectors

The writer is a senior technology advisor. Views are personal

40 YEARS AGO
October 14, 1986


GAREES
INDIAN EXPRESS
UXMI
Rajiv, Suharto hold talks
Call for global meet on Indian Ocean
Army out in Kurseong area after violence
Security man had strayed from post
PM unhappy over tainted babies
Gorbachev, Reagan blame each other
Summit broke on verge of agreement

Call for Indian Ocean meet

INDIA AND INDONESIA called for greater cooperation among developing countries to reinforce their demand for an equitable international economic order through a North-South dialogue. PM Rajiv Gandhi, speaking at a banquet hosted by Indonesian President Suharto, said that advanced economies were working against the concerns of the economically weak.

Security lapse at Rajghat

A SECURITY officer posted just below the creeper where a gunman hid at Rajghat on the morning of October 2 had strayed several metres from his post. This primarily led to the failure to pinpoint the source of the gunshot, and could have been fatal for the Prime Minister, police sources said.

US-USSR talks collapse

THE UNITED STATES and the Soviet Union were close to a major agreement on nuclear disarmament when the summit broke down over the US refusal to yield on its Star Wars research. The Soviet leader, Mikhail Gorbachev told newsmen in Reykjavik at the end of the summit that the two sides were about to agree on a plan to cut strategic weapons by 50 per cent in five years, eliminate medium-range missiles in Europe and reduce the number of warheads on Soviet medium-range missiles in Asia to 100, TASS reported. But while he demanded that these cuts be linked to a ban on Star Wars, Reagan rejected it outright.

India worried over impasse

THE PRIME MINISTER, Rajiv Gandhi, expressed India's concern at the breakdown of the talks on disarmament between the United States President, Ronald Reagan and the Soviet leader, Mikhail Gorbache, in Reykjavik.

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

The IDF must enable the Palestinians to harvest their olives from their own lands.

— Haaretz, Israel

READ. THINK. SHARE.
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Going forward, all protests must be one, coordinate efforts and energies



DESHKAAL

BY YOGENDRA YADAV



ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

WHAT NEXT? What should we expect now in the medley of protests? Sitting in Bengali Market, I munched over this question, a good distraction from the chhole bhature that did not live up to their fame.

It was a good moment to ask this question. Monday, October 12, was the death anniversary of Rammanohar Lohia, who famously said "*zinda kaumein paanch saal tak intezar nahin karti*" (A living people do not wait for five years). Over the previous 10 days, I had been detained five times — grabbed, dragged, pushed and shoved into police vans — for peacefully protesting against the Chief Election Commissioner. This was one of those lucky days when I did not end up in a police station.

We had just returned from the march to the Supreme Court. This was not a protest against the judiciary, least of all an attempt to put pressure on the courts. If anything, it was to restore the majesty of the Supreme Court that lay tattered on the streets of Delhi this weekend. Above all, it was to assert our fundamental right to peaceful protest in the national capital that was placed under a virtual curfew and experienced a reign of terror in miniature. We had reclaimed the streets.

What should be the next move? Obviously, the movement has to be expanded both in geographical and social terms. Some new forms of action need to be devised, besides a routine of street demonstrations. Some new institutional pressure points need to be identified. While the strategy and tactics of the protest are being worked out, an understanding of the destination and route might help navigation.

Suhas Palshikar characterises the present protests as a moment of "redemocratisation", as the way of opening the multiple systemic "closures" that we have witnessed ('Crackdown on Jantar Mantar 2.0, amid other closures, calls for redemocratisation', *IE*, October 13). These "closures" are a consequence of what I have called "democracy capture" that began in 2014 — a capture of democracy by using seemingly democratic means. The key instrument was "election capture": Elections are held regularly, but the playing field is tilted progressively to insulate the regime from electoral defeat. It began with the taming of mass media and monopoly over money power, was supplemented by the capture of the Election Commission and misuse of the CBI and ED, and is finally taking the shape of permanent architectural changes by way of the SIR, delimitation and One-Nation-One-Election. The current protests are against this design to ensure a permanent majority for the BJP.

The protests are about restoration of electoral integrity. No more. No less. Although there is no official charter, three demands are shared by all the protesters. First, the resignation or impeachment of CEC Gyanesh Kumar, a symbolic act towards restoring the proper functioning and credibility of the ECI. Second, the rollback of the SIR, so as to undo the largest ever disenfranchisement in the history of democracy. Third, the repeal of the 2023 Act, which grants the regime unfettered powers to appoint anyone to the ECI and complete immunity to those appointed. The basic impulse underlying these demands is the quest for free and fair elections, at least as free and as fair as the election that brought the BJP to power in 2014. Nothing less would do.

> The movement has to be expanded in geographical and social terms. Some new forms of action need to be devised. New institutional pressure points need to be identified

At the same time, this protest is not about regime change. Many of the forces behind the protest may wish to see an exit for Prime Minister Narendra Modi, sooner rather than later. But this is not the sentiment that drives ordinary citizens to the streets. Not yet. As of now, it is about restoring a system that keeps open a fair possibility of a democratic and peaceful transfer of power. If this bare minimum demand is frustrated, and every legitimate avenue for redress remains closed, the present protest may morph into a popular upsurge for regime change. The human and systemic costs of that kind of upheaval would be terrifying. Thankfully, we are not there yet. We should continue to hope that the residual capacity of regulatory institutions and the sheer long-term self interest of the ruling party would prevent such a catastrophe. Popular mobilisation on the streets does not bypass the constitutional order. It generates countervailing pressure that can strengthen institutions against the overwhelming power exerted by the regime.

Steering the protests towards this objective would require a realignment of forces. So far, these protests are a textbook example of "spontaneous synchronisation", where orderly collective action emerges without any central command or coordination. This happens when different actors, responding to one another, gradually align their actions without any conscious design or plan. The spontaneous call by "concerned citizens" (including this writer) leading to street action on October 2 to 4, the October 10 protest originally called by the CJP and the series of actions by the INDIA coalition from October 6 to 12 were not coordinated decisions. But the outcome appears like an orchestra or a relay race where the baton keeps changing hands.

That cannot be the way forward. If the regime has decided not to yield an inch, the protesters have to find a mechanism to coordinate their efforts. The CJP, the INDIA bloc, youth organisations and civil society may not and need not come under one umbrella, but they must ensure that they do not work at cross-purposes, that their energies cannot be deflected against one another. Fortunately, Rahul Gandhi has opened a window in this respect by stating that there are no separate or parallel protests, that all protests are one. Also, the relative strength of different strands of this movement has undergone a shift this time. This makes a realignment possible. The success of this movement hinges on this. The strength of organic or self-mobilised protesters, who were the backbone of the July youth protests, is critical here. These young protesters are not wedded to any organisation and their enthusiasm could be dampened if they find conflicting signals. Instead of an organisation- or party-led movement, they would like to see a citizens' movement supported by parties and organisations.

My train of thought stopped here as the insipid "machine coffee" I was sipping got over. I resolved not to order anything except South Indian filter coffee. And not to take *chhutti* till Gyanesh Kumar gets his *chhutti* from the Election Commission.

The writer is member, Swaraj India, and national convenor, Bharat Jodo Abhiyan

The only path to lasting peace is one state of Israel-Palestine



RAMESH VENKATARAMAN

EARLIER THIS month, the Green Party of England and Wales voted to declare Zionism a form of racism. The reaction was ferocious, well out of proportion for a party with only five MPs. Jewish groups condemned the motion as antisemitic. The Israeli government branded the Greens a body legitimising terrorism and banned its leader, who is himself Jewish, from entering Israel. Lost in the uproar was the truly significant wording in the resolution's text. For the first time, a mainstream Western party was calling "for the establishment of a single democratic state throughout historic Palestine." In short, a "one-state solution".

The conventional wisdom that has dictated international diplomacy, including India's, for three decades — the two-state solution — is well and truly dead. PM Benjamin Netanyahu's repeated insistence that Israeli security leaves no room for Palestinian sovereignty stated aloud what 30 years of policy had achieved. With elections imminent, Israel's political opposition has failed to present a clear mandate for Palestinian statehood. Public support for two states, low to start with, has collapsed — dropping to 17 per cent in recent Pew polling as security concerns continue to escalate three years after the October 7 Hamas attack and the devastating Israeli retaliation on Gaza.

The unworkability of a two-state solution goes beyond Israeli domestic politics. A separate Palestinian state, along the borders prior to the 1967 Six-Day War, is no longer viable. Anyone who has travelled through the West Bank knows that 30 years of expanding hilltop settlements, military outposts and dividing fences have fractured the territory into an absurd patchwork quilt of jurisdictions. You cannot build a coherent, sovereign state with a sustainable economy on a land so fragmented. Getting the 750,000-odd Israeli settlers in the occupied territories to relocate to Israel's legal borders is well nigh impossible.

Israel cannot occupy Gaza indefinitely. It may have degraded Hamas militarily, but it cannot crush the humiliation and despair that feed Palestinian militancy. Continuing down this path will only cement Israel's status as a global pariah. As the Greens' resolution proposes, the only available path to lasting peace is a single, secular, democratic state of Israel-Palestine.



Sceptics will point out that this is unrealistic: Israelis and Palestinians are too deeply divided by decades of trauma to share a single country. But every other option is even more delusional. Ask Israelis: Would you prefer an armed, hostile neighbour on your doorstep, or integration with 5.5 million Palestinians alongside the 2 million Arab citizens already living more or less peacefully in Israel, albeit as second-class citizens? Ask Palestinians: Would you prefer to cling to the illusion of having your own country, or gain equal rights in a prosperous power?

These are difficult questions and it will take time to change hearts and minds on both sides. But history demonstrates that entrenched ethnic and sectarian conflicts can transition into shared democratic governance. Democracies like Belgium have managed complex linguistic and cultural divisions within a constitutional framework that guarantees protections for different groups. Israeli Jews would need these safeguards, ideally underwritten by acceptable foreign powers, to overcome their fears over being outnumbered. Northern Ireland showed that after decades of sectarian violence, former enemies can share power under a democratic system overseen by Britain and the Republic of Ireland. Other precedents — South Africa, Bosnia, even fragile Lebanon — are far from perfect, but they prove that shared governance is possible, and vastly superior to endless war and misery.

A shared state is not an anti-Zionist anomaly; it echoes Zionism's founders, many of whom were democratic socialists rooted in liberal, humanistic values. In his 1902 utopian novel *Altneuland* ("Old New Land"), Theodor Herzl, the founder of modern political Zionism, envisioned a secular state where Arab citizens held equal voting rights, sat in parliament, and benefited from economic advancement. Herzl would be appalled to see his vision hijacked by ethnonationalists like Netanyahu.

Persisting with the myth of two states only guarantees endless bloodletting. The Green Party's resolution should be seized as a catalyst to kick-start the process of building consensus around a single democratic state where Israelis and Palestinians share peace, dignity, and equal rights. India can play a critical role in this. Despite its recent tilt towards Israel, India's historically staunch support for Palestinian rights gives it sufficient credibility to take the lead in evolving a one-state solution. This might just be the bold leap of political imagination required to return India to the top table of multilateral diplomacy.

The writer is an investor

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Wrong message

CERTAIN PLACES capture our imagination and hold immense symbolic value ('Crackdown on Jantar Mantar 2.0, amid other closures, calls for redemocratisation', *IE*, October 13). Jantar Mantar is one such place. It has hosted many protests that have asserted people's power and brought about many changes. In denotifying Jantar Mantar as a protest site, the government has matched the "provocation" of the place having been used for protests by the opposition parties and the Cockroach Janta party with overreaction. The government now seems to have taken the decision based on the saying "Out of sight, out of mind".

C David Milton, Maruthancode

Police conduct

THE CREDIBILITY of police reform in India rests not on judicial pronouncements alone, but on their translation into accountable, impartial and professional policing ('Police must protect individual rights, not political interests', *IE*, October 13). The Supreme Court's 2006 *Prakash Singh* judgment laid the foundation for transformation, yet implementation gaps persist. Recent protests have brought renewed attention to police conduct during demonstrations, the proportionality of crowd-control measures and the delicate balance between maintaining public order and safeguarding civil liberties.

Vaibhav Goyal, Chandigarh

THE POLICE must remain impartial, particularly when peaceful protests challenge those in power ('Police must protect individual rights, not political interests', *IE*, October 13). Clear rules for crowd control, independent inquiries into alleged misconduct and regular human-rights training can improve accountability. Police leadership should be insulated from improper political pressure, while officers must remain answerable for unlawful actions.

A D Nithish Kumar, Neelambur

What universities need to learn from IITs



SUDHIR K JAIN

IN THE 1950s and early 1960s, the IITs entered an academic landscape in which several universities already had distinguished reputations, outstanding faculty and long-established traditions. Yet over the decades, the IITs built formidable reputations while some institutions that had once been among India's best lost ground. What lessons do they hold for India today as it seeks to build universities among the world's best?

Three things, in my view, determine whether an institution can achieve and sustain excellence: Talent, resources, governance and culture. All three matter, but governance and culture determine how effectively an institution can attract, develop and use the other two. There is no upper limit to excellence: However good the talent, resources, governance or culture, there is always room for each to improve.

Universities depend on faculty, students, non-teaching staff and members of governing boards. Strong institutions are serious about whom they bring in and continually seek to raise the quality of their people in all these roles. At leading universities, there is often an implicit aspiration that every new faculty appointment should be at least as good as, and preferably better than, those already there. A mediocre appointment can affect an institution for decades. Recruiting outstanding people is only the beginning. A strong institution should enable talented people to become even better over time, expanding their capabilities and ambition rather than allowing them to stagnate.

> A strong institution should enable talented people to become even better over time, expanding their capabilities and ambition rather than allowing them to stagnate

Universities also need resources: Buildings, hostels, laboratories, libraries, scholarships and research support. These come not only from government grants or tuition fees; alumni, donors and industry relationships are important institutional assets. A strong university will probably never feel that it has enough resources, because greater ambition creates new possibilities and new needs. It must keep building resources and directing them to the right academic priorities.

This is where governance and culture become crucial. Universities need sufficient autonomy for decisions to be taken close to where information and responsibility reside. They need transparent processes, appropriate delegation and clear accountability. Culture is less visible but equally consequential. When people are respected, information is shared, participation is sought and differing views are genuinely considered, they are more likely to feel ownership of the institution. That ownership brings the ideas, energy and passion of faculty, staff and students into building the university.

The IITs benefited from substantial public investment and, compared to typical Indian universities, had a strong resource base. They attracted highly capable students and were exacting in faculty recruitment, with a strong norm that positions need not be filled if suitable candidates were not found. They also enjoyed considerable academic autonomy, with substantial freedom to shape curricula, teaching, faculty recruitment and internal academic practices. Uniformity in curricula, grading or recruitment practices across the IIT system was not the guiding principle; each institution had room to innovate and develop its own identity. This combination helped the IITs build strong institutions. But they are not permanently protected from decline. If recruitment standards weaken, governance deteriorates, culture erodes or autonomy becomes less purposeful, they too can lose ground.

The three pillars reinforce one another. Institutions with sound governance and a strong culture find it easier to attract good people. Better people strengthen teaching, research and reputation, while greater trust helps mobilise resources. Better resources make more ambitious work possible, which, in turn, attracts still better people. If India wants universities among the world's best, the answer cannot simply be more money or better ranking strategies. Talent must keep improving, resources must keep expanding, and governance and culture must keep evolving. There is no finishing line.

The writer has been vice-chancellor, Banaras Hindu University and founding director, IIT Gandhinagar

In Nepal, a majority government in search of stability



YUBARAJ GHIMIRE

TWENTY YEARS ago, Nepal's leaders, buoyed by their success after deposing King Gyanendra, declared that democracy would be a permanent feature in the country's governance. The current regime is now defining democracy rather uniquely. In six months, Prime Minister Balendra Shah showed up in parliament just four times, spoke briefly twice, and left the House once when the President was still at the joint session. He has not called on the President even once.

Shah is, in fact, doing things only slightly differently from the governments led by the Maoists, Nepali Congress and Communist Party of Nepal (UML) in the past 20 years. They too used the legislature as a rubber stamp and scuttled Members' right to move amendments, even when the constitution-making process was on.

On September 27, the police arrested former chief justice Cholendra Shumsher Rana without a warrant. He was let off 12 hours later, after he gave the authorities a letter that his detention was at his own request. Days later, Rana's relatives and close contacts are being searched and investigated for wide-ranging charges, including an attempt to influence *sub judice* cases and subvert the government in collaboration with some ruling-party and opposition leaders.

Home Minister Sudhan Gurung is personally supervising surveillance and the investigation. Why the government chose not to inform parliament about the conspiracy remains a mystery. But in a highly polarised political climate, Shah remains a "hero" and Rana the opposite.

Gurung's warning that the misuse of information accessed through people holding certain official positions will not be condoned offers a clue about the course the case may take. While nothing much has been revealed yet, the investigation is likely to take cognisance of the growing dissent within the ruling Rastriya Swatantra Party and criticism of the government by MPs who are supporters of party leader Rabi Lamichhane. In addition, UML chief K P Sharma Oli is demanding the revival of the parliament that was dissolved on September 12 last year after he was forced to quit as PM in the face of the "Gen Z" anti-corruption protest.

> Shah is doing things only slightly differently from the governments in the past 20 years. They too used the legislature as a rubber stamp

The perceived conspiracy seems to have multiple dimensions, and, going by the actions so far, the government is trying to link them together. Naturally, Lamichhane would be as much of a suspect as Oli and Maoist leader Prachanda.

Way back in 2006, when the political parties of the day ousted the king, they also moved towards controlling the judiciary. The new government asked Supreme Court judges to take a fresh oath, which was seen as a pledge of loyalty to the new regime. A proposal put forward by the Maoists that the judiciary be answerable to parliament did not find support from other parties. But in 2013, Chief Justice Khil Raj Regmi took over as the PM, with nominees from the four major parties in the cabinet — an experiment that has not only ruined the reputation and independence of the judiciary, but also injected political ambition among judges. Sushila Karki, a retired CJ, took over as PM last year despite the constitution clearly disqualifying judges from any constitutional or political position even after retirement.

These experiments at the cost of the principle of separation of powers have brought judges and politicians together. The landslide victory in favour of a single party last year was a rare outcome in Nepal. But perhaps it is no guarantee of political stability.

The writer is the Kathmandu-based contributing editor for The Indian Express

• ECONOMY

Inflation generalisation: Why economists gauge the 'spreading' of price pressures

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 13

HOUSEHOLD INFLATION jumped to 5.54% in September from 4.83% in August, data released Monday showed. One phrase is now on everyone's lips: price pressures are generalising, or spreading. This is important, as the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) last week admitted there is "some evidence of elevated inflation expectations and generalisation of inflation".

The RBI's admission marked a U-turn of sorts after it had said as recently as August that there were "little signs of generalisation of price pressures so far" — something a few economists could not digest. Economists from ICICI Securities Primary Dealership said the "insistence on waiting for generalisation of price pressures and downplaying current bout of inflation as supply shock does not hold up to scrutiny."

The latest Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation data and the RBI's concession have given rise to a consensus of sorts on price pressures spreading. CPI inflation measures the year-on-year change in the general level of retail prices of selected goods and services consumed by households. But what exactly is generalisation of inflation and how is it identified?

Inflation generalisation

Generalisation of inflation simply refers to when higher prices begin spreading across the household consumption basket in a sustained manner. This requires the price rise to move from categories most susceptible to price increases, such as food and fuel, to others, like consumer goods and services.

There are many ways to check if inflation is spreading across the CPI basket. Consider the simplest first: how many items are seeing above 4% inflation. Why 4%? Because the RBI's medium-term target for the inflation rate in the economy is 4%, in a band of 2-6%. In January, 65 of the 358 items in India's CPI basket clocked an inflation rate of 4% or more. By September, this number rose to 129.

Inflation, however, isn't the best measure of price momentum. As it is the year-on-year price change, it depends on what the price was in the year-ago period. For example, if prices were unchanged in September 2025 compared to the previous month, it creates an unfavourable base for inflation in September 2026. This is why policymakers want to know how prices are moving from one month to another, called price momentum. In February, 236 of the 358 items in India's CPI basket saw prices rise compared to January. By September, it rose to 319.

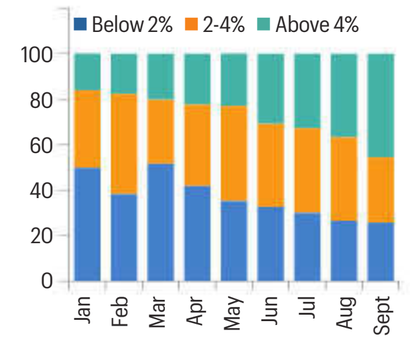
Diffusion indices

These methods to understand the generalisation of inflation are still rather simplistic. Economists thus have other gauges, such as diffusion indices. These map the breadth of price increase. In doing so, they account for the weight of each item in the basket. So, a good that makes up 0.01% of the CPI basket does not get the same importance as one that accounts for 1%.

These weights are those assigned to each of the 358 items, decided by the statistics ministry's Household Consumption Expenditure Survey. The current CPI basket and its item weights are based on the survey conducted from August 2023 to July 2024.

Going by the RBI's own diffusion index for the CPI, as seen in the *chart*, almost 46% of the CPI basket registered 4%-plus inflation in September, up from 37% in August. However, Nomura economists say that their India Inflation Generalisation Index is suggests that while price pressures are rising, "they are still below the long-term average". Such assessments matter because they determine how much the RBI may raise interest rates — the broader the pressures, the higher the repo rate may be. After Monday's data, the consensus is towards another 50-75 basis points of rate hikes in the next 4-6 months.

• Sharp inflation generalisation in September



NOTE: DATA IS FOR HEADLINE CPI DIFFUSION INDEX; SOURCE: RBI

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• CLIMATE

Flash flood in Nepal again: For India, a warning

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
New Delhi, October 13

A SUDDEN surge of water, mud, boulders and debris swept through settlements along Nepal's Budhi Gandaki river in Gorkha district last week, causing damage to infrastructure.

The fresh incident has renewed concerns about sudden floods across the Himalaya, where retreating glaciers, unstable mountain slopes and large quantities of loose sediment can combine to produce destructive flows.

What caused the Gorkha flash flood?

The immediate trigger appears to have involved a sudden release of water and debris, but the precise mechanism has not been conclusively established.

Manish Mehta, a glaciologist at the Wadia Institute of Himalayan Geology in Uttarakhand's Dehradun, told *The Indian Express* that based on the available visuals and reports, the event appeared consistent with a possible glacial lake outburst flood or an avalanche involving ice and rock.

Why do these floods carry so much mud and rock?

Mehta explained that high-altitude Himalayan terrain contains large quantities of loose material shaped by erosion and past glacial activity. Glaciers transport and deposit sediment, while weathering and erosion continue to break down mountain slopes.

The loose material in upper mountain valleys can be mobilised by rainfall or a sudden release of water. As the surge moves down the valley, it picks up additional sediment, boulders and vegetation, turning into a dense slurry.

• ROLE OF WARMING

- Climate change is altering the conditions in which Himalayan hazards develop.
- In areas where ice helps bind material together, changes in temperature and melting can make slopes more susceptible to failure.

P D Pant, director of the School of Earth and Environmental Science at Uttarakhand Open University, also highlighted the sediment content visible in footage of the flood going around on social media.

Thus, the danger is not determined by water volume alone. A flood carrying heavy rocks and dense sediment can exert enormous force on houses, bridges and roads.

What is the danger in India?

The same broad categories of hazards exist across the Indian Himalaya, including Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, Ladakh, Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh.

The 2013 Kedarnath disaster involved exceptionally heavy rainfall, flooding and the mobilisation of sediment and debris.

The 2021 Chamoli disaster involved a massive rock-and-ice mass movement in the Rishiganga valley that generated a destructive downstream surge. Pant said "similar hazards could occur across the Himalayan arc, from Kashmir to Arunachal Pradesh, including Uttarakhand."

How much is climate change responsible?

Climate change is altering the conditions in which Himalayan hazards develop, but it does not establish the cause of any individual flood. In areas where ice helps bind material together, changes in temperature and melting can make slopes more susceptible to failure. Pant said climate change was the biggest factor behind retreating glaciers.

Scientific research, including assessments by the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change, has documented glacier loss across the Hindu Kush Himalaya and other mountain regions. This supports the conclusion that warming is changing the physical environment in which mountain hazards occur.

What is the way forward?

For Uttarakhand and the other Himalayan states in India, the challenge is to identify vulnerable lakes and unstable slopes, monitor changes and ensure that information reaches downstream settlements quickly enough for people to act. Satellite observations can help map lakes, track glacier retreat and identify changes in the landscape. But satellite monitoring alone may not provide the real-time information needed to detect a rapidly rising lake or an impending failure of a natural dam. This is where ground-based sensors can help.

Mehta emphasised the need for early-warning systems across the Himalayan terrain. Pant similarly said sensors could, where conditions allow, provide warnings hours in advance, giving authorities time to evacuate vulnerable settlements.

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• LAW

Protests vs 'public order': Prevention and policing

The protest restrictions in Delhi raise questions about the right to peaceful assembly, preventive policing and the Supreme Court's proportionality test



DEEPTIMAN TIWARY

THE SWEEPING restrictions imposed in Delhi amid protests demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar — prohibitory orders, detentions, barricades, Metro restrictions and cancellation of trains — and the denotification of Jantar Mantar as a protest site have brought an old constitutional tension back into focus.

The Constitution guarantees citizens the right to speech and peaceful assembly. But these rights are not absolute, and the police are not required to wait for violence before acting: preventive policing is both a power and, in certain circumstances, a statutory duty.

Can the State stop a peaceful protest in absence of permission?

Articles 19(1)(a) and 19(1)(b) guarantee freedom of speech and expression and the right to assemble peacefully and without arms. But Articles 19(2) and 19(3) permit reasonable restrictions, including in the interests of public order.

This means the right to protest does not translate into a right to assemble at any place, in any number and under any conditions.

A former Delhi Police Commissioner told *The Indian Express* that from a policing perspective, whether a gathering is peaceful is not the only question. If protesters have permission to assemble at Jantar Mantar but begin marching towards Parliament, "even if peacefully", they have breached the conditions under which the assembly was permitted, the officer said.

The Supreme Court has accepted the principle of regulation. In *Himat Lal K Shah vs Commissioner of Police* (1973), it held that the State can regulate assemblies on public streets since streets have competing public uses. But regulation cannot become an arbitrary power to prohibit assemblies altogether.

That distinction returned in *Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan vs Union of India* (2018), concerning protests at Jantar Mantar. The court rejected a blanket prohibition and required authorities to devise a regulatory mechanism balancing protesters' rights against those of residents and commuters.



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi heading towards the Supreme Court on Monday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

"If police consider a venue inappropriate because of its capacity or security concerns, an alternative should ideally be provided — for instance, Ramlila Maidan for a gathering too large for Jantar Mantar," the former Delhi police commissioner said.

Can violence at an earlier protest justify restrictions on the next one?

Delhi Police has cited events during the July 20 protests in assessing the risks surrounding the latest mobilisation.

Legally, the police can take past conduct into consideration. Preventive policing itself has statutory backing. Section 168 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), replacing Section 149 CrPC, requires police officers, to the best of their ability, to prevent cognisable offences.

But previous violence does not create an unlimited power to prohibit every subsequent gathering.

The Supreme Court has long required a close relationship between the anticipated danger and preventive action. *In Madhu Limaye vs Sub-Divisional Magistrate* (1970), while upholding the predecessor Section 144 CrPC, it stressed the urgency and gravity necessary to exercise such extraordinary power.

In *Anuradha Bhasin vs Union of India* (2020), the court said preventive orders could be passed against an apprehended danger — the State need not wait for violence to actually occur — but the danger must warrant emergency action and restrictions must satisfy proportionality. Section 144, it said, could not be used to suppress legitimate democratic expression.

The Supreme Court's intervention arising from the July protests is significant.

Discretion question

Over the weekend, the Court intervened again over restrictions surrounding the latest protests, stressing free movement and lawful policing.

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"The problem is SC has itself not yet spelt out restrictions to Article 19 (2). The principle of proportionality is not clearly defined. As long as it remains so, the State will have discretion," a former UP DGP said.

In August, it constituted a High-Powered Enquiry Committee whose terms include examining blanket Section 163 [Power to issue order in urgent cases of nuisance or apprehended danger] orders so that they do not become a routine or pre-emptive means of foreclosing peaceful assembly.

How far can preventive policing go?

Delhi Police had sought the closure of entry and exit gates at 57 Metro stations, saying protesters could use the network to gather and move towards sensitive areas. Indian Railways also cancelled 245 trains originating from or terminating in Delhi.

Police sources have told *The Indian Express* that the railway decision followed an analysis of the July 20 mobilisation. According to that assessment, a protest that began with the pressure group Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) subsequently drew manpower from Opposition parties.

Party workers travelled to Delhi from several states over days, including by train, swelling numbers beyond what the police had anticipated.

The law allows police to anticipate such situations. The former Delhi Police Commissioner recalled earlier rail roko, chakka jam and Bharat bandh agitations where thousands were preventively detained.

On October 9, however, the Supreme Court questioned the proposed transport restrictions, cautioning against using a "hammer to kill a fly". It said measures could regulate transport where necessary but should not indiscriminately shut it down.

A former Uttar Pradesh DGP put the counter-question, "How can the State presume that thousands of ordinary people travelling in Metro trains and railway coaches will be violent? The principle of proportionality has to apply."

He added, "The question to be asked is could the perceived threat have been dealt with through targeted policing of particular stations and routes, crowd caps, selective access restrictions or interception of identified groups rather than disruption affecting large numbers of unrelated passengers?"

What about the sensitivity of Delhi's VIP zone?

Parliament, Rashtrapati Bhavan, Central Vista, the Supreme Court and other sensitive establishments lie within a relatively small area of central Delhi. Police therefore have concerns that do not necessarily arise at an ordinary protest site.

Crowd size matters too. The former Delhi Police Commissioner pointed out that a designated site has finite capacity. "Physical restraint may become necessary when agreed conditions break down," he said.

The Supreme Court's Shaheen Bagh judgment similarly made clear that the right to dissent does not permit indefinite occupation of public roads. But there is another side. Protest is not merely physical assembly; it is communication.

"Protesters naturally seek to be near the institution from which they demand action. Sending demonstrators to a remote location where they can keep sitting till eternity without being noticed can render the exercise meaningless," he said.

Who decides what is 'too far'?

Ultimately, the police make the first call. But their assessment is not beyond judicial review.

"Yes, there is another view, which the CJP articulates. Why should you need permission for a peaceful protest in a democracy. For that, there should be a new law. As long as there is a law asking police to do something, it will do it," the former Delhi police commissioner said.

That is where the courts come in. Constitutional courts can examine existing provisions and determine whether the restrictions were necessary and proportionate.

The SC has taken cognizance of this. Its committee examining the July violence has been asked to scrutinise both alleged excesses by security personnel and violence attributed to protesters, while separately examining the use of blanket Section 163 orders.

• DEFENCE

How INS Mangrol plugs gaps in anti-submarine operations

Sushant Kulkarni
Pune, October 13

IN A boost to India's coastal defence and Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW) capabilities, the Indian Navy commissioned INS Mangrol at Mumbai's Naval Dockyard on Monday.

The third Mahe-class ASW Shallow-Water Craft (SWC) can track and hunt underwater threats, strengthening maritime surveillance and safeguarding critical coastal approaches — especially in the littoral zone, the strategically and economically critical shallow and near-shore maritime zone.

Latest Mahe-class ship

INS Mangrol is the third of the eight indigenously designed and built Mahe-class ASW-SWCs being built by Cochin Shipyard Ltd (CSL) at Kochi.

In total, 16 ASW-SWCs are being constructed by the CSL and the Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE), Kolkata. With over 80% indigenous content, the programme reflects India's expanding capabilities in defence shipbuilding, the Ministry of Defence has said.

INS Mangrol is named after the prominent fishing harbour of Mangrol in Gujarat's Junagadh, reflecting the region's rich maritime heritage.



INS Mangrol at the Naval Dockyard in Mumbai on Monday. PTI

Features of the Mahe class

The Mahe-class vessels adhere to the classification standards of Det Norske Veritas (DNV), an internationally recognised body that certifies ships against rigorous technical and safety requirements.

They are the Indian Navy's largest warships to use a diesel engine-waterjet propulsion system, combining improved manoeuvrability with reduced underwater noise. While their primary role is anti-submarine warfare in coastal waters, the vessels are also designed for underwater surveillance, search and rescue (SAR), Low Intensity Maritime Operations (LIMO) and mine-laying.

Crucial for India

- The fleet of anti-submarine warfare Shallow-Water Craft addresses a critical capability gap by tracking and engaging submarines.

CSL has stated that each vessel is 78 metres long, has a beam, or maximum width, of 11.36 metres, and a displacement ranging from 896 to 1,100 tonnes. The ships are equipped to operate indigenously developed sonar systems that use sound waves to detect underwater objects.

Their advanced sensors, weapons and communication suites enable the detection, tracking and engagement of underwater threats. The class also features sophisticated systems for sustained operations in shallow waters. Its armament includes torpedoes, multifunctional anti-submarine rockets.

Managing sub-surface threats

Before the ASW-SWC programme, the Indian Navy relied on four Abhay-class corvettes (faster and smaller ships) for coastal patrol and ASW.

After decades of service, they were decommissioned between 2017 and 2025. To replace them and bolster coastal defence, the Defence Acquisition Council (DAC) approved the procurement of 16 ASW-SWCs in December 2013 for Rs 13,000 crore.

Contracts were subsequently awarded to CSL and GRSE to build eight vessels each. With a coastline stretching approximately 11,000 km, 12 major ports, 184 minor ports and 1,197 islands, India requires specialised platforms for underwater threats.

The 16 vessels are divided into two classes. GRSE is building the Arnala-class, comprising INS Arnala, Androth, Anjadip, Amini, Abhay, Agray, Ajay and Akshay. CSL is constructing the Mahe-class, comprising INS Mahe, Malvan, Mangrol, Malpe, Mulki, Magdala and Machilipatnam. The fleet will likely be inducted over the next three years.

It addresses a critical capability gap by tracking and engaging submarines, particularly stealthy diesel-electric types close to shore. Their shallow draught, advanced sonar systems and high manoeuvrability make them well-suited to safeguard harbour approaches, shipping lanes, offshore energy installations and key naval bases.

The Navy will thus gain a dedicated force for coastal anti-submarine operations, freeing larger warships to focus on missions in deeper waters. The fleet will also complicate covert underwater approaches by adversaries, strengthening India's maritime security posture in the Indian Ocean Region. Working alongside coastal radar networks, underwater sensors and maritime patrol aircraft, the vessels will contribute to a layered, largely indigenous ASW capability.

India will be leader in AI diffusion at scale: Nilekani

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, October 13

INDIA WILL be the leader in diffusing AI technology, and with its help, the new jobs will come from the small businesses in future, according to Nandan Nilekani, Chairman & Co-founder, Infosys.

In an interaction at Bloomberg New Economy forum 2026 in Delhi on Tuesday, Nilekani said that AI technology cannot be bottled up as there will be thousands of models coming up and it should not be looked at through "disaster marketing" lens.

"India is already a strong country for small business. That is where the job creation will come because a small company of 3-5 people, you cannot really automate those jobs because they do very complex things in the morning, they will pick up things in the afternoon and stack the shelf in the evening and deliver. These are actually AI-proof jobs. So once India unleashes its small business economy, millions of small companies will hire a couple of people each, and that is how jobs will happen. So we will see a new job creation, enabled by open networks and AI, which is a paradigm we have not seen, therefore we cannot visualise it," said Nilekani, in conversation with John Fraher, Co-head of APAC News, Bloomberg.

While he did not give any timeline for this to happen, he said entrepreneurs and small businesses will benefit from access to markets, capital, knowledge, agents to make their lives easier, and become engines of job creation. Nilekani said that coding as an activity will become much more productive.

'RBI WILL CONTINUE TO STOP VOLATILITY IN THE RUPEE BUT NOT FIX A LEVEL'

LTCG tax debate 'healthy', keen to hear about it: FM

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 13

FINANCE MINISTER Nirmala Sitharaman sent stock markets soaring on Tuesday, saying that the debate on long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax is "healthy" and she is "keen" to hear about it.

Speaking at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum, Sitharaman also said the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) "will continue" to stop volatility in the rupee but not "fix" a level.

Quizzed on comments by certain foreign investors that they are waiting for the removal of the capital gains tax so that they can invest in India, the finance minister said considering that work on 2027-28 Union Budget has begun, it may not be the best time for her to say "what I will or what I will not consider. So, I'll tread cautiously on that".

The finance ministry started its pre-budget meetings on October 12. The budget is usually presented in Parliament on February 1.

In her response, Sitharaman said both domestic and foreign investors ask and comment about the LTCG tax and the securities transaction tax (STT) and the debate on "tax in the market" and the tax treatment for all asset classes "has been a very well discussed topic".

"Two years ago, we had brought all asset classes similarly and people thought I'm increasing the tax. I wasn't increasing the tax; I was bringing all of them to be at par with one another so that an investor is not speculating as to which one gives them greater leverage. So, these are things on which there's a lot of debate. It's healthy to have this debate and I will be keen to hear them," Sitharaman said.

The finance minister made the comments during market hours. The Sensex and the Nifty extended gains after her remarks, closing the day 1.5% and 1.6% higher, respectively.



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman in a panel discussion at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum, in New Delhi. ANI

Markets surge 1.6% on hopes of capital gains tax relief

Mumbai: Stock markets staged a sharp rally on Tuesday, with benchmark indices surging around 1.6%, after Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman indicated the government would consider stakeholders' views on the removal of long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax during Budget consultations, describing the debate over securities transaction tax (STT) as healthy.

The Sensex climbed 1.54%, gaining 1,109.10 points to close at 73,033.78, while the NSE Nifty jumped 358.60 points, or 1.60%, to settle at 22,721.95.

It offered a reprieve to investors after a prolonged period of weakness, with buying interest extending across several sectors.

"There's an indication that the government is likely to reduce the LTCG and STT. The market has been going down for the last one year," said a market observer. The Sensex has fallen 15% in the last one year. The rally also underscored how sensitive investor sentiment remains to policy signals, even in the absence of a concrete announcement. ENS

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

India levies a 12.5% tax on long-term capital gains, which accrue when an asset is sold after one year of its purchase.

Last week, Soumya Kanti Ghosh, State Bank of India's Group Chief Economic Adviser, said the government needs to "support the RBI in its quest" to stabilise the rupee, which was veering close to its all-time low of 96.96-per-dollar last week before the central bank announced measures early Saturday to dampen speculative forex market activity and made hedging forex exposures expensive.

"There is a serious need to relook at enhancing flows of patient capital in debt, as also equities tweaking the tax and capital gains structure suitably as the fight for capital is just getting murkier globally and non-AI heavyweights put us on the wrong end of the see-saw," Ghosh said in a report on October 9.

Earlier this year on June 5, the government scrapped the withholding tax as well as long and short-term capital gains tax on foreign investors' investments in government bonds to attract overseas funds.

This came amid heavy pressure on the rupee, which had almost breached the 97-per-dollar mark in May amid continued dumping of Indian stocks and debt by foreign investors.

Before the June 5 decision, foreign investors paid 12.5% tax on long-term capital gains, 30% on short-term capital gains, and around 20% withholding tax on interest income from their government bond holdings. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

P2M UPI PAYMENTS OF OVER RS 2K FACED MDR FROM OCT 15

UPI merchant fee deferred until after Diwali, says NPCI

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 13

THE NATIONAL Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) on Tuesday said the merchant discount rate (MDR) on person-to-merchant payments will only come into force after Diwali.

Diwali is on November 8.

"UPI and Services Steering Committee today decided that, keeping in mind the festive season, merchant discount rate (MDR) on select person-to-merchant (P2M) UPI transactions, shall be implemented immediately post Diwali on a date to be notified separately," the NPCI said in a statement.

Consumer spending typically spikes around the festival.

There have been fears that the implementation of the merchant fee could hurt spending amid warnings from retailers that they will pass on the additional cost to buyers.

Announced by NPCI last month, UPI payments of more than Rs 2,000 are to attract a merchant fee of 0.4% under the revised MDR framework. This fee will be paid by merchants. Person-to-person UPI transactions will not attract any fee. UPI payments to merchants of less than Rs 2,000 will not face a fee. Furthermore, merchants who get less than Rs 1 lakh per month as UPI payments are exempt from any MDR.

Person-to-merchant transactions of more than Rs 2,000 account for only 4% of all P2M payments in volume terms but around two-thirds in value terms.

The 0.4% fee on person-to-merchant transactions has been capped at Rs 300 per transaction.

Further, capital market transactions face a lower rate of 0.02%, while a flat fee of Rs 5, irrespective of the size of the payment above Rs 2,000, has been put in place for certain payments, such as rail tickets, fuel and agricultural inputs, telecom or utility bills, insurance premiums, and tax payments, among others.

This flat-fee model is to stop costs from rising in critical public services, utility bill collection, and sectors with thin profit margins.

However, despite assertions from the government that this fee will not be passed on to consumers, with banks being advised to ensure the same, retailers have said it will eat into their margins and hit the usage of UPI.

Certain retailer bodies have also warned that this may be passed on to consumers or lead to a shift to cash payments.

The MDR on UPI was announced after the payments industry expressed concerns for several years that the infrastructure and transaction settlement costs were rising.

According to estimates, the total cost to the industry is around Rs 20,000 crore per year. The proposed fee structure may bring in about Rs 15,000 crore, insiders said.

While lower than the 1-3% charge that merchants pay on debit and credit card payments, the 0.4% fee on UPI payments of over Rs 2,000 to merchants will provide the money for continuous technological innovation and allow new fintech startups and technology companies to enter the digital payments space and compete with "well-capitalised tech conglomerates", the NPCI said last month.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM



Hyundai chief calls on PM Modi

Hyundai Motor Group Executive Chair Euisun Chung discussed the South Korean auto major's investment strategy for India, entailing commitments of $15.5 billion from 2026 through 2032, during a meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the PMO on Tuesday. HYUNDAI

Enough demand for AI with profitability in sight: Infosys CEO

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, October 13

THERE IS enough demand for AI, and Infosys is harnessing it by helping clients build agents, streamline change management, and drive technology transformation, its MD and CEO Salil Parekh said.

"The way Infosys is working on this, we've built AI services which do the work that we've all been discussing...building agents, looking at coding, making sure there's transformation of technology, change management, and that work we shared last quarter is eight percent of our revenue, but growing at an incredible pace.

"Double-digit quarter-on-quarter. So that already tells us that there's a huge demand, even if it's small today in terms of relative size for Infosys, it's growing at a fantastic pace," Parekh said, speaking at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum.

He was speaking in a panel consisting of other tech experts like Tillman Global Holdings CEO Sanjiv Ahuja, NTT Data CEO Abhijit Dubey, and Brookfield Asset Management CEO Connor Teskey.

"I think we are barely scratching the surface on the demand side of the equation. So if you look at token consumption today, we've got 30 million software developers, and sort of a fraction of it is where it's mostly concentrated, along with some research kind of work. We've got a billion knowledge workers. We're barely scratching the surface of that," according to Dubey.

In fact, Teskey of Brookfield said that "the demand so overwhelms supply at this point that there is going to be a supply-demand imbalance through the end of this decade and probably far beyond that."

This is, in contrast, to the "somewhat detached" narrative that AI demand is fragile, and that the supply chain is inefficient, he added.

A lot of experts have theorised that AI-driven optimism is actually a "bubble" leading to high costs and chip shortages amid a lack of profitability, but Dubey believes that this profitability is in sight.

"We're still in very early stages, but I think the recipe is starting to become a little bit clearer in terms of how you truly see it in your P&L. We used to joke that AI is everywhere, except in the P&L," said Dubey.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

India may need additional coal power by 2035: CEA chairman

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, October 13

INDIA MAY need to add 105-150 gigawatts (GW) of coal-based power capacity by 2035, significantly more than the 97 GW currently planned, to meet rising electricity demand and ensure a stable power supply, Ghanshyam Prasad, chairperson of the country's top power planner Central Electricity Authority (CEA), said on Tuesday.

Speaking at the 20th India Energy Summit organised by the Indian Chamber of Commerce, Prasad stressed the need to maintain adequate baseload capacity to address the challenges posed by the intermittency of renewable energy sources. Solar and wind power generation fluctuates depending on weather conditions, while the limited availability of energy storage restricts the ability to use surplus renewable power to meet evening and night-time demand.

Prasad's remarks signal the need for a reassessment of India's planned coal-based capacity additions, even as the country continues to expand its renewable energy capacity.

The country has witnessed an unusual surge in electricity demand this year, putting additional pressure on coal-based power plants amid deficient monsoon rainfall and lower hydropower generation.

Coal-based sources generated nearly 10% higher electricity between April and August compared to the same period last year.

Between April and August, coal-based sources generated 579,869.38 million (MU) against 527,542.87 MU in the corresponding period last year.

Generation from coal-based sources was also the highest recorded for the April-August period in the past three years.

In contrast, hydropower generation fell by over 11% to 75,304.58 MU during April-August period this year, from 84,767.77 MU in the corresponding period last year.

Stress on coal-based plants are also reflected in depleting coal stocks in these plants.

Fuel stocks at domestic coal-based power plants have declined by around 66% by the end of September this year, compared with a decline of around 23% during the same period last year, when stocks fell from 55.2 million tonnes at the beginning of April to 42.6 million tonnes by the end of September.

Prasad said electricity demand was running 45-50 GW higher than last year, adding to concerns over coal supplies and the availability of power plants for scheduled maintenance.

"The stock is depleting almost every day. We need to put these plants under maintenance as well. We are not finding time to put them on the maintenance cycle," he said, highlighting the challenges facing the power sector.

The situation, he said, underscored the need for a judicious mix of energy sources rather than relying on one or two resources.

"We need to have a good amount of baseload stations," Prasad said.

"It was good that 4 to 5 years back we reverted our policy and said that we need a huge addition of coal-based generation," he added. The emphasis on additional coal capacity marks a shift from the position outlined in the National Electricity Plan in 2018, which said India would not require any new coal-based capacity beyond projects already planned.

However, Prasad said a greater focus on baseload power did not mean renewable energy would take a back seat. The country would continue adding around 50 GW of renewable energy capacity annually, with nuclear power and pumped-hydro storage also contributing to the electricity mix, he said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Noel Tata, Neville file caveats amid Tata Trusts dispute

Mumbai: Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata and trustee Neville Tata have filed caveats before the High Court and the City Civil Court amid the ongoing dispute over the governance and functioning of the Tata Trusts. The caveats have named fellow trustees Venu Srinivasan, Vijay Singh, Darius Khambata and Bhaskar Bhat as caveatees.

The filings are aimed at ensuring that Noel and Neville are given prior notice and an opportunity to present their arguments before either court passes an order that could affect their interests, particularly in the form of interim or ex parte relief. Neville, son of Noel Tata, is a trustee of Sir Dorabji Tata Trust.

The filings indicate that Tata Trusts are preparing the ground for a legal battle. ENS

• BRIEFLY

Mandatory monitoring agency for all IPOs on the anvil

New Delhi: SEBI on Tuesday proposed making the appointment of a monitoring agency mandatory for all public issues, irrespective of their size, and imposing a fine of Rs 50,000 on listed companies for each instance of non-cooperation in monitoring the utilisation of issue proceeds. The proposals form part of a broader review of SEBI's Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements Regulations, 2015, aimed at strengthening transparency and accountability in the utilisation of funds raised through public issues. PTI

Adani Entp, Jabil sign pact for hardware joint venture

New Delhi: Adani Enterprises and US-based manufacturing firm Jabil have signed a non-binding agreement to set up a 50:50 joint venture to manufacture artificial intelligence and data centre equipment in India as demand for computing infrastructure accelerates. The proposed venture would make and assemble AI racks, servers, storage and networking equipment, alongside power distribution systems, liquid-cooling equipment and transformers. PTI

MSMEs need to improve quality to tap global market: Secy

New Delhi: Indian micro, small and medium enterprisesneed to improve product quality, embrace technology and strengthen export capabilities to leverage opportunities from free trade agreements and shifting global supply chains, MSME Secretary Bharat Khera said on Tuesday. Khera said the government is pursuing a comprehensive approach to strengthen the competitiveness, focusing on five key areas -- formalisation, access to finance, technology adoption, export competitiveness and entrepreneurship & skilling. PTI

• CO-FOUNDER AND CHIEF SCIENTIST SRIDHAR VEMBU SAYS BUSINESS OUTLOOK FOR SOFTWARE IS UNCERTAIN AND AI HAS RAISED COSTS DRAMATICALLY

'Zoho unable to provide pay rise to employees due to AI costs'

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, October 13

Days after his appeal to Indians in the US to return home and build in India following disruptions to the Green Card process, Zoho co-founder and chief scientist Sridhar Vembu said Tuesday that the rising costs due to AI have led to his company not being able to provide the "usual pay increase" to its employees this year.

This, along with challenging geopolitical conditions, made it unavoidable despite the company cutting its marketing budget, he said in a social media post.

"The business outlook for software is uncertain and AI has raised costs dramatically with a) massive 4-fold increase in server prices which we need for data centers b) AI usage increasing rapidly, leading to much higher expenses, which we are trying to control. On top of that is the challenging geopolitical backdrop," Vembu said in a post on social media platform 'X' early on Tuesday.

"We have cut down on our marketing budget. We have also told our employees that we cannot have our usual pay increase this year. I have apologized for not being able to avoid this. We will work hard to avoid mass layoffs but the outlook for software jobs in general is grim. We have not been growing our employee count for 18 months now," he further wrote.

Rounding off his rather concerning assessment of the situation and the impact of AI, Vembu said, "We are in the middle of reinventing ourselves. The next 3-5 years will decide how our reinvention has worked. Please pray for us."

Difficult times for the industry

His comments come at a time when investments in AI, especially in countries like the US, South Korea, and Taiwan, have continued to ramp up despite little visibility on profitability. American big tech companies and hyperscalers like Google, Meta, and Nvidia have committed a combined capital expenditure of nearly $700 billion this year towards building data centres. While these massive expenses have yet to see significant profitability, they have led to prices of components like chips, memory, and other components surging to an extent that even the biggest companies have started passing on costs to customers, having absorbed it until now.

Apple, for example, hiked prices across its portfolio by as much as 42% in June this year. "We have never seen a component price increase this much, this quickly. We have shielded our customers from these increases so far, but we have now reached a point where we need to begin raising prices on a number of products, including today's increases for iPad and Mac," the company said in its statement.



'Pray for us', Vembu said in a post on X. EXPRESS

• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▼
73,033.78	22,721.95	₹1,47,617	₹95.28
1109.10	358.60	Silver ▼	Oil ▲
1.54%	1.60%	₹2,19,038	$125.72

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF OCTOBER 12, 2026

Received no warning from partners about Russian strike, says Zelenskyy

Hanna Arhoriva & Justin Spike
Kyiv, October 13

UKRAINE RECEIVED no early warning from its partners about a Russian ballistic missile strike on Kyiv in which five missiles hit civilian infrastructure, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Tuesday in a post on X.

Zelenskyy characterized the barrage on the capital as "particularly vile," and emphasized that receiving intelligence from Ukraine's partners on such ballistic missile attacks "helps save lives, and this is one of the most critical issues."

"This is precisely what helps prevent people from being killed — when there is an early warning about ballistic missiles," he wrote. He did not apportion blame for the lack of warning.

Russia's war in Ukraine hasn't seen major shifts on the ground since last year, but Ukraine is struggling to fend off Moscow's intensified aerial attacks on cities that include speedy ballistic missiles and high-flying jet-powered drones.

Zelenskyy said Russia had attacked Ukraine with more than 100 weapons since Monday evening.

Among the damage was a residential building in the northeastern city of Kharkiv that was destroyed, killing four people despite an all-night rescue operation, he said.

Russia has increasingly used attacks on civilian infrastructure such as energy facilities to deny Ukrainians power, heat and running water during the 4 1/2-year war, hoping to wear down public support for Ukraine's response to Moscow's full-scale invasion. **AP**

11 sailors missing after drone sinks cargo vessel off Bulgaria

Alex Lefkowitz
Sofia, October 13

ELEVEN SAILORS were missing at sea on Tuesday from a ship sunk by a drone attack off the coast of Bulgaria, possibly the second deadly sinking of a cargo vessel in the area in a week, prompting Bulgaria to summon Russia's ambassador.

Two cargo ships were hit by drones overnight and one was sunk, Bulgarian officials said. Bulgaria stopped short of explicitly accusing Russia of carrying out the attacks but Prime Minister Rumen Radev said their outcome "benefits the Russian Federation".

There was no immediate comment from Moscow on the incidents.

"This is absolutely unacceptable — another attack in the immediate vicinity of Bulgarian territorial waters," Radev said in a televised address. The attacks were also condemned by Ukraine and the EU.

"The Black Sea has become another front of escalation of the Russian war in Ukraine," European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen said on X. "Those responsible should be held accountable." **REUTERS**

ANKARA WILL STAND BY RIYADH, ERDOGAN TELLS SAUDI CROWN PRINCE

Saudis strike Yemen's Capital, Houthis promise retaliation

Attacks follow Saudi warning to civilians to stay away from oil depot near Sanaa

Timour Azhari & Menna AlaaElDin
Riyadh, October 13

YEMEN'S IRAN-allied Houthis said Saudi Arabia was attacking the Yemeni capital Sanaa on Tuesday after a Saudi-led coalition warned civilians to stay away from an oil depot on the city outskirts, part of a rapidly escalating war between the sides.

The Houthis have for a week been targeting Saudi airports, including a strike on Riyadh on Saturday that killed 13 people, in retaliation for the kingdom's backing of government forces against the Houthis in Yemen's reignited civil war.

Houthi-run Al-Masirah television reported that the Saudi-led coalition had targeted the Yemen Petroleum Company's Sabah central station, a fuel depot on the outskirts of Sanaa. YPC said the facility did not currently hold any stocks of petroleum products and that targeting it did not affect oil reserves or supply chains.

However, the Houthis had earlier threatened a "harsh and painful" response to any strikes on Sanaa, with spokesperson Yahya Saree saying targets could include the Saudi Aramco headquarters in Dhahran and an oil refinery in Riyadh. The group renewed earlier warnings it had issued to oil workers in Saudi Arabia, telling them to stay away from sites that could be potential targets.

The Saudi cabinet, chaired by de facto ruler Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, issued a statement saying the Houthis would face consequences for their repeated attacks on the kingdom.

Turkish President Tayyip Erdogan told Mohammed bn Salman on Tuesday that Ankara would stand by the kingdom, the Turkish presidency said, but without giving details. **REUTERS**



A building damaged during fighting in 2015, with Arabic graffiti that reads, 'There was a life in our home', in Mualla district of Aden, Yemen, on Tuesday. AP

Houthis are behaving very badly: Trump

Washington: US President Donald Trump on Tuesday accused Yemen's Houthi militants of deliberately trying to drive up oil prices ahead of the US midterm elections and warned that he would "never forget" their attacks on Saudi Arabia, amid a widening regional conflict fueled by the US war with Iran. "The Houthis are behaving very badly," Trump wrote in a Truth Social post, accusing the group of resuming attacks at Iran's behest after a period of relative quiet following US strikes in Yemen last year.

Trump also made clear that his warning would extend beyond the November 3 midterm elections, saying, "I'll be there after the elections, and I will never forget!"

Earlier, Trump told reporters he "might" ask Turkish President Tayyip Erdogan to intervene in support of Saudi interests. "President Erdogan, I think, would do as I ask," he said. **PTI**

'Cowardly act': Imran's son slams emergency in Pakistan's KPK

Press Trust of India
Lahore, October 13

SON OF jailed former prime minister Imran Khan on Tuesday called the Pakistan government's decision to impose an emergency in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province a "cowardly act" even as his father's party accused the army of going after the rare earth deposits in the region.

President Asif Ali Zardari on Sunday proclaimed Articles 232(1) and 234(1) of the Constitution to declare an emergency in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, citing the deteriorating law and order situation, bringing the provincial government led by jailed former prime minister Imran Khan's Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI) party to an end.

"The tyrannical crooks in charge of Pakistan continue to dismantle democracy, now arresting the elected chief minister of KPK. The world must see what's happening. Repeated disgraceful and cowardly acts from Munir to stifle the voice of the people to cling onto power. Disgraceful," Imran Khan's son Kasim Khan posted on social media. Khan, 73, was arrested on August 5, 2023, in a corruption case and has remained in custody since then. He has been lodged in Adiala Jail, a detention facility on the outskirts of Rawalpindi. His two sons, Sulaiman Khan and Kasim Khan, are British citizens.

Meanwhile, PTI said in a statement on Tuesday that the emergency was imposed in the province because of its natural resources: oil, gas, and minerals.

KPK CM named in 2023 Radio Pakistan attack

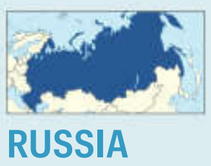
FORMER KHYBER Pakhtunkhwa chief minister Sohail Afridi and four other Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI) leaders on Tuesday were named in the 2023 attack on a state-run radio station building in Peshawar, police said.

The Radio Pakistan Peshawar Building was stormed, ransacked, and set on fire in May 2023 by violent protesters following the arrest of former prime minister and PTI founder Imran Khan.

The investigating officer, DSP Khushal Khan, appeared before the Anti-Terrorism Court and submitted the charge sheet to the District Public Prosecutor. The court also obtained identity verification reports from the National Database and Registration Authority (NADRA) and the Punjab Forensic Science Agency. **PTI**

MI5 lists Russia, Iran, AI and terrorists among threats to UK

MI5 spy chief Ken McCallum delivered his annual speech on Tuesday outlining the threats to Britain. Here is a summary of what he said in his speech. **REUTERS**



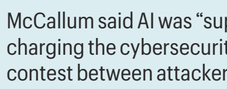
RUSSIA

McCallum called Russia "aggressor number one". He said it was escalating "hybrid" warfare, staying below the threshold that would trigger a direct NATO response. He said Russia's capabilities had been reduced by the expulsion of 1,000 officials from embassies since the invasion of Ukraine, which meant it had to rely on native volunteers and criminal proxies.



IRAN

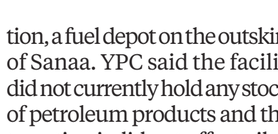
Tehran is also using criminal proxies - to target opponents, Iranian media organisations and Israeli interests in Britain - and has expanded its hybrid campaign in the last year, McCallum said. He said operations connected to Iran had yielded more than 50 arrests in the UK, and that many had been aimed at Jewish communities.



AI

McCallum said AI was "supercharging the cybersecurity contest between attackers and defenders", producing tailored propaganda and material for individuals.

MI5 has caught potential attackers using it to try to improve reconnaissance and attack methodologies. AI-enabled drones added a new challenge, he said.



TERRORISM

McCallum said Al Qaeda and IS continued to inspire plots, and MI5 was still having to respond to attempted attacks. He said the most marked trend had been the increase in cases where extreme anti-immigration and anti-Muslim grievances were tipping over into terrorist intent.

BREXIT

McCallum said it was public knowledge that Russian media "came in pretty strongly around the time of the referendum", and there had been a certain amount of activity from trolls and bots. But he said Russian online trolling had been comparatively unimpressive.

"The greatest concern about the misuse of AI is terrorists developing bioweapons or even creating new pathogens."
KEN MCCALLUM, MI5 SPY CHIEF





For Better Schools, Songs of Protest

Orchestra musicians play during a demonstration by French students in front of the City Hall in Paris on Tuesday. The nationwide students-led protests seeking better school conditions are supported by teachers, parents and labour unions. REUTERS

AI models may soon self-replicate across smart home devices: Anthropic

Reuters
October 13

ANTHROPIC SAID on Monday that small AI models could be months away from self-replicating across internet-connected devices, raising the possibility of AI botnets spreading quickly, fighting takedown attempts and even breaking into data centres to turbocharge their growth.

Last month, Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei first floated the idea that within the next year or even sooner, AI might be able to hijack "the entire internet" with "a persistent botnet," a warning that raised eyebrows in the cybersecurity community.

Botnets — vast networks of devices controlled by malicious operators — have been around since the early days of the internet, and are still around.

The network typically includes poorly secured Internet of Things (IoT) devices, such as Android TV boxes, smart appliances and security cameras, and is used by hackers to send spam, seed malware, or sabotage target companies using floods of bogus traffic.

The company said that its experiments showed that a malicious AI agent could stitch together the computing power of inexpensive internet-connected devices to run other AI models. It added that the models were able to replicate across a simplified test network.

"A replicator like this would be challenging to shut down, since there's no centralised point to shut off," the company said.

The report adds to broader concerns about the security risks tied to increasingly capable AI systems, including their potential to automate cyberattacks, operate with limited human oversight and circumvent safeguards. The advances in models have prompted a series of often dire warnings from industry heads and AI company employees about the possibility of severe, even existential, risks of runaway AI development.

Anthropic said its experiments showed that models with 30 billion parameters or fewer can already perform many of the individual tasks required for self-replication, although they struggle to complete the entire process reliably.

Bangladesh PM's adviser warns of legal action over harassment of Yunus in US

Press Trust of India
Dhaka, October 13

AN ADVISER to Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman on Tuesday warned of "legal action" after former interim government chief Muhammad Yunus was heckled by purported supporters of the disbanded Awami League at New York's John F. Kennedy Airport.

"It will not go unchallenged," Zahed Ur Rahman told a media briefing, hours after Yunus faced the hecklers shouting aggressive slogans, which went viral on social media.

The Bangladesh PM's information and broadcasting adviser said the government viewed the incidents as "Awami League terror" and "definitely legal proceedings will be initiated against those committing this offence".

"I want to tell the Awami League members living in different countries that if they attempt such actions, they will not go unchallenged. There is no question of that," Zahed said, referring to the case of actress and activist Ajmeria Haque Badhon who was harassed in Italy.

• BRIEFLY

THE NETHERLANDS

Nobel Peace laureate: US should become rights defender again



Navi Pillay. REUTERS

NOBEL PEACE Prize winner Navi Pillay urged the US on Tuesday to resume its traditional role of defender of human rights and freedom for the rest of the world as Washington campaigns to undermine the International Criminal Court. "My message is: 'You have to get back to playing your serious role as a leader, playing a liberatory role for the rest of the world'," Pillay, 85, told Reuters in The Hague, where she is currently a judge at the United Nations' highest legal body, the International Court of Justice. Hours after Pillay was announced as the winner of the Peace Prize on Friday, the United States announced sweeping sanctions aimed at her former employer, the International Criminal Court. REUTERS

• DRAWING ON HIS REAL-LIFE STRUGGLE WITH CEREBRAL PALSY, MITTE BROUGHT AUTHENTICITY TO A TELEVISION CHARACTER WHOSE PHYSICAL DISABILITY WAS PORTRAYED AS LARGELY INCIDENTAL TO THE STORYLINE

'Breaking Bad' actor and disability rights activist RJ Mitte dies at 34

Steve Gorman
Los Angeles, October 13

ACTOR RJ Mitte, whose personal experience living with cerebral palsy informed his role as Walter White Jr, the physically disabled son of a methamphetamine kingpin in the landmark television series "Breaking Bad," died on Monday at age 34.

News of Mitte's death in Brownsville, Texas, was announced in a statement released through his talent management agency. A publicist for the actor later confirmed news reports that Mitte took his own life. No further details about the circumstances were given.

"It is with profound sadness that we share the tragic passing of beloved actor, philanthropist, and passionate disability rights advocate RJ Mitte," the initial statement said.

"Breaking Bad" star Bryan Cranston voiced his "deep despair" over the death of his "sweet son" on social media.

Mitte was best known for his breakout role on the AMC cable TV series "Breaking Bad," playing the only son of Cranston's lead character, Walter White, a terminally ill high school teacher who descends into a secret life of crime cooking crystal meth.

The acclaimed show, often cited by critics as one of the best television dramas of all time, ran from 2008 to 2013, garnering 16 Emmy Awards, including two for best drama series. Mitte was 14 when cast for the pilot episode, which began shooting in 2007, Cranston said.

Drawing on his real-life struggle with cerebral palsy, a chronic muscle-control disorder, Mitte brought a rare measure of authenticity to a television character whose physical disability was portrayed as largely incidental to the storyline.

His performance as Walter "Flynn" White Jr, who walked with crutches and spoke with a slur, gained early attention from fans who dubbed him "the breakfast king" for his recurring appearances in scenes around the family breakfast table.



RJ Mitte poses at the premiere for 'El Camino: A Breaking Bad Movie'

But his role grew in prominence as the story arc of the series progressed. He starts out as a carefree teenager who admires his father, then is forced to reckon with the family's disintegration as the truth about Walter White's meth-making "Heisenberg" alter ego emerges.

In a statement posted to Instagram on Monday night, Cranston ⊠paid tribute to Mitte, saying he was a "fine actor" and "vocal advocate for performers with disabilities."

"It is especially devastating to hear that he took his own life," Cranston wrote, adding he and Mitte "were texting each other just a few weeks ago" about possibly meeting for lunch.

"I don't know if that lunch would have changed his future," Cranston wrote. "But I do know that I loved him, and thoroughly enjoyed being with him throughout the years on the series, and after the spotlight on Breaking Bad dimmed. I'll miss you, son."

Despite his disability, Mitte "never-ever-allowed that challenge to be an excuse for anything" during the show's production, Cranston recalled. "He met the demanding shooting schedule head on with great determination."

Mitte later played a standup comedian with cerebral palsy in the 2019 romantic comedy film "Standing Up for Sunny" and a high school wrestler with CP in the 2021 coming-of-age film "Triumph."

Mitte, whose credits also include the films "The Recall" and "The Oak Room," had been working to promote a new movie, "Talking to Strangers," appearing as a podcast guest to discuss the film in recent days, according to Hollywood trade publication Variety.

Off screen, Mitte served as a Screen Actors Guild spokesman for performers with disabilities, and was a celebrity ambassador for the United Cerebral Palsy foundation.

Born in Jackson, Mississippi, Mitte suffered brain damage at birth, was adopted as an infant and was diagnosed with cerebral palsy at age 3. He was fitted with leg braces and crutches for much of his childhood, but through athletics and exercise eventually outgrew his need for walking devices. **REUTERS**

SALUTE THE SOLDIER



LT ATUL KATARYA, SM (POSTHUMOUS)
(21 FEB 1975 – 14 OCT 1998)

IC-56616A Lt Atul Katarya, Sena Medal laid down his life while fighting against Anti National Elements during "OPERATION RAKSHAK" in J&K while on attachment with 13 PUNJAB. In the true traditions of the Indian Army, Lt Atul Katarya displayed audacious initiative, presence of mind and exemplary courage by killing nine dreaded militants including a foreign militant before making the supreme sacrifice. He will always be remembered and missed by all of us in the Army Ordnance Corps for his supreme sacrifice and gallant act.

DG OS & Sr Colonel Commandant and all rks of the AOC



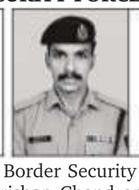
CT(GD)
Ghansham Gurjar

"Sashastra Seema Bal" solemnly remembers the selfless and valiant act of the braveheart, CT(GD) Ghansham Gurjar of 59th Bn SSB, Nanpara, who made the supreme sacrifice for the Nation. On this day, he attained martyrdom when militants opened indiscriminate fire on the SSB vehicle at Hobitabad, under Zakoora Police Station, in Srinagar (Jammu & Kashmir). He will always be remembered for his bravery, valour, and unwavering devotion to the Nation. His sacrifice will forever be etched in our hearts and continue to inspire generations to come.

"SASHASTRA SEEMA BAL"
BORDER SECURITY FORCE



HEAD CONSTABLE
KRISHAN CHAND
54 BN BSF
14.12.1951 –
14.10.1995



CONSTABLE/
DRIVER
MOHD O U
54 BN BSF
25.05.1967 –
14.10.1995

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Head Constable Krishan Chand and Constable/Driver Mohd O U on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast triggered by militants in Kupwara area (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



LANCE NAIK
PRAKASH KHOT
21 BN BSF
01.06.1964
– 14.10.1992

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Lance Naik Prakash Khot on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Srinagar area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



CONSTABLE
DEEN MOHD
102 BN BSF
16.03.1966
– 14.10.1990

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Deen Mohd on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Srinagar area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



HEAD CONSTABLE
DALBIR SINGH
128 BN BSF
04.03.1946 –
14.10.2001



HEAD CONSTABLE
SUNDER PAL
128 BN BSF
10.07.1965 –
14.10.2001



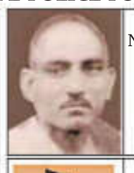
CONSTABLE
KUNWAR PAL
128 BN BSF
11.09.1965 –
14.10.2001

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Head Constables Dalbir Singh, Sunder Pal and Constable Kunwar Pal on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal injuries while fighting militants in Bishnupur area, Manipur and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE



Veer Balidani
Constable
Devi Dutt
1 Bn 14-10-1942
To 14-10-1966



Veer Balidani
Naik/ Radio Operator
Jai Dayal
1 Bn
9-9-1930 To
14-10-1966



Veer Balidani
Constable
Narbeer Singh
1 Bn
5-10-1937 To
14-10-1966



Veer Balidani
Constable
Kanwar Singh
1 Bn
2-8-1946 To
14-10-1966



Veer Balidani
Constable
Suraj Dev Singh
1 Bn
2-3-1944 To
14-10-1966

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to 5 valiant troopers of 1 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries while valiantly countering insurgents in dist. Ukhrul, Manipur, on 14 October 1966. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani
Constable
Amar Nath
1 Bn
2-5-1948 To
14-10-1981

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Amar Nath of 1 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining a bullet injury while valiantly carrying out the mission to take over the Quarter Guard from the revolting 2 APSP Bn, Kurnool, on 14 October 1981. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani
Constable/Driver
A. Chinaiyya
58 Bn
15-3-1961 To
14-10-1992

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable/Driver A. Chinaiyya of 58 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir, on 14 October 1992. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



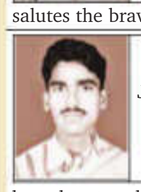
Veer Balidani
Head Constable
Shiv Ram Singh
25 Bn
17-1-1950 To
4-10-1992

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable Shiv Ram Singh of 25 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir, on 14 October 1992. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani
Lance Naik
Ram Prakash
67 Bn
12-2-1960 To
14-10-1997

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Lance Naik Ram Prakash of 67 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries while valiantly countering insurgents in a fierce encounter in dist. Bishnupur, Manipur, on 14 October 1997. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani
Constable
Jitender Kumar
80 Bn
1-3-1981 To
14-10-2004

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Jitender Kumar of 80 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries while countering an ambush by Maoists in dist. Gadchiroli, Maharashtra, on 14 October 2004. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

NORTHERN RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM

Ref : Tender Notice No. - 16/2026-2027 Dated - 27.05.2026 Sr. no. 06
(i) Tender No.- 15235293A due on 10.11.2026

In reference to above tender, the due date has been extended from 13.10.2026 to 10.11.2026. All other terms & conditions remain unchanged.

The corrigendum has been published on website **www.ireps.gov.in.**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3572/26

SBI

IT Quality Assurance Centre of Excellence Dept., State Bank of India,
Global IT-Centre, Sec-11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai-400 614
E-mail: dgmit.qacoe@sbi.co.in; Website: https://sbi.bank.in

CORRIGENDUM NOTICE

RFP NO. SBI/GITC/IT-Quality Assurance CoE/2026-27/1492
DATED: 18.09.2026

Corrigendum with reference to the RFP has been published on **https://etender.sbi/SBI/** portal and in Procurement News at **https://sbi.bank.in**.

Last date and time for submission of bids: 23.10.2026 up to 17:00 hrs.

IT Quality Assurance Centre of Excellence Dept.

UJVN Limited

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Phone : 0135-2763508, 2763808 & Fax : 0135-2763507
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866

RO No. 941 **Time Extension Tender notice** Dated : 13/10/2026

Due to unavoidable reason, the dates of Tender NIT No.18/EE(M&G)/MPH/2026-27 invited by the office of the Executive Engineer, (M&G) Mohammadpur Power House, Gurukul Narsan–Haridwar are hereby extended :-

Date of availability of bid document on website: 14.10.2026
Last date for submission of tender: 19.10.2026, up to 11:00 Hrs.
Date of opening of tender: 19.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.
All other terms and conditions of tender shall remain unchanged. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com".

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (M&G)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

NORTHERN RAILWAY

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Name of Work and its location	121-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27, Balance work of Augmentation of Power Supply system and Provision of Central Air Conditioning system of Boxing Hall at Karnail Singh Stadium, New Delhi.
Approx. cost of the works in	Rs. 8739077.00/-
Address of the office	Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi, 110055
Earnest Money	Rs. 174800.00/-
Last Date & time of submission of tender	04.11.2026, 13.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender	04.11.2026, 13.00 Hrs.
Website & notice board	www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/ General, New Delhi.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3565/26

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001 for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	15265127	Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning DG Set	16 Set	03.11.2026
02	19260628	Set of Labyrinth Ring for Nose Suspend Drive	150 Set	09.11.2026
03	19261697A	Panto Foot Insulator	375 Nos	09.11.2026
04	77269008A RGC	Running Contract for IM Long Fish Plate	31676 Nos	16.11.2026

Note: 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. **www. ireps.gov.in** for details. 2. No manual offer will be entertained. 3573/2026
Tender Notice No. 49/2026-2027 Dated: 13.10.2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE AMBALA DISTRICT COOP. MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED	FABRICATION /CONSTRUCTION OF MILK BOOTHS /MILK PARLORS CUM AMBIT PHARMACY /MILK PARLORS FOR MILK UNION, AMBALA	14.10.2026 27.10.2026	2,00,000/-	vita.haryana.gov.in	9728875323 milkplant@vitaambala.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50155/HRY

कार्यालय अधिशाषी अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, खण्ड औंसिया

क्रमांक: 1277 दिनांक: 01/10/2026

निविदा सूचना संख्या: 10 वर्ष 2026–27
NIB No. PWD2627A3195

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से विभिन्न निर्माण एवं मरम्मत कार्य हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग राजस्थान में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार / केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों / केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग / डाक एवं दूर संचार विभाग / रेल्वे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के उपयुक्त श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हो, से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ईटेण्डरिंग प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑनलाईन निविदायें आमंत्रित की जाती है।

निविदा से सम्बन्धित विवरण वेब साईट **http://dipr.rajasthan.gov.in** व **http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in** व **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर देखा जा सकता है। सम्पूर्ण निविदा प्रक्रिया **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर ऑनलाईन सम्पादित की जायेगी। कार्यवार यू.बी.एन संख्या निम्नानुसार है।

PWD2627WSOB14449	PWD2627WSOB14451	PWD2627WSOB14453
PWD2627WSOB14455	PWD2627WSOB14456	PWD2627WSOB14457

हस्ता/–
अधिशाषी अभियन्ता
सा.नि.वि. खण्ड औंसियां

DIPR/C/17638/2026

HDB FINANCIAL SERVICES LIMITED

DEMAND NOTICE UNDER SECTION 13(2) OF THE SARFAESI ACT,2002

Registered Office: Radhika,2nd Floor, Law Garden Road, Navrangpura, Ahemdabad, Gujrat, Pin Code: 380009 **BRANCH OFFICE:** HDB Financial Services Limited, Khasra No 47, Behind Ox Ford School, Vikaspuri Delhi 110018

You the below mentioned borrower, co-borrowers and guarantors have availed loan(s)/ financial facility(ies) from HDB Financial Services Limited by mortgaging your immovable properties (securities) and defaulted in repayment of the same. Consequent to your defaults your loan was classified as non-performing asset. Subsequently, the Company has issued demand notice under Section 13(2) of The Securitization And Reconstruction of Financial Asset and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the Act), the contents of which are being published herewith as per section 13(2) of the act read with Rule 3(1) of The Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 as and by way of alternate service upon you. Details of the borrowers, co-borrowers, loan account no., loan amount, demand notice under section 13(2) date, amount claimed in the notice, NPA date and securities are given as under:

1) NAME AND ADDRESS OF THE BORROWER/CO-BORROWER/GUARANTOR; 2) LOAN ACCOUNT NUMBER; 3) LOAN AMOUNT; 4) DATE OF DEMAND NOTICE; 5) CLAIMED AMOUNT IN INR; 4) DETAILS OF SECURITIES;7) DATE OF POSSESSION

Name Of The Borrower & Co-Borrowers: Jitendra SO Chandrapal Brahmpuri Dadri Dadri-203207 Uttar Pradesh And Also Khasra No. 655, Situated At Mohalla Brahmpuri, kasba Dadri, Pargana & Tehsil Dadri Distt Gautam Budh Nagar Dadri-203207 Anita SO Rajpal Brahampuri Dadri Dadri-201001 Uttar Pradesh **LOAN ACCOUNT NO.:** 26849797;**LOAN AMOUNT:**Rs.4000000/- (Rupees Forty Lakhs Only) **DEMAND NOTICE DATE:** 16.08.2024, **AMOUNT CLAIMED:**Rs.3,858,914.33/- (Rupees Thirty Eight Lakhs Fifty Eight Thousand Nine Hundred Fourteen and Paise Thirty Three Only) as of 20.07.2026 and future contractual interest till actual realization together with incidental expenses, cost and charges etc..**NPA Date :** 02.08.2024: **DETAILS OF SECURITY:**All the Piece and Parcel of the Property Khasra no. 655, Mohalla Brahampuri, Kasba Dadri, Pragana & Tehsil Dadri, District Gautam Budh Nagar Uttar Pradesh-203207 Property Bounded as: North-Other Property, South-Others Property, West-Road 18 Feet Wide, East-Plot Sunil Rawal Date of Possession: 09.10.2026

Name Of The Borrower & Co-Borrowers: Bareilly Gorakhpur Road Line Kh. No 652, 653, 654, 655, 656, 658, 36harbans Nagar Meerut Road Ghaziabad Ghaziabad-201001 Uttar Pradesh And Also Plot No 24 , Kh No 264 Situated In The Residential Colony Knownas Kalyan Vihar Hadbast Village Dhargal, Pargana Jalalab Ghaziabad-201001 Babli Bhadana H.no 24 Kh.no 264 Garhi Kalyan Vihar Ghaziabad Ghaziabad-201001 Uttar Pradesh Santosh Bhadana H.no 24 Kh.no 264 Garhi Kalyan Vihar Ghaziabad Ghaziabad-201001 Uttar Pradesh **LOAN ACCOUNT NO.:** 54625262; **LOAN AMOUNT:** Rs.4200000/- (Rupees Forty Two Lakhs Only) by the loan account number 54625262 **DEMAND NOTICE DATE:** 20.07.2026. **AMOUNT CLAIMED:**Rs.3493843/- (Rupees Thirty Four Lakhs Ninety Three Thousand Eight Hundred Forty Three Only) as of 14.07.2026 and future contractual interest till actual realization together with incidental expenses, cost and charges etc..**NPA Date :** 08.06.2026: **DETAILS OF SECURITY:**All that piece and parcel of Plot No.24 measuring 100 sq. yds. i.e. 83.61 Sq meter, out of Khasra No.264, situated in the residential colony known as Kalyan Vihar, Hadbast Village Dhargal, Pargana Jalalabad, Tehsil and Distt. Ghaziabad. Bounded as under: North: Plot No.25, South: Road 15 ft. wide, East: Plot No.15, West: Road 15 ft. wide. Date of Possession: 09.10.2026

Name Of The Borrower & Co-Borrowers: Avon Interior Worksh No-345 Kh No-1661/1 Ikram Nagar Loni Loni Dehat Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh Ghaziabad-201102 Uttar Pradesh And Also Khasra No - 1661/1 Ikram Nagar Hadbast Village - Loni Tehsil and District - Ghaziabad Ghaziabad-201102 Shama Do Shahbuddinkh No-1661 Ikram Nagar Gzb Loni Gzb Ghaziabad-201102 Uttar Pradesh Fakruddin So Abdulhasan Kh No-1661 Ikram Nagar Gzb Loni Gzb Ghaziabad-201102 Uttar Pradesh **LOAN ACCOUNT NO.:** 61042694: **LOAN AMOUNT:** Rs.2341000/- (Rupees Twenty Three Lakhs Forty One Thousand Only) by loan account number 61042694, **DEMAND NOTICE DATE:** 20.07.2026 **AMOUNT CLAIMED:** Rs.2060191.67/- (Rupees Twenty Lakhs Eighty Thousand One Hundred Ninety One and Paise Sixty Seven Only) as of 14.07.2026 and future contractual interest till actual realization together with incidental expenses, cost and charges etc..**NPA Date :** 03.07.2026: **DETAILS OF SECURITY:** All that piece and parcel of Plot admeasuring 50 Sq. yards, out of Khasra no. 1661/1,, Ikram Nagar, Village Loni, Tehsil & Distt. Ghaziabad, U.P. Property Bounded as: East: Plot Salauddin West: Road 12 Ft, North: Road 15 Ft, South: Plot Digar Date of Possession: 08.10.2026

You the borrower/ co-borrowers and guarantors are therefore called upon to make payment of the above mentioned demanded amount with further interest as mentioned herein above in full within 60 days of this notice failing which the undersigned shall be constrained to take action under the act to enforce the above-mentioned securities. **(Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.)** Please note that as per section 13(13) of the said Act, you are restrained from transferring the above-referred securities by way of sale, lease or otherwise without our consent and any non compliance of section 13(13) of the Act is punishable under section 29 of the said Act.

For Any Query Please Contact Mr. Arun Yadav Phone: 9350538386 / Mr. Vikas Anand (9711010384)

DATE: - 14-10-2026, Place : DELHI **Authorised Officer For HDB Financial Services Limited.**

RailTel (A Govt. of India Undertaking)
CIN No. L64202DL2000G01107905

e-Tender No. RailTel/Tender/OT/WR/RO/2026-27/VSS/002 Date: 12.10.2026

RailTel /Western Region invites open E-Tender for "Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning, Integration with Existing VSS Infra, Operation and Maintenance of IP based Video Surveillance System (VSS) at Railway Stations of SECR under Western Region of RailTel for and on behalf of Indian Railways"

Tender Notice and Tender Document are available on https://www.railtel.in/ and can be downloaded from the e-tendering portal https://www.ireps.gov.in/ . All future Addendum/Corrigendum will be uploaded on RailTel website and e-tendering portal only.

Western Railway Microwave Complex, Senapati Bapat Marg, Mahalaxmi, Mumbai-400013 Phone: 91 (22) 24923907 Fax: 91 (22) 24923913

ADDITIONAL ELECTRICAL WORKS AT RANGIYA DIVISION

E-Tender Notice No. RNY-EL-T-13-2026-27 Date: 09-10-2026. Works tenders through "E" Tendering system for and on behalf of the President of India are invited for the works as detailed below:- **Name of Work:** At New Bongaigaon-Additional Electrical work for completion of New Bongaigaon 1st entry building & entry porch as per ABSS plan. **Tender Value:** ₹1,69,96,975.95/- **Earnest Money:** ₹3,39,900/-. **Date & time for Closing of tender:** At **15.00** hrs. on **04-11-2026.** The complete information with tender documents of above e-tender will be available in the website **www.ireps.gov.in**

Sr. DEE/Rangiya
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

KERALA STATE POLLUTION CONTROL BOARD

Head Office, Pattom P.O., Thiruvananthapuram - 695 004
Web: www.kspcb.kerala.gov.in
email: kspcbendosulfan@gmail.com

Ref No: KSPCB/1939/2023-SEE-2 Date: 13/10/2026

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

Kerala State Pollution Control Board (KSPCB) invites Expression of Interest (EoI) from authorized and eligible operators/agencies having operational integrated HazardousWastes Treatment, Storage, and Disposal Facilities (HWTSDF)/Hazardous waste incineration facility with high-temperature hazardous waste incineration capabilities for the safe packaging, loading, inter-state transportation, treatment, and scientific disposal of legacy Endosulfan waste stocks stored at the various cashew estates of Plantation Corporation of Kerala Limited in the state of Keralam.

For further details please refer to web link: https://kspcb.kerala.gov.in/tenders

Contact Officer & Queries:
Chief Environmental Engineer,
Kerala State Pollution Control Board
E-mail: kspcbendosulfan@gmail.com
Mob. No.: 9447975729

Last Date for Submission of EOI: 27-10-2026

(Sd/-) Member Secretary
Kerala State Pollution Control Board,
Thiruvananthapuram.

HARYANA REAL ESTATE REGULATORY AUTHORITY

New Mini Secretariat, 2nd Floor, Sector-1, Panchkula.
E-mail: hrerapkl-hry@gov.in,
officer.rera.hry@gmail.com
Website: www.haryanarera.gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby brought to the notice of the general public, homebuyers, investors, and all concerned persons that SRS Real Estate Ltd., presently developing real estate project in District Rewari, Haryana, has not registered its project, with the Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority (HRERA) as mandated under the provisions of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016.

In terms of Section 3 of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016, no promoter shall advertise, market, book, sell, or offer for sale any plot, apartment, or building in a real estate project without obtaining registration from the Real Estate Regulatory Authority.

Therefore, the general public is hereby cautioned:

- Not to book, purchase, invest in, or make any payment for any plot or unit in the project measuring 5.981 acres and 6.643acres being developed by SRS Real Estate Ltd. in Rewari.
- Any transaction made in violation of the above provisions shall be at the sole risk, cost, and consequences of the purchaser and the Authority shall not be responsible for any loss or dispute arising therefrom.

This public notice is issued in the interest of the general public to prevent fraudulent or illegal real estate transactions and to ensure compliance with the provisions of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016.

For verification of registered projects, the public is advised to visit the official website of Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority (HRERA) Panchkula

Secretary (Acting),
HRERA Panchkula

No. 50151/HRY

ANDHRA PRADESH INLAND WATERWAYS AUTHORITY (Government of AP)

Anish Legacy, H.No.12-455/B bypass Road Ward No.12, Tadepalli, Guntur Dist.-522501.
Email: ceo-apiwa@ap.gov.in, info.inlandwaterways@gmail.com

Request for Proposal (RFP) e-procurement
RFP Notice No.47/APIWA/Port Connectivity/MTM/2026-27, Dated: 13.10.2026

Sl.No.	Name of the work
1	APIWA is Inviting the Request for Proposal for "Development of Inland Waterways & establishing Port Connectivity to Machilipatnam Port under DBFOT Mode through Public Private Partnership (PPP) Model". The details can be seen at https://apeprocurement.gov.in from Dt: 15.10.2026, @11.30 AM onwards. The last for Bid submission: 02.11.2026 @ 14.00 Hrs. Mob. No: 8143901582, 9952974150.

Sd/- Chief Executive Officer, AP Inland Waterways Authority
DIPR No.5503PP/CL/ADVT/1/1/2021-22, Dt.13/10/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE No. ELS-SRE-25-26-T-16RT dtd. 12/10/2026

Onen tender through E-tendering are invited by Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRS, Electric Loco Shed, Khanalampura Yard, Northern Railway, Saharanpur (Ambala Division) for and on behalf of the President of India from the registered tenderer on website **www.ireps.gov.in** for the following work upto 11:00 hrs on the date of closing shown against the work and will be opened thereafter:

Open Tender No.	ELS-SRE-25-26-T-16RT
Name of work	Repair /reconditioning of 1750 LPM compressors of electric locomotives.
Date of Closing/Opening	04.11.2026
Approx. Cost.	Rs. 2,83,17,919.20
Earnest Money	Rs. 5,66,400/-
Completion period	Twenty (24) Months
Validity period	60 days
Cost of tender form	'Free of cost' for downloading from IREPS & ₹ 10000/- for obtaining from Sr.DEE/TRS/SRE office.

1. Tenderer(s) should have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate to participate in E-Tendering of Works Tenders. **2.** Tenderer are required to upload self-attested scanned copies of all related eligibility documents as per conditions. **3.** Taxes & Charges will be applicable as per extant rule. **4.** For details, please log on IREPS website www.ireps.gov.in 3554/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Government of Jharkhand
Department of Higher and Technical Education
(Jharkhand Council on Science, Technology and Innovation)
Yojna Bhawan, Nepal House Campus, Doranda,
Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002
Email- jharkhandcouncilonsct@gmail.com

Ref. No: Vi.Pra./Kau.-04/2015- **285** / Ranchi, Date:**12/10/2026**

NOTICE

Subject: Cancellation of Advertisement for Engagement of Chief Mentor and Junior Mentor issued vide Ref. No. Vi.Pra./Kau.-04/2015-221 dated 10.08.2026

It is hereby notified for information of all concerned that the advertisement issued vide Ref. No. Vi.Pra./Kau.-04/2015-221 dated 10.08.2026 for engagement of Chief Mentor and Junior Mentor on contractual basis at Innovation Hub, Regional Science Centre, Ranchi stands cancelled with immediate effect due to unavoidable administrative circumstances.

Accordingly, the engagement process initiated under the aforesaid advertisement is hereby withdrawn. No further action shall be taken in pursuance of the said advertisement.

JCSTI reserves the right to issue a fresh advertisement for these positions, if required, at a later date. Any inconvenience caused in this regard is regretted.

This has been issued with the approval of the competent authority.

PR No. 387147

Sd/-
(Dr. Raj Shekhar Prasad)
Executive Director, JCSTI

PR.NO.391693 Higher Education,Technical Education and Skill Development Department(26-27):D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2)(ii) Cr.Pc.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Israr Ahmed s/o Rafiq Ahmed** R/o. D-417 (Basment) Plot No.12-A, Khasra No.16/20, Block-D Sarvodya Kanya Vidhalyla Baljeet Vihar, Delhi also at: Vill. Shahjahan Mohlla Basariya, PS-Sadar, Distt-Shahajahanpur UP. has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence under **FIR No.20495/2016 u/s 138 NI Act.** has been registered at **P.S. Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Israr Ahmed** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Israr Ahmed** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Israr Ahmed** under **FIR No.20495/2016 u/s 138 NI Act.** registered at **PS. Aman Vihar Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Aakanksha,
JMFC, North West,
Room No.107, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/14344/RD/2026
(court notice)

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
P.W.D. (B&R) AMBIKPUR CIRCLE AMBIKAPUR

Invitation Date: 09.10.2026

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

01. For tender detail please visit http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in
02. Concern Division - S.No. 1,2 Jashpur, S.No. 3 Manendragarh and S.No. 4,5 Pathalgaon Division
03. S.No. 1-'C' Class And Above Contractor & S.No. 2 to 5-'D' Class And Above Contractor
04. Bid Submission Due Date - 22.10.2026

S. No.	N.I.T. No.	Name of work	P.A.C. in lacks
1	2	3	4
1	176	BT Patch Repair Work of Various Road under PWD Sub Division Bagicha. (Second Call)	128.51
2	177	BT Patch Repair work on Various Roads under PWD Sub Division Kunkuri (Second Call)	12.71
3	178	BT Patch Repair work on Various Roads under PWD Sub Division Janakpur Distt Koria (Second Call)	67.84
4	179	BT Patch Repair work of Various Road under PWD Sub Division No. 2 Pathalgaon (Second Call)	33.60
5	180	BT Patch Repair work of Various Road under PWD Sub Division No.1 Pathalgaon. (Second Call)	84.74

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
P.W.D. Ambikapur Circle Ambikapur

RO NO. 262703922/4

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB YAMUNANAGAR	ESTABLISHMENT OF CENTRE OF EXCELLENCE (COE) FOR BERRIES AT RAJKIYA BAGH AND NURSERY, CHHACHHRAULI, DISTRICT YAMUNA NAGAR + 4 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 30.10.2026	16,06,99,735/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9270010001 xenynr.hsamb2023@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 50138/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB KURUKSHETRA	CONSTRUCTION OF NEW LINK ROAD FROM PEHOWA KURUKSHETRA ROAD TO CAMBRIDGE WORLD SCHOOL KURUKSHETRA IN MC PEHOWA (ROAD ID : 12936) + 1 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 23.10.2026	1,80,68,939/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01744231420 xenkkr2022@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 50137/HRY

झारखण्ड बिजली वितरण निगम लिमिटेड
JHARKHAND BIJLI VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED
(CIN: U40108JH2013SGC001702)
Regd. Office:- Engineering Building, HEC, Dhurwa, Ranchi–834004. Telephone:- 0651-2400760 & Fax: 0651-2446055

TENDER CANCELLATION NOTICE

Cancellation Notice for inviting Request for Proposal (RFP) / Expression of Interest (EoI) having NIT NO. 137/PR/JBVNL /2026 -27 dated 05.06.2026 for Appointment of Company Secretary in practice or a Firm of Company Secretaries to conduct the Secretarial audit of JBVNL at Headquarter as well as all field offices for the FY 2024-25, 2025-26 & 2026-27 (Extendable upto 2028-29).

Due to inevitable reasons, Notice inviting Request for Proposal (RFP) / Expression of Interest (EoI) having NIT No. 137/PR/JBVNL/2026-27 dated 05.06.2026 for Appointment of Company Secretary in practice or a Firm of Company Secretaries to conduct the Secretarial audit of JBVNL at Headquarter as well as all field offices for the FY 2024-25, 2025-26 & 2026-27 (Extendable upto 2028-29) has been cancelled.

Company Secretary
Jharkhand Bijli Vitran Nigam Limited
Regd. Office: - Engineering Building,
HEC, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
Mobile No. 9934118745 Email: csjbvnl@gmail.com

स्वहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचावें। कृपया अपनी शिकयतों को 18003456570(कॉल सेन्टर) पर दर्ज करावें।

Sd/-
Company Secretary
JBVNL

PR No. 381538
PR 391729 (Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd)26-27*D

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB YAMUNANAGAR	ESTABLISHMENT OF CENTRE OF EXCELLENCE (COE) FOR BERRIES AT RAJKIYA BAGH AND NURSERY, CHHACHHRAULI, DISTRICT YAMUNA NAGAR + 4 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 30.10.2026	16,06,99,735/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9270010001 xenynr.hsamb2023@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 50138/HRY

NPCL
NOIDA POWER COMPANY LIMITED

Noida Power Company Limited
Electric Sub Station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida-201310
(CIN: U

UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LTD.

(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking)
Office of the Superintending Engineer,
Electricity Distribution Circle (R), 18 E.C. Road, Dehradun

"ई-निविदा तिथि विस्तार सूचना"

अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता द्वारा ई–निविदा संख्या **79/EDCRDDUN/2026-27** आमंत्रित की गयी थी जिसको खोलने की तिथि **12.10.2026** है, जिसमें किसी भी निविदादाता द्वारा प्रतिभाग न किये जाने के कारण विस्तारित की जाती है। निविदा अब दिनांक **23.10.2026** को 12:00 बजे तक ऑफलाइन/ऑनलाइन प्रस्तुत की जा सकती है जो उसी दिन 15:00 बजे खोली जाएगी। निविदा की शेष नियम व शर्तें पूर्ववत रहेंगी। उपरोक्त निविदाओं की अधिक जानकारी हेतु वेबसाईट **www.uktenders.gov.in** पर देखें।

पत्रांक: 3614/वि०वि०मं०या०दे०/उपाकालि
दिनांक : 12.10.2026 (अधीक्षण अभियन्ता)

"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF THE NATION."
(Customer Care Toll Free No. 1800 419 0405)

Office of The Superintending Engineer PWD Circle Barmer

No. SE/PWD/BMR/2026/D-1258 **Date: 30.09.2026**

Notice Inviting Bid No. 08/2026-27
NIB - PWD2627A3199

Bids for Civil Works (Road and Building) are invited from intersted bidders upto date **22.10.2026, 06.00 PM** other particulars of the bid may be visisted on the procurement portal (**http://www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** and **http:www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in**) of the state, The approximate value procurement is **Rs. 940.70 Lac (04 Works)**

PWD2627WSRC14471	PWD2627WSRC14474
PWD2627WSRC14476	PWD2627WSRC14477

Sd/- **(Sura Ram)**
Superintending Engineer
PWD Circle Barmer

DIPR/C/17549/2026

उदयपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, राजस्थान

No. :- F-2(01)Acct/Contract/2026-27/190 - 192 **Date :- 07/10/2026**

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या : 51/2026-27

उदयपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, उदयपुर द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्यो मय डिफेक्ट लाईबिलिटी अवधि के लिये जो कि निविदा प्रपत्र में अंकित है के लिये उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदको से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई–टेण्डरिंग के माध्यम से ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है :–

निविदा कार्यो की कुल लागत	रूपये 139.69 लाख (01 कार्य)
ऑनलाईन निविदा प्रपत्र डाउनलोड/अपलोड करने की अवधि	09.10.2026 को प्रातः 10.00 बजे से 20.10.2026 को सायः 6.00 बजे तक
Online EMD, Tender Fee & Processing Fee जमा कराने की तिथी	09.10.2026 को प्रातः 10.00 बजे से 20.10.2026 को सायः 6.00 बजे तक
ऑनलाईन निविदा खोलने की तिथी	21.10.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे

विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाईट **urban.rajasthan.gov.in/uitudaipur**, **www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** व **www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in** पर देखा जा सकता है।

UBN No. : ITU2627SLOB00333

अधिशाषी अभियन्ता - विद्युत
उदयपुर विकास प्राधिकरण

लाज.संवाद/सी/26/11733

PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LTD.

(Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala)
Corporate Identification Number (CIN): U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact Number 9646123323)

Tender Inquiry No. PPR - 15/2026 **Date:- 13.10.2026**

Chief Engineer/PP&R Organization, Shed No.D-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites E-tender under three part bid system for supply of electrical energy (RE-Non Solar) from interstate/intrastate sources viz. Generators, Traders having Valid Inter State Trading License issued by CERC for interstate trading of energy, intrastate trading license issued by PSERC for intrastate trading of energy, State Electricity Boards, State Electricity Utilities, States, IPPs & CPPs from 1st November 2026 to 31st March 2027. The link for the e-Bidding portal is **www.mstcecommerce.com** and is also available on the website of Ministry of Power (**www.Powermin.nic.in**) and PFC Consultancy Limited (**www.pfcindia.com**). For detailed NIT & tender specifications please refer to **www.mstcecommerce.com** from 13.10.2026 onwards.

Note:- Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **www.mstcecommerce.com**

No. 16128/PB **C 978/26**

AXIS FINANCE LIMITED

(CIN U65921MH1995PLC212675)
Axis House, C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai – 400 025

APPENDIX IV
[See Rule 8(I)]
SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE
(For immovable property)
[As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002]

Whereas,
The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the **Axis Finance Limited (AFL)**, under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of Powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with the Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued a demand notice dated **27th July , 2026** calling upon the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgagor(s) **(1) Sangam Education Society(Borrower) Nahni Chander (Co-Borrower 1/ Mortgagor) Rajesh Kumar (Co-Borrower 2) Sunita Singh (Co-Borrower 3/ Mortgagor) Ramesh Kumar (Co-Borrower 4) Anil Kumar (Co-Borrower 5) Hardeep Kumar (Co-Borrower 6) Pawan Kumar (Co-Borrower 7) Suresh Kumar** who have mortgaged the immovable property more particularly described hereunder to repay the amount mentioned in the notice **INR 4,97,69,729/- (Rupees Four Crores Ninety Seven Lakhs Sixty Nine Thousand Seven Hundred Twenty Nine Only)** due as on 23.07.2026 with further interest at the contractual rate thereon till the date of payment within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgagor(s) having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgagor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on this **12th** day of October of the year **2026**.

The Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgagor(s) in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the Axis Finance Limited for an amount of **INR 4,97,69,729/- (Rupees Four Crores Ninety Seven Lakhs Sixty Nine Thousand Seven Hundred Twenty Nine Only)** due as on 23.07.2026 and further interest thereon at the contractual rates together with costs, charges, etc. of Axis Finance Ltd until the full payment or realization in full.

The Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgagor(s) attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) & sub section (13) of section 13 of the said Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

DETAILS OF SECURED ASSETS

All that Piece and parcel of Property building total area admeasuring 51 kanal 12 marla (approximately) comprised in the Araji Khewat No. 375 Min, Khatoni No 501 Min, Khasra No. 352/6 (8-0) and Araji Khewat 1753 Khatoni 2279, Khasra 352/14/2 (4-12), Araji Khewat No. 1261 Khasra 352/23 (7-0) 24 (8-0) Khewat No. 353 Khasra No. 352 /15 (8-0), 16 (8-0), 17 (8-0), Khewat No. 1639 Khasra No.352/14/2(4-12), Tehsil Tosham, Mouja Tosham, District- Bhiwani, Haryana-127040 and construction thereon, bounded as under:
East- Agriland
West- Road
North- Agriland
South- Agriland

Date:12.10.2026 **Authorized Officer**
Place: Bhiwani **Axis Finance Ltd.**

GOVERNMENT OF MADHYA PRADESH
NARMADA VELLY DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER
UPPER NARAMADA ZONE, BARGI HILLS, JABALPUR(M. P.)

Tel. No. 0761-2673450 | E-mail: ceunz.2010@rediffmail.com | FAX No. 0761-2672373

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (1st Call)

N.I .T. 318/G/CE/2026, **Jabalpur, Dated: 09/10/2026**

Online tenders for the following works have been processed on the e-Procurement system Portal website http://mptenders.gov.in Tender details as below:-

Tender ID No. 2026-NVDA 541818-1

Name of the work : Repair, Maintenance and system correction of Right Bank Main Canal from RD 83.00 Km to RD 102.00 Km and RD RD 129.00 Km to 154.00 Km including distribution system on TURNKEY Basis comprising the work of jungle clearance from bed as well as inner and outer slopes of canal, silt clearance from canal bed, drainage syphon, drainage culverts, super passages etc. Rehabilitation of embankment'and slopes to original state, dismantling and canal lining and other structures. Cleaning and sealing of lining groves, stone pitching works on deteriorated slopes, launching aprons of cross drainage structures, approach slab construction at VRB, super passage bridge slab and parapet repairs, complete as per design, drawings and specifications of MPWRD and MPRRDA including all materials, Labour, machinery and incidentals, as per detailed scope of work but not limited to that. The work also includes 12 months defect liability period after completion of the Project.
Probable Amount of Contract (Rs. in Lakhs) : Rs. 3095.94 Lakh (excluding G.S.T.)
EMD (In Rs.) : Rs.1548000.00
Cost of Tender Document : Rs. 50000.00 (non-refundable)
Date of Purchase of tender document : 09-10-2026, 17:31 Hrs. to 28-10-2026, 17.30 Hrs.
Date of Opening of EMD : 30-10-2026, 10:30 AM Onwards
Completion Period : 18 Months (including rainy season)

- The tender document can be purchased only online from the above website after making online payment using credit card or Internet Banking Account.
- Detailed N.I.T. and other details can be viewed on the abovementioned portal.

Sd/-
(D. L. Verma)
Chief Engineer
Upper Narmada Zone,
Bargi Hills, Jabalpur (M.P.)

G-19987/26

Jawaharlal Nehru Aluminium Research Development and Design Centre

(An Autonomous Body under Ministry of Mines, Govt. of India)
Amravati Road, Wadi, Nagpur - 440 023.
www.jnarddc.gov.in (07104-220701) e-mail: purchasejnarddcnagpur@gmail.com

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना/NOTICE INVITING TENDER - October 2026

Director, JNARDDC, Nagpur, invites online bids from reputed firms for the following services/items.
निदेशक, निम्नलिखित निविदा की आपूर्ति के लिए प्रतिष्ठित कंपनियों से ऑनलाइन प्रस्ताव आमंत्रित किया है।

Tender/ GeM Bid No.	Description of Equipments/ Work	Refundable EMD (₹)	Last Date of Tender Submission	Date of Tender Opening
GEM/2026/B/8121778	Controlled Atmosphere Melting Furnace	23,600/-	27.10.2026 (18:00 Hrs.)	28.10.2026 (18:00 Hrs.)
GEM/2026/B/8139787	Gallium Metal 99.99% chemical	25,000/-	02.11.2026 (21:00 Hrs.)	03.11.2026 (21:00 Hrs.)

The details are available in the tender document which will be available for download from our office website **https://www.jnarddc.gov.in** or **https://gem.gov.in/**

वरिष्ठ प्रशासनिक अधिकारी

JHARKHAND STATE RURAL ROAD DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (JSRRDA)

3rd Floor, F.F.P. Building, Dhurwa, Ranchi - 834004
PRADHAN MANTRI GRAM SADAK YOJANA(PMGSY)

Expression of Interest (Short Notice)

Letter no. JSRRDA -739/2023-1451 Dated: 12.10.2026
NIT No. eTender NO-29

The Chief Engineer, JHARKHAND STATE RURAL ROAD DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY on behalf of Rural Works Department invites the bids in electronic tendering system regarding consultancy services for "Forest Diversion/ Clearance proposal including clearance of all stages as required (General Forest/ Wild Life by DFO, CF, CCF, PCCF level & up to wild life board in JSRRDA for Rural Road Construction under PM-JANMAN/ PMGSY/RCPLWEA)" from the reputed firms/consultants/companies having experience in similar nature of work.

The Date of release of invitation for Bids through e-procurement 25.09.2026

Availability of Bid Documents and mode of submission:The bid document is available online and should be submitted online in www.pmgsytendersjhr.gov.in. The bidder would be required to register in the web-site which is free of cost. For submission of the bids, the bidder is required to have a valid Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) from one of the authorized Certifying Authorities.

Last Date &Time for receipt of bids through e-procurement: 09/10/2026 upto 15:00Hours (time). For further details please log on to www.pmgsytendersjhr.gov.in.

Sd/-
The Chief Engineer,
JHARKHAND STATE RURAL ROAD DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
(JSRRDA)
3rd Floor, F.F.P. Building, Dhurwa, Ranchi - 834004

PR 391687 (Rural Work Department) 26-27 (D)

OFFICE OF PROJECT DIRECTOR PROJECT MANAGEMENT UNIT, BIIU, ASIAN DEVELOPMENT BANK

PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT, DEHRADUN, UTTARAKHAND
Office of Engineer-in-chief PWD Uttarakhand, Room 16, Yamuna Colony, Dehradun, Pin Code-248001
EMAIL- pdpmuadb.pwduk@gov.in

Letter No-731/26/PMU/BIIU/ADB/2026 **Dated: 12/10/2026**

PUBLIC NOTICE

The general public is hereby informed that the Draft Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) and Environmental Assessment Review Framework (EARF) Report for the project "Bridge Improvement in Uttarakhand" (BIIU), funded by the Asian Development Bank (ADB), has been prepared and is available for public review on the official website of the Public Works Department (PWD), Government of Uttarakhand, at https://pwd.uk.gov.in. The report can be accessed under the 'Bridge Improvement in Uttarakhand (ADB)' tab on the website.

Suggestions, comments, or objections from interested individuals, local residents, and other stakeholders are invited regarding the said EIA and EARD Report on or before 15th November 2026 through email to the official email ID of this office or by registered post to this office.

Sd/-
Project Director PMU, BIIU, ADB,
PWD Uttarakhand, Dehradun

Government of Odisha
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER KATAKA (R&B) CIRCLE, KATAKA

34001/1003/2627
E-mail.ID-sectcrb 2006@yahoo.co.in
Tel/Fax 0671-2301751/2302751
('e' - PROCUREMENT NOTICE)
Bid Identification No.CCE.Cte. (R&B) 13/2026-27.

1. The Chief Construction Engineer. Kataka (R&B)Circle. Kataka on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites on Percentage rate basis bid in double cover system in ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for Building works as mentioned below.
2. **No. of work:-** 02 Nos.
3. **Nature of work:-** Building works
4. **Class of contractor:-** 'A' & Special Class
5. **Tender paper cost:-** Rs.10000/-(online)
6. **Available of bid document in the web site:-** From 26.10.2026 to 17.30 Hours of 10.11.2026
7. **Date of opening of bid:-** Dt.11.11.2026 at 11.00 Hours.
8. The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website **https://tendersodisha.gov.in**. Any addendum/corrigendum/cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer,
Kataka(R&B)Circle

OIPR- 34001/34012/1/26-27/003

SAHARANPUR SMART CITY LIMITED

CIN: U75144UP2018SGC101551
Reg. Office: Gurudwara Road, Nagar Nigam Campus, Saharanpur-247001 (UP)
Email: smartcitysaharanpur@gmail.com, **Website:** www.saharanpursmartcity.com

NIT No. 05/2026-27/03/SSCL **Date: 13st October 2026**

Notice Inviting Tender

Saharanpur Smart City Limited, Saharanpur invites online Bids on two stage system for the following works:

Name of Project/ Work(s)	Estimated Cost (excluding GST) (Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)	Tender Fee including GST (Rs.)	Period of Completion
Shifting of 11kv line, LT line and transformer during work of construction of road and retaining wall for approach road of newly constructed bridge in U/S of Dehradun Ambala road xing in district Saharanpur **Tender ID: 2026 SSCL 1196051 1**	17,94,835/ (Rupees Seventeen Lakh Ninety Four Thousand Eight Hundred Thirty Five Only)	36,000/ (Rupees Thirty Six Thousand Only)	5900/- (Five Thousand Nine Hundred Only)	Three (03) Months

1. Detailed NIT & Bid Documents shall be downloaded from https://etender.up.nic.in
2. Availability of Tender on-line for bidding: From 14.10.2026 at 1000 Hrs.
3. Last Date & Time for online submission of Bids: 28.10.2026 at 1700 hrs.
4. Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid: 29.10.2026 at 1100 hrs.
5. Date & Time of Opening of Financial Bid: To be intimated later
6. Pre-bid Meeting: 21.10.2026 at 1600 hrs. at SSCL office
7. SSCL reserves right to reject any or all Tenders and/or cancel/ annul/ keep in abeyance the Auction Process.
8. Any subsequent addendum/corrigendum shall be published at eauction portal https://etender.up.nic.in only.

Sd/-
(Company Secretary)
Saharanpur Smart City Limited

Office of the Superintending Engineer Central Equipment & Stores Procurement Circle-II, Irrigation Department, Uttar Pradesh, Ganga Sinchai Bhawan, Telibagh, LUCKNOW-226025

GeM CUSTOM BID NOTICE

GeM Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8052869, Date 08.10.2026

On behalf of the Honourable Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Online GeM Bid No GEM/2026/B/8052869, Date 08.10.2026 are invited by the undersigned from Original Manufacturers or from their dealers/distributors/ reseller/channel partner authorized by the firm to participate in this bid, for the supply of Smart Controllers (Fully Automatic Air Break Star Delta Starter Panel) of ratings from 12.5 HP to 50.0 HP to be used on state tubewells for Submersible/VT Pumpsets for water handling and catering irrigation to farmers, conforming to IS/IEC 60947-4-1:2000 & latest amendments if any. Last date of participation in the bid is dated 31.10.2026 at 14.00 PM. Details for eligibility, qualification, technical and other conditions of bid etc. are available in the GeM Bid Document uploaded on the GeM Portal. The undersigned reserves the right to cancel any or all the GeM bids/annul the bidding process without assigning any reason.

Santosh Kumar Sonkar
Superintending Engineer
Central Equipment &
Stores Procurement Circle-II,
Irrigation Department, U.P., Lucknow

UPID-257978 Dt. 12.10.2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

Office of the Superintending Engineer, Moradabad Circle, P.W.D. Moradabad

E-Procurement Notice Inviting Tenders

No. 6008 /E-Tender/MBD Circle/26-27 **Dated:- 30.08.2026**

1. On behalf of the Governor of UP, tenders for following work are invited by the Superintending Engineer, Moradabad Circle, PWD Moradabad online on website **http://etender.up.nic.in** from registered contractors from **16-10-2026 at 10.00 am to 27-10-2026 at 12.00 pm.** Technical bid /Prequalification of tenders shall be opened on **27-10-2026at 12.30 pm.** in office of undersigned by tender committee in presence of authorised representatives/bidders who wish to be present. Financial bid of the tenders' who qualify in technical bid shall be opened on date and time as specified by a notice in the office of undersigned. In case of Government holiday the required process shall be carried out on next working day. Amount mentioned in column 5 & 7 shall be mandatory deposited by net banking only on E-Tender Portal.
2.

Sl. No	DISTRICT	Name of Work	Estimated cost including mantinance (Rs.in Lacs)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lacs)	Time of completion of the work (Including rainy season)	Cost of tender documents including GST
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Sambhal	Year 2025-26 New Construction / Widening and strengthening of 24 Kosiya Vansh Gopal Tirth Parikrama road in Distt Sambhal.	15700.00	157.00	18 Month	2354.00

3. In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software. URL for Prahari is **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/** On opening of the website Prahari login page will open in which user type Contractor is to be selected. User name and password for login on Prahari shall be same as used for contractor's registration on Chnakaya Portal. Bidders have to upload all the basic information and required document on Prahari as given in Prahari in detail. If a bidder does not upload information and document on Prahari technical evaluation of the tender shall not be done and the bidder will be responsible for that.

Rules/conditions & details of the tender are available at website **http://etender.up.nic.in.** and **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari** .

(Er. Sunil Prakash)
Executive Engineer
Provincial Division PWD
Sambhal

UPID-258046 Dt. 12.10.2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(S.P. Singh)
Superintending Engineer
Moradabad Circle, P.W.D Moradabad.
For and on behalf of Governor of UP
Mob No. 9557104999
Mail ID:- semoradabad13@yahoo.com

Office of the Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr

No- 10225 /96M(iv)-BSR Circle/2026-27 **Dated. 07.10.2026**

Short E-Procurement Inviting Tenders

On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, U.P.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites following percentage rate bid online through http://etender.up.nic.infrom the eligible and approved Contractors registered with P.W.D. class as per column no. 10 below Setu work Category as applied from Date 15.10.2026 to 22.10.2026 upto 12:00 Noon as per the prescribed T-2 of Govt. of U.P. The technical bids will be opened online on dated 22.10.2026 at 12:30P.M. If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day, at the same time any validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

Sl. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lakh)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lakh)	Time of Completion work including rainy season	Tender document fee including GST (In Rs.)	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	जनपद में गौतमबुद्धनगर उटरावली से दूबली सम्पर्क मार्ग के किमी0-2 में स्थित बरसाती नाले पर लघु सेतु का निर्माण कार्य।	76.00	5.80	06 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000+18 % G.S.T.Rs. 414.0 =2714.00	Executive Enginner Provincial Division, P.W.D., Gautambudhnagar	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahar Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahar	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A,B Setu Work
2	जनपद गौतमबुद्धनगर के अन्तर्गत खुर्जा-जेवर मार्ग के किमी0-21 में सेतु का पुनः निर्माण का कार्य।	381.00	21.05	12 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000+18 % G.S.T.Rs. 414.0 = 2714.0	Executive Enginner Provincial Division, P.W.D., Gautambudhnagar	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahar Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahar	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A,B Setu Work

1. Time allowed for completion of Whole work is mention in col. No. 5 with including rainy season.
2. The Tender Document fee must be deposited through Internet Banking only.
3. All registered contractors have to upload Turnover certified by C.A. of last 5 years and details of maximum cost of work satisfactorily completed in last 5 years on Chanakya Software before submission of tender.
   Details of e-tender uploaded on **http://etender.up.nic.in** shall also be uploaded on UP PWD Chanakya software, before last date & time of submission of bid.
4. Terms & other conditions related to bid are available on **http://etender.up.nic.in**
5. During execution of work contractor should ensure the all safety Measures for COVID-19issued by the Uttar Pradesh government.
6. In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL for Prahari is **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/**.
7. For the SI No 2 work, it is mandatory to have experience certificate of pile foundation/well Foundation.

(Kanchan Singh)
Executive Engineer
P.D., PWD,
Gautambudhnagar

UPID-258047 Dt. 12/10/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(Maneesh Verma)
Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahar circle, PWD
Bulandshahar

Office of the Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr

No- 10219/96M(iv)-BSR Circle/2026-27 **Dated-07.10.2026**

Very Short E-Procurement Inviting Tenders

On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Superintending EngineerBulandshahr Circle, U.P.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites following percentage rate bid online through http://etender.up.nic.infrom the eligible and approved Contractors registered with P.W.D. class as per column no. 10 below Category as applied from Date 15.10.2026 to 21.10.2026 upto 12:00 Noon as per the prescribed T-2 of Govt. of U.P. The technical bids will be opened online on dated 21.10.2026 at 12:30P.M. If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day, at the same time any validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

Sl. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lakh)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lakh)	Time of Completion work including rainy season	Tender document fee including GST (In Rs.)	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	जनपद गौतमबुद्धनगर में वित्तीय वर्ष 2025-26 में त्वरित आर्थिक विकास योजना के अन्तर्गत ग्राम छतंगा कला में एक सामुदायिक केंद्र का निर्माण कार्य।	55.00	4.75	09 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000+18% G.S.T.Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	Executive Enginner Provincial Division, P.W.D., Gautambudhnagar	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahar Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahar	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A,B,C Building Work
2	जनपद गौतमबुद्धनगर में वित्तीय वर्ष 2025-26 में त्वरित आर्थिक विकास योजना के अन्तर्गत जनता इंटर कॉलिज जेवर में दविमंजिला सामुदायिक भवन का निर्माण कार्य।	34.00	3.40	09 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000+18% G.S.T.Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	Executive Enginner Provincial Division, P.W.D., Gautambudhnagar	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahar Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahar	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A,B,C Building Work
3	जनपद गौतमबुद्धनगर में वित्तीय वर्ष 2025-26 में त्वरित आर्थिक विकास योजना के अन्तर्गत जेवर स्थित देवी मंदिर में दविमंजिला सामुदायिक भवन का निर्माण कार्य।	34.00	3.40	09 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000+18% G.S.T.Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	Executive Enginner Provincial Division, P.W.D., Gautambudhnagar	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahar Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahar	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A,B,C Building Work
4	जनपद गौतमबुद्धनगर में वित्तीय वर्ष 2025-26 में त्वरित आर्थिक विकास योजना के अन्तर्गत जहांगीरपुर नगर में बूढा बाबू गेट के पास दविमंजिला सामुदायिक भवन का निर्माण कार्य।	34.00	3.40	09 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000+18% G.S.T.Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	Executive Enginner Provincial Division, P.W.D., Gautambudhnagar	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahar Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahar	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A,B,C Building Work

1. Time allowed for completion of Whole work is mention in col. No. 5 with including rainy season.
2. The Tender Document fee must be deposited through Internet Banking only.
3. All registered contractors have to upload Turnover certified by C.A. of last 5 years and details of maximum cost of work satisfactorily completed in last 5 years on Chanakya Software before submission of tender.
   Details of e-tender uploaded on **http://etender.up.nic.inshall** also be uploaded on UP PWD Chanakya software, before last date & time of submission of bid.
4. Terms & other conditions related to bid are available on **http://etender.up.nic.in**
5. During execution of work contractor should ensure the all safety Measures for COVID-19issued by the Uttar Pradesh government.
6. In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL for Prahari is **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/**.

(Kanchan Singh)
Executive Engineer
P.D., PWD,
Gautambudhnagar

UPID-258053 Dt. 12/10/2026
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(Maneesh Verma)
Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahar circle, PWD
Bulandshahar

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I Mehul Verma S/o Anil Verma R/o WZ-1598K/2 nangal raya South West Delhi-110046, my father's name has been wrongly written as Anil Kumar in my Passport No N9376994, my father actual name is Anil Verma. 0071065503-1

I,Prashant,S/o-Rajpal Yadav R/o Village-Naurangpur(157),Sikohpur, Gurgaon(Haryana)-122004,have changed my name to Prashant Yadav for all Purposes. 0040883314-3

I RASHMI KAPOOR D/o HARPAL SINGH W/o HARPREET SINGH R/o M-93 2nd Floor Street 10 Hari Nagar Delhi-110064 have changed my name to RASHMEET KAUR vide affidavit 09/10/2026 Notary JK SHARMA Delhi. 0050299572-1

I, MANI GARG w/o Mr.ABHISHEK AGARWAL, residing at 8/6, Gulmohar road Shipra suncity Indirapuram, Ghaziabad,U.P - 201014, declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as MANI in my minor daughter AVNI AGARWAL aged 17 years in her 10th Class Marks Statement Cum Certificate (Roll no.21169951).The actual name of mine is MANI GARG,which may be amended accordingly. 0040883305-1

I RAMESH SHARMA,S/O-RAM NATH SHARMA,R/O.JE-38, KHIRKI EXTENSION,MALVIYA NAGAR,NEW DELHI 110017, HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO RAMESH KUMAR 0040883310-5

I,LATA D/O RAKESH KUMAR R/O A-4/164, NEW KONDLI, MAYUR VIHAR, PHASE-3, EAST DELHI, DELHI-110096 changed my name to NAYRA. 0040883302-6

I, MAANYA S/o SURENDER KUMAR R/o-378, Sector-11, Vasundhra, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Maanya Kwatra for all purposes 0071065537-1

I,ZAKIR AHMED,Son of RAFIQ AHMED,R/o-H NO-B-1/136, GALI NO-20,AND 1, ZIAUDDINPUR,MUSTAFABAD,NORTH EAST,DELHI-110094,I have changed my name to MOHD ZAKIR for all purposes. 0040883299-5

I,Garima Garg,R/o A-52 Gagan Enclave Amrit Nagar Ghaziabad U.P.-201001, have changed my minor daughter's name Drishti Jain to Drishti Garg 0040883306-8

I SHAM SUNDER S/O DASHRATH PARSHAD R/O-S.T.NO-1 DHANDARI KHURD DHANDARI KALAN LUDHIANA PUNJAB-141014 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHYAM SUNDER 0040883310-7

I Mehul Verma S/o Anil Verma R/o WZ-1598K/2 nangal raya South West Delhi-110046, my mother's name has been wrongly written as Purnima in my Passport No N9376994, my mother actual name is Purnima Verma. 0071065506-1

I, kunnu S/o Sh. Rajkumar chauhan,R/o 37,karhera, mohan nagar, Gaziabad, mohan Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201007 have changed my name to Raja for all purposes. 0071065572-1

I,RENU W/o-Vijay Kumar R/o-35-DG-3, Vikas Puri Delhi-110018, have changed my name to RENU CHAUHAN for all purposes 0040883306-1

I, Suman W/o Sohan Lal Ahuja R/o House No. 927, HIG, Near Sanatan Dharam Mandir, Sector 29, VTC: Faridabad Sector 29, Faridabad, Haryana-121008 have changed my name to Suman Ahuja 0071065478-1

I,ANNA UR REHMAN,S/O HEDAYATTULLAH ANSARI R/O H-115, BLOCK-H, VIJAY VIHAR, PHASE-2,RITHALA DELHI-110085 have changed my name to ATAUR REHMAN ANSARI. 0040883302-8

I,Jitender S/o Hajari Lal R/o Bharangi,PO:-Nahar,Rewari (Haryana) -123303, have changed my name to Jitender Singh for all Purposes. 0040883314-5

I Madhuri Chugh D/o Ram Narain Chugh and W/o Rakesh Ahluwalia R/o 3C/42, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi-110005, have changed my name to Madhuri Ahluwalia 0071065530-1

I,Seekha Kumari W/o Vasudev Pandey R/o RZ-38,Gali No-2,I Block,West Sagarpur,Nagal Raya,Delhi-110046,have changed my name to Seekha Pandey. 0040883326-1

I,MD RIZWAN,Son of-ABDUL RAHMAN,R/o-H NO-3296,GALI NO-22B,NEAR AKBARI MASJID,RAJIV GANDHI NAGAR, MUSTAFABAD,NORTH EAST,DELHI-110094,I have changed my name to MOHD RIZWAN,for all purposes. 0040883299-7

I, SANJEEV KUMAR S/O JAGDISH LAL UPPAL R/o 1/68, BLOCK-1, RAMESH NAGAR, DELHI-110015, have changed my name to SANJEEV UPPAL. 0040883302-1

I, hitherto known as "YOJANA KUMAR" alias "YOJANA", W/O Rajesh Kumar R/O H.No 40-A, Pocket-C, Siddhatrha Extension, Post Office: Jangpura South District, New Delhi-110014, changed my name and shall hereafter be known as "YOJANA". It is hereby certified that I have complied with all other legal requirements in this connection. 0040883218-1

I, Sultana Begam W/O Shahbuddin R/o F-1/40, D.D.A Flats, Sunder Nagri, Delhi-110093, Have Changed My Name To SULTANA. Permanently. 0040883314-7

I,Alok Behari Mathur,S/o-Rajbans Behari Mathur,R/o-D 1802,AIG Park Avenue,Gaur City 1,Sector 4,Greater Noida West,Gautam Budh Nagar,Uttar-Pradesh-201306,have changed my name from,Alok Behari Mathur to Alok Mathur,for all future purposes. 0040883306-3

I, HARINDER KUMAR S/o JAGDISH PARKASH R/o HOUSE NO. 2141 BADSHAHPUR TETHAR(222) BADSHAHPUR, GURGAON HARYANA - 122101 have changed the name of my minor daughter from TAVISHA to TAVISHA SHARMA for all purposes. 0071065483-1

I, Mohd Mozaffar Husain S/o Abdul Kalam, R/O,WZ-247 Basai-Darapur, Ramesh-Nagar, West-Delhi, New Delhi-15,have changed my name to Mohammad Mozaffar Hussain all-purposes. 0040883302-10

I, Shiv Narayan S/o Partap Singh R/o 56B, Rishi Nagar, Rani Bagh, Delhi -110034, have changed my name to Shiv Narayan Dahiya permanently. 0040883213-1

I,Zaheer Khan,S/O-Tahir Ahamad,Address-Rz-524/24b, Tughlakabad extension New delhi-110019,have changed my name to Zahir Ahamad. 0040883299-9

I,Vijita Abhishek Pandey W/O Abhishek Pandey R/O Flat. No.108,Tower-9, Purvanchal Royal Park, Sector-137, Shahdara, Uttar Pradesh-201304,have changed,my minor daughter name,from Akshita Pandey to Akshita Abhishek Pandey. 0040883310-2

I, PAWAN KUMAR GUPTA S/o Mange Ram Garg R/o-A-51, 2nd-Floor Phase-3,Ashok Vihar Delhi-110052,have changed my name to PAWAN GARG 0040883302-3

I, BHAGWAN DASS S/O Shri Khem Chand R/O 261A, Pocket-1, Mayur Vihar Phase 1, Delhi - 110091,have changed my name to BHAGWAN DASS MIDHA for all my future purposes 0071065510-1

I, Usha Devi, wife of Chaman Lal Duggal, resident of 42-D, Block-U & V, Shalimar Bagh, Delhi - 110088, hereby declare that my name has been mentioned as "Usha Devi" in my Passport No. N9376471.My correct name is "Usha Duggal," and I have changed my name from Usha Devi to Usha Duggal. Henceforth, I shall be known as Usha Duggal for all future purposes and official records. 0040883323-1

I, Satnarain Garg,S/o-Dhani Ram,R/o-2143,Bawana Road,Old Anaj Mandi,Narela, Delhi-110040,have changed my name to Sat Narain,for all future purposes. 0040883302-5

I,Lovely,W/o-Sunny Verma,R/o-Flat No.1967, Tower I Block,11th Avenue,Gaur City 2,Greater Noida West,Gautam Budh Nagar,UP - 201009,have changed my name to,Lovely Verma,for all purposes. 0040883299-2

I,Anand,S/o-Gyan Singh Yadav, R/o-Flat No.B-104,Jeevan Ashray Apartments, Vishwakarma Road,Sector 62, Noida,Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301,have changed my name to Anand Yadav for all future purposes. 0040883306-5

I, No. 7772248N Rank Ex HAV Pandeya Sunil Kumar Sinha S/o (Late) Panday Shoenanden Prasad R/o A-1/253, Gali No-8, Near Shiv Mandir, Harsh Vihar, Mandoli, PO: Nand Nagri, Delhi - 110093 have changed my name to Pandey Sunil Kumar Sinha vide affidavit date 12-10-26 before Delhi. 0071065488-1

I,Prabhakar Kumar Saxena,S/o-Ghanshyam Bahadur Saxena, R/o.B-107,South City - 1,Gurugram(Haryana)-122007,have changed my name to Prabhakar Saxena for all future Purposes. 0040883314-2

I, Najreen, W/o Shakeel Ahmed, R/o 2260, Gali Dakotan, Turkman Gate Delhi-110006, have changed my name to Nazreen, for all purposes. 0040883233-1

I,Jitendrakumar Jorabhai patel, Address-B-5,Ravirashmi Society, Ramdevnagar, Jodhpur Tekra,Setellite, Ahmedabad-380015,have changed my minor son Gauraang to Gauraang Jitendrakumar patel 0040883310-4

I, RASHNA SHAKEEL KAPADI W/o AMIT SINGH R/o 1701-B GUNDECHA SYMPHONY LANE OF FUN REPUBLIC, VEERA DESAI ROAD, NEAR COUNTRY CLUB, ANDHERI WEST, MUMBAI, MAHARASHTRA, 400053 That name of mine has been wrongly written as RASHNA KAPADI in my Marriage Certificate No. 644. The actual name of mine is RASHNA SHAKEEL KAPADI. 0071065515-1

I,SANJAY DAWER,S/O: B.R.Sharma,R/o-Pocket-H,153-A,Dilshad Garden,Jhilmil,East Delhi,Delhi-110095,have changed the name of my minor daughter Shradha Dawer,aged 13 years,and she shall hereafter be known as,SHRADDHA DAWER. 0040883299-4

I,Garima Jain D/o Sushil Kumar Garg R/o A-52 Gagan Enclave Amrit Nagar, Ghaziabad U.P.-201001,have changed my name to Garima Garg 0040883306-7

I, Rajesh Ram S/o Ram Samujh Singh R/o Flat No 62, Deluxe apartment, NearDharamshila Hospital, Vasundhara Enclave, DelhiI-110096 have changed my name to Rajesh Kumar 0071065505-1

I,Usha Somnath Nair,D/o-Puliyampath Ramchandran Nair,R/o.B-503,Shree Shashwat CHST,Saint Meerbani Road,Sejal Park,Gharatan Pada-2,Mumbai,Maharashtra-400068,have changed my name to Usha Nair for all Purposes. 0040883314-4

I,GEETIKA MAHESHWARI,D/o-Late YOGESH KUMAR MAHESHWARI, R/o Gali-No.2,Bharat Singh Colony,Village-Sabha Pur,Karawal Nagar,Delhi-110094,declare that "NANCY" and "GEETIKA MAHESHWARI" refer to one and the same person, i.e.,myself, and I shall be known as GEETIKA MAHESHWARI for all future purposes. 0040883306-9

I, SANJAY YADAV (holder of Indian Passport No. T2487978) son of KASHI RAM YADAV having permanent residence in 7/11B, Jantar Mantar Road, New Delhi, Pin 110001, India intend to change my name from SANJAY YADAV to SANJAY ADVAIT for all practical purpose. Any objection towards my name change may please be communicated to Embassy of India, Muscat, Diplomatic Quarters, Al Khuwair, P.Box No. 1727, Postal Code 112, Ruwi, Sultanate of Oman. 0040883305-2

I, MOHD IMRAN S/O ATIQ UR REHMAN R/O, 5273, KUCHA REHMAN CHANDANI CHOWK DELHI 110006, have changed my name to MOHAMMAD IMRAN Permanently. 0071065570-1

I,VED PARKASH S/O SHYAM SUNDER R/O-C-3,2ND.FLOOR F-115 STREET NO-3 SAIDUL AZAIB MEHRAULI DELHI-110030 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO VEDPRAKASH 0040883310-6

I,PARVEEN KANSAL,S/O-BHAGWAN DASS KANSAL,R/O-BEHIND M. M.PUBLIC SCHOOL,54,VASUDHA ENCLAVE, VTC,PITAMPURA,DELHI-110034,have changed my name to PARVEEN KUMAR permanently. 0040883302-7

I, Yogesh bhati S/o Bijender Singh, House No-06, Village-Chamrawli Bodaki Dadel, Post: Dadri, Dist: G.B Nagar, U.P have changed my minor son Name ABEER BHATI to ABEER SINGH for all purposes. 0071065553-1

I,MD IMRAN,Son of MOHD RIZWAN,R/o-H NO-3296,GALI NO-22B,NEAR AKBARI MASJID,RAJIV GANDHI NAGAR, MUSTAFABAD,NORTH EAST,DELHI-110094,I have changed my name to,MOHAMMAD IMRAN,for all purposes. 0040883299-6

I,Ritu Rani,D/O-Suresh Kumar,born on 28 August 1988,residing at RZ-1101 A,Gali Number 11,Sadh Nagar,Palam,New Delhi-110045, hereby declare that,Ritu Rani and,Ritu are one and the same person, and,I wish to be known and recorded by the name Ritu only. 0040883310-8

I,Amrinder Singh Bakshi,S/o-Parminder Singh Bakshi,I Have changed My Son,s Name Sahib Singh to change Sahib Singh Bakshi have permanently. 0040883314-6

I, Dipali Bhanudas Shingote C/O Ketan Nanasaheb Patil, R/o Flat No-1501, 15th Floor, Tower-23, Sector-100, Lotus Boulevard, Noida Sector-37, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201303 have changed my name to Dipali Ketan Patil for all future Purposes. 0071065584-1

I,NIKHIL KUMAR,S/O-SHAILENDRA SINGH,R/O-NEAR POST OFFICE, MOHALLA-BHEEMNAGAR,THE KURAWALI DISTT.MAINPURI,UTTAR PRADESH,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM,NIKHIL KUMAR,TO NIKHIL SINGH,FOR FUTURE PURPOSE AND,NIKHIL KUMAR,AND NIKHIL SINGH,BOTH ARE THE NAME OF ONE AND SAME PERSON. 0040883306-2

I, Sohan Lal S/o Kashi Ram R/o House No. 927 Hig, Near Sanatan Dharam Mandir, VTC: Faridabad Sector 29, Haryana-121008 have changed my name to Sohan lal Ahuja 0071065479-1

I,VIKRANT YADAV S/o Raj Roop Yadav,R/o-WZ-65 Shakur Pur Village Delhi-110034,have changed my minor son name from UDAY VEER YADAV to UDAY VEER SINGH 0040883302-9

I Syed Asifardawlla S/o Morsed Mir R/o 53, Picnic Garden Road, Tiljala, PO- Tiljala, Dist- South 24 Parganas, West Bengal-700039, have changed my name to Asif Mir 0071065531-1

I,Kapil Kumar,S/o-Bishan singh,R/o-House no 48,Rajpur Khurd Falsha Chowk,Mehroli, Maidan Garhi,New Delhi-110068,Have Changed my Name to Kapil kumar Rathi,For all future purpuse. 0040883299-8

I,Vijita Pandey W/O Abhishek Pandey,R/O Flat No.108,Tower-9,Purvanchal Royal Park,Sector-137,Shahdara,Uttar Pradesh-201304,have changed,my name,to Vijita Abhishek Pandey. 0040883310-1

I,Sanjeev Uppal,S/o-Late Jagdish Lal Uppal,R/o-1/68, Block-1, Ramesh Nagar,Delhi-110015,that name of my father has been wrongly-written as Jagdish Lal in my Passport-No.J4756929.The actual name of my father is Jagdish Lal Uppal. 0040883302-2

I, JERALD, S/o Joven Varghese, R/o 539 Mandakini Enclave, Alaknanda, New Delhi-19, have changed my name to JERALD JOVEN MALAKKARAN. 0130070224-1

I, Dr. Mangal Singh, S/o Mr. Ram Chandra Singh, residing at Plot No. 376, Ground Floor, Shakti Khand-1, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201014, have changed my name from Dr. Mangal Singh to Dr. Mangal Singh Rana and shall hereafter be known as Dr. Mangal Singh Rana for all purposes. 0040883197-1

I,Shabbar Raza,S/o-Syed Mohd Hasnain Rizvi,R/o-Flat No.0002, Tower A-4,Saviour Greenisle,Crossing Republik,Ghaziabad,UP - 201016,have changed my name to Shabbar Raza Rizvi,for all purposes. 0040883299-1

I,Vrinda Makharia,D/o-Vaneet Sehgal and,W/o-Shubham Makharia R/o H.NO- 7,Road No-13,Punjabi Bagh Extn,Punjabi Bagh,Delhi - 110026,have changed my name to Vrinda Sehgal 0040883306-4

I,Ali Husain,S/o Allah Bux R/o-H.No-3,2nd Floor,APJ Abdul Kalam Road Delhi-110003,Have Changed My Name To Ali Hussain For Future. 0040883314-1

I, VIKAS KUMAR S/o MAHENDER SINGH R/o K-333, JAHANGIR PURI, N.S. MANDI, NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI, 110033 have changed the name of my minor Son from SARTHAK to SARTHAK KUMAR for all purposes. 0071065484-1

I,Ali Husain,S/o Allah Bux R/o-H.No-3,2nd Floor,APJ Abdul Kalam Road Delhi-110003,Have Changed My Name To Ali Hussain For Future. 0040883314-1

I, Rohan Baisla, S/o- Subhash Kumar Baisla, R/o- 1645, Kotla Mubarakpur, Delhi-110003, declare that my father's name wrongly-written as Subhash Baisla in my 10th-class Marksheet-cum-Certificate. My father's actual name is Subhash Kumar Baisla, which may be amended accordingly. 0040883299-10

I,Vijita Abhishek Pandey W/O Abhishek Pandey R/O Flat.No.108,Tower-9,Purvanchal Royal Park, Sector-137,Shahdara,Uttar Pradesh-201304,have changed my minor daughter name,from Aavya Pandey to Aavya Abhishek Pandey. 0040883310-3

It is,general information that I,Brij Bala,W/o-Satbir,residing at H.No.576,Pana Udyan, Narela,Delhi-110040,declare that name of my minor son has been wrongly written as Sujal in my minor son namely Sujal Rajput,aged-12-years,in his school-records.The actual name of my minor son is Sujal Rajput, which may be amended accordingly. 0040883302-4

I, MOHAMMAD FAIZ ALAM S/o MOHAMMAD SHAMSHE ALAM R/o H-679, SHAKUR PUR, PO: SARASWATI VIHAR, DIST: NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI - 110034 have changed my name to MD FAIZ ALAM for all purposes 0071065513-1

I, Anita Devi, W/o Dinesh Chand Srivastav, Address-Rz-105A/14, Tughlakabad Extention,New Delhi -110019 have changed my name to Anita Rani Srivastav. 0040883321-1

I,Priya,W/o-Bibesh Kumar,R/o-Flat No.1504,Tower C5, Supertech Eco Village 2,Sector 16B,Greater Noida West, Gautam Budh Nagar, UP - 201318,have changed my name to,Priya Yadav,for all purposes. 0040883299-3

I,RAKTIM SARMAH,S/O-NAGEN SARMAH,R/O.A-9,1904, SAVIOUR GREENISLE, CROSSING REPUBLIK, GHAZIABAD,UP-201016,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ROKTIM SARMAH FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES 0040883306-6

I, SONU MAGGO, S/o Smt. Nirmal Maggo, R/o 16/40, Geeta Colony, Delhi-110031, declare that SONU MAGON, SONU KR. MAGON and SONU KUMAR MAGON are the same person. My correct name is SONU MAGGO as per Aadhaar, PAN and Passport. 0040883185-1

LOST & FOUND

LOST my Original PARTNERSHIP DEED Papers,dtd-01-04-2000 of United Technical,Corp.S-27-Badli,Phase-II,Industrial Area Delhi.Finder Kindly contact, Dinesh Sharma,S/o-Raj Pal Sharma,at above Address Mob-9811076539 0040883306-10

I Ramesh Sachdeva S/o Bhagwan Das Sachdeva R/o House No. 309-A, Ground Floor, Ram Nagar, East Delhi-110051 have lost my Agreement, Receipt and Will Deed executed on 17.08.2017 by Santosh Anand in favour of Rekha Gulati W.R.T. Property No. C-22, Second Floor, Radhey Puri, Delhi-110051. Finders may contact at above address. 0040883183-1

Lost all original DDA Documents against my Flat No.F-6/63, First Floor, Sector-16, Rohini, Delhi-110089. Finder may Contact-Deepak Nagpal S/o-J.N.Nagpal at above noted address. 0040883209-1

I,Kulbir Singh Bali,R/o-H.No.-205,Mohyal Colony,Sector -40, Gurugram (Haryana),have Lost my Original deed of,Conveyance (Referance No.-02AA872286) & Documents finder please Contact above address #9873469933. 0040883314-11

PUBLIC NOTICE

सार्वजनिक सूचना

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि मेरी मुवक्किला श्रीमति सोनी देवी पत्नी स्व० श्री लक्ष्मी नारायण, निवासी बी-17, जे. जे. कॉलोनी, रघुबीर नगर, टैगोर गार्डन, दिल्ली-110027 ने अपने पुत्र प्रदीप कुमार व उसकी पत्नी प्रिया को उनके गलत आचरण व दुर्व्यवहार करने के कारण अपनी समस्त चल-अचल सम्पति से बेदखल कर दिया है तथा समस्त सम्बन्ध विच्छेद कर लिये है। भविष्य में कोई व्यक्ति इनके साथ किसी भी प्रकार का कोई लेन देन, दीवानी, फौजदारी मुकदमे के लिए, या फिर इनके द्वारा किये गये किसी भी कानूनी कार्यवाही के लिये मेरी मुवक्किला व उसके परिवार के अन्य सदस्यों की कोई जिम्मेदार नही होगी।

हस्ता/-
महेश कुमार (एडवोकेट)
Enroll No. D/5229/24

PUBLIC NOTICE

To be known to all that I, Rajender Kumar S/O Shri Ved Prakash and Smt. Sushila Devi Mutatee of Application no. 40601 under Rohini Residencial Scheme 1981 has lost original Allotment_Cum_Demand Letter . An FIR (LR.No.693026/2026) to this effect has been lodged at maurya enclave police station Delhi on 04/10/2026. Any person claiming any right, intrest, having any objection or found in possession of original documents may write/contact with the above named person at address Gu 265B Pitampura/Phone 9313980153. Delhi, within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice.

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is for general information that **I, AJAY SRIVASTAVA S/O RAM JI LAL R/O 218, T/F, BABA FARIDPURI, PATEL NAGAR WEST, CENTRAL DELHI, DELHI-110008** declare that name of mine, my wife and minor daughter has been wrongly written as **AJAY KUMAR, MAMTA** and **KETKI** in my minor daughter **KETKI SRIVASTAVA** aged 15 years in her school records. The actual name of mine, my wife and my minor daughter are **AJAY SRIVASTAVA, MAMTA SRIVASTAVA** and **KETKI SRIVASTAVA,** which may be amended accordingly.

PUBLIC NOTICE

THIS IS TO INFORM the general public THAT, M/s. New India Detergents Pvt. Ltd. having its registered office at F-50, DJ, Radhey Mohan Drive, Chhattarpur South Delhi, New Delhi, South Delhi – 110074, Delhi have declared that they are the owners and in possession of Industrial Unit admeasuring 96 Kanal 6 Marla i.e. 12.0037 Acres comprised in Khasra no. 37// 13 (2-7), 18 (7-13), 19 (8-0), 22 (8-0), 23 (8-0), 41// 2 (8-0), 3 (8-0), 8 (8-0), 9 (8-0), 12 (8-3), 13 (8-0), 18 (8-0), 19 (5-10) and 23 (2-18) in the revenue estate of Village Rajpur, Sub Tehsil Sadhaura, District Yamuna Nagar, Haryana; hereinafter referred to as "the said Property".

It is further informed that HDFC Bank Limited, intends to extend a financial facility to the aforesaid owner against the said Property as security and that the owners have agreed to mortgage the said Property and confirms that the said Property has clear and marketable title, without any encumbrances.

That Original Gift Deed bearing no. 2365 dated 12.12.2011 executed by Bimla Devi and Sunil Kumar in favour of Harvinder Kumar in respect of 640/1651 share in land admeasuring 10 Kanal in Khasra no. 37// 13 (2-7) and 8 (7-13) has been misplaced and is not traceable.

In case the same is found the same shall be returned to the undersigned immediately.

Adv. Himanshu Bansal,
Progressive Law Group,
9/14, Third Floor,
East Patel Nagar,
Delhi – 110008,
himanshu@plgroup.in

DATE :- 13/10/2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that my clients **Sh. Jai Singh,** S/o Late Atar Singh and **Smt. Baby,** W/o Sh. Jai Singh both R/o H. No. D-165, Ganesh Nagar Pandav Nagar Complex, East Delhi-110 092 have severed all their relations with their son **Sh. Jitender Kumar** and his wife **Smt. Satyawati @ Annu,** D/o Sh. Netra Pal Singh due to their bad habits. My said clients have also disowned and debarred their said son and his said wife from all of their movable and immovable properties. Anybody dealing with above named **Sh. Jitender Kumar** and his wife **Smt. Satyawati @Annu** will do so at his/her/their own risk and responsibility/ies and my clients will not be responsible for any such acts, deed or dealing done by **Sh. Jitender Kumar** and his wife **Smt. Satyawati @ Annu.**

Sd/-
LALIT KUMAR (Advocate)
Ch. 12, Old Lawyer's Chamber,
Supreme Court of India
Tilak Marg, New Delhi-110001

PUBLIC NOTICE

Sale Deed favouring Dinesh Kukreja executed by Sudarshan Kumar Suman in respect of Ground Floor without roof rights of Prop No.F-12, Vikas Puri, New Delhi-110018 land area measuring 160 sq. mtrs., duly regd. as document No.6945, on dated 02.05.1996, Sale Deed favouring Sita Ram Sharma executed by Dinesh Kukreja in respect of above mentioned Ground Floor without roof rights of Prop No.F-12, Vikas Puri, New Delhi, duly regd. as document No. 5620, on dated 09.07.1997, General Power of Attorney favouring Sh. O.P. Arora executed by Sh. Sita Ram Sharma vid GPA duly regd. as document No.66222, dated 4.12.1999 and Agreement to Sell dated 04.12.1999 alongwith SPA, Receipt, Will etc. in respect of above mentioned property No.F-12, Ground Floor without roof rights, situated at Vikas Puri, New Delhi have been lost while I am going to take photocopies of the above said documents. Finder contact to SANTOSH AGGARWAL at above address/M. No.9999986818

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is publically informed that my client, DHARMENDRASINH VISHWANATHSINH CHAUHAN S/O VISHWANATHSINH CHAUHAN R/O 13, CHAUHAN PALASE, DARJI NI CHALI, SATYANARAYANNAGAR, AMRAIWADI, AHMEDABAD CITY, GUJARAT, 380026, owner of property No.202, Second Floor, Kohat Enclave, Pitampura, Delhi-34, vide Sale Deed Registration No.12763, in Book No.I, Volume No.5425, pages 43 to 50, dated 27/11/2014, has been lost/misplaced on dated 12/10/2026 and he has intimated this fact to P.S. Crime Branch, Delhi, on 13/10/2026 vide I.R. No.718118/2026. Any Person who may found such original Sale Deed shall deliver the same at the aforesaid address of my client. And now my client intends to sell/transfer the aforesaid property. Any person (s)/Bank/ Financial Institution, etc., have any claim, right, title, interest, objection then he/she/they can contact either my client mobile No.7096712345 and in writing at his address or me in writing at dineshkradvocate78@gmail.com, within Seven Days from the date of this Notice, failing which such objection shall be treated as null and void. **DINESH KUMAR (Advocate)**
Enrl.No.D/5096/17

सार्वजनिक सूचना

मेरे मुवक्किल (1) श्री बद्री प्रसाद पुत्र स्वर्गीय रेवड़ राम पता A-2/292, नन्द नगरी दिल्ली-110093 और (2) श्रीमती विमला देवी पत्नी श्री बद्री प्रसाद पता A-2/292, नन्द नगरी दिल्ली-110093 ने अपने पुत्र "दया चंद" (विवाहित) और उसकी पत्नी "वंदना" को उनके दुर्व्यवहार, अनादर, अवज्ञा और क्रोध के कारण अपनी चल एवं अचल संपत्तियों से वंचित / बेदखल कर दिया है और हमने उसके साथ अपने सभी संबंध समाप्त कर लिए हैं तथा हम उनके किसी भी कार्य के लिए के लिए उत्तरदायी नहीं रहेंगे उनके साथ व्यवहार करने वाला कोई भी व्यक्ति अपने जोखिम और परिणामों के लिए खुद जिम्मेदार रहेगा।

अमर सिंह (अधिवक्ता)
Enrollment No. D/3500/2010
MOBILE: +91 93135 00952.

सार्वजनिक सूचना

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि मेरे मुवक्किल श्री यदु नंदन यादव पुत्र श्री अम्बिका यादव एवं श्रीमती रंजू देवी पत्नी श्री यदु नंदन यादव दोनों निवासी KH.59/1, 30/B स्वतंत्रा नगर, नरेला, दिल्ली-110040 ने अपने पुत्र दिवाकर कुमार भारती एवं और पुत्रबधु कोमल कुमारी को उनके साथ गलत व्यवहार एवं गलत आचरण के कारण अपनी समस्त चल-अचल सम्पत्ति आदि से बेदखल कर सारे संम्बध समाप्त कर लिया हैं। कोई भी व्यक्ति दिवाकर कुमार भारती, कोमल कुमारी से किसी भी प्रकार का कोई लेन-देन या संबन्ध इत्यादि रखता है वह उसके लिए स्वंय जिम्मेवार होगा, भविष्य में दिवाकर कुमार भारती, कोमल कुमारी के किसी भी प्रकार के सिविल एवं क्रिमिनल कार्य आदि के लिए मेरे मुवक्किल जिम्मेदार नहीं होंगे।

SANJEEV JAIN (Advocate)
Enrl.No.D/226/1991

PUBLIC NOTICE

To be known to ALL that my client **Mrs. Shashi Devi Gupta W/o Late Shri Vinod Kumar Gupta R/o D-2, Sec-56** Noida-201301 aged-65 years has broken all her relationship with her elder son **Mr. SANJAY KUMAR GUPTA**-45 years, his wife Mrs. SHOBHA GUPTA-44 years, his son **Mr. NITYANT GUPTA**- 21 years and his daughter **Ms. GUNILLA GUPTA**-15 years and debarred and dis-owned all of them with immediate effect from all her moveable, immoveable property earned & owned by her and by her late husband Sh. Vinod Kumar Gupta in past, present and/or will be earned/owned by her in future. **Mrs. Shashi Devi Gupta and her 2 married daughters Mrs. Seema Gupta & Neelam Gupta** will not be responsible for any act done/will done in any manner by her elder son **Sanjay Kumar Gupta & by his family members in future.**
■ **Adv. Chanda Babu Saxena, Delhi High Courts.**

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JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

"IMPORTANT"

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ELECTRICAL WORK

E-Tender Notice No. Sr. DEE/ G&CHG/LMG/26 of 2026-27; dated: 08-10-2026. E-tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following works: **SN.1; Tender No:** EL-LM-26-27-31; **Name of work:** Comprehensive Maintenance and Four-Monthly Preventive Schedule Maintenance of 25 kVA Inverters of M/s Hitachi HI-Rel Power Electronics Make Fitted on RMPU SG AC Coaches over N.F. Railway for a Period of Three (03) Years. Tender Value: ₹1,17,30,708.00; Earnest Money: ₹2,08,700.00. **E-tender will be closed at** 11:00 hrs. on 30-10-2026 and **Opened** at 11:30 hrs. on 30-10-2026. The complete information with the tender document of above e-tender will be available upto 11:00 hrs. on 30-10-2026 on website http://www.ireps.gov.in

Sr. DEE/G&Chg/Lumding
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
"Serving Customers with a smile"

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No. LS-GD-2026-Ovh_Line_Shunt

Online open E-tender are invited by Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer (TRS)/ N.E. Railway/ Loco Shed Gonda acting for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work. **Tender Notice No. & Description Tender No.:-** LS-GD-2026-Ovh_Line_Shunt "Overhauling of Line contactor and Shunting Contactor of Conventional Electric Locos of Loco Shed Gonda for two years.", **Estimated Cost (in Rs.):-** 2,17,93,197.14, **Period of Completion:-** 24 months, **Earnest Money (in Rs.):-**4,35,900.00. • Offers can be uploaded by tenderer, up to 12:00 Hrs. on 02/11/2026. • Detailed information, minimum eligibility criteria, Terms and conditions regarding this e-tender are available at website **www.ireps.gov.in.** • Tenderer should check any correction / corrigendum related to this e-tender notice on website before uploading their offer. **Note:-1.** Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders and any such manual offer received, shall be ignored. **2.** For full details and submission of bid, Kindly visit the official website of Indian Railways, i.e. **http://www.ireps.gov.in**

ADDE/TRS Loco Shed
CPRO/EL-216 Gonda
Do Not Smoke Bidi/Cigarette in train

PUBLIC NOTICE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shrey Jain, S/o: Sanjay Jain, R/o: A-522, Block-A, Sector-46, Noida, UP-201303** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Ct. No. 880/2023, U/s: 420 IPC, Police Station Barakhamba Road, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shrey Jain** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shrey Jain** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shrey Jain** of **Police Station Barakhamba Road, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Vijayshree Rathore
JMFC-05, 1st Floor,
Main Building, Room No. 13
Patiala House Courts, New Delhi

DP/14590/NDD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Md. Majid, S/o: Riyasat, R/o: J-09, Higher Secondary School, New Seelampur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 155/22, U/s: 363/379/34 IPC, P.S. Geeta Colony, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Md. Majid** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Md. Majid** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Md. Majid** of **P.S. Geeta Colony, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.01.2027.**

By Order
Ms. Prerna Rai
JMFC-02, Room No. 15,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/14479/SHD/2026

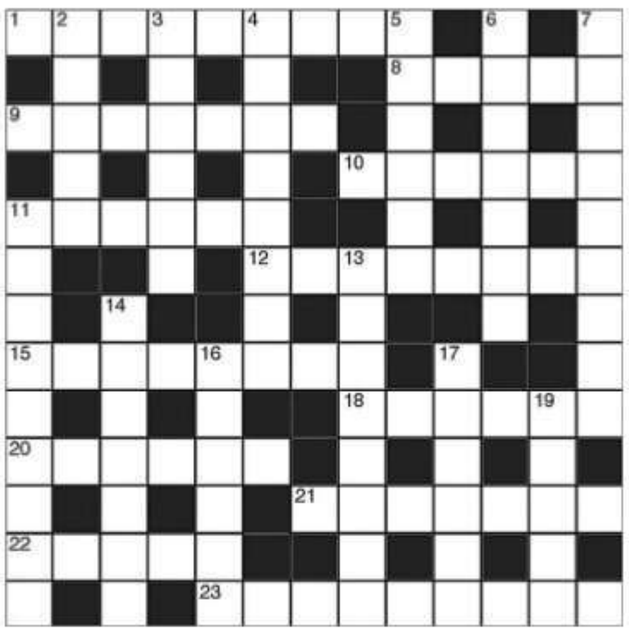
PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **S. Sundar S/o** Shankar Narayan **R/o** C-107, Ram Sons, Sector-95, Gurgaon, Haryana, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 659/2021, U/S 498A/406/34 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Rohini Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **S. Sundar** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **S. Sundar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **S. Sundar** the said accused of **FIR No. 659/2021, U/S 498A/406/34 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Roh

CROSSWORD 6119



ACROSS

1 Great picture? Far from it! (9)
8 Growing girl? (5)
9 Criminal gets in at the back of the house (7)
10 An improvement from former muddle (6)
11 Run out of clothes (6)
12 Possibly relating to the whole (8)
15 It's more unusual in someone you don't know (8)
18 'Moody' could describe Romeo's disposition (6)
20 Go back — to bed? (6)
21 I find plenty wrong stupidly (7)
22 Soundly disapproves of alcohol (5)
23 Salt recollected in sea song (9)

DOWN

2 He's one to do it wrong (5)
3 Filled perhaps or not filled! (3-3)
4 Thought one needs a spare ruler (8)
5 Spent two notes at the garden party (6)
6 Flags showing we've won a mountain pass? (7)
7 Mother badly alarmed in a jam! (9)
11 Pay out as an underwriter (9)
13 An extremely important station (8)
14 Talk goes on about proportional representation (7)
16 Point to bad verse as indication of strain (6)
17 Doctor has a ring to fix when to visit (4,2)
19 Girl takes on a hairdressing business (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6118 **ACROSS:** 1 Sleight, 4 Baker, 7 Unit, 8 Arsonist, 10 Steady wind, 12 Socked, 13 Proofs, 15 Monogamist, 18 Crossing, 19 Fiji, 20 Strip, 21 Cabinet **DOWN:** 1 Slugs, 2 Evidence, 3 Thrown, 4 Brown bread, 5 Knit, 6 Retains, 9 Idle gossip, 11 Dominion, 12 Seances, 14 Cognac, 16 Taint, 17 Hour

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Next to excellence is the ___ of it.- William Makepeace Thackeray (12)alter Scott (6,..,4)

DGAAE

GSYINT

BCORI

EORCPP

SOLUTIONS: Adage, Boric, Stingy, Copper
ANSWER: Next to excellence is the **appreciation** of it.- William Makepeace Thackeray

OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS



CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON



MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG



SUDOKU 6471

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s
INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

		5				4		
1	2						3	6
8			1		5			7
3		1	4		9	6		5
4		9	2		3	8		1
7			6		8			4
9	4						8	2
		2				7		

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6470

3	1	5	6	8	7	9	4	2
7	8	4	9	3	2	1	6	5
6	9	2	5	1	4	8	7	3
8	7	6	2	9	5	3	1	4
1	2	9	8	4	3	7	5	6
4	5	3	7	6	1	2	9	8
9	4	7	3	2	6	5	8	1
2	6	8	1	5	9	4	3	7
5	3	1	4	7	8	6	2	9

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is a fantastic day to travel and do anything to expand your world. Sports events, kids' activities, the theater and the arts will be exciting choices. You might even act on this feeling in a practical way. Tonight: Learn something.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Today is an excellent day for financial negotiations and discussions about shared property, mortgages, taxes, debt and inheritances. You'll be sympathetic but practical. Tonight: Check your finances.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Today you might attract someone very interesting to you. This person might be logical and sensitive. They might have bright ideas that they express very directly. In turn, you'll come forth with your own clever suggestions. Tonight: Listen to someone.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Today you might help someone or put the needs and wants of someone else before your own. You might be financially generous or see ways to encourage others to be helpful. Whatever you do will likely earn the respect of some. Tonight: Work.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): This is a high-energy, playful day. Enjoy chatting with friends. Sports events, fun activities with kids will be great choices. Do something that pleases you today. Romance with someone of an age difference might happen. Tonight: Socialise.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): You might make some home improvements today or pay bills and secure your home in a better way. Instead of home improvements, you can help a family member as well. Stock the fridge, because your home routine might change. Tonight: Relax at home.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): You will negotiate strongly on your behalf, or for anything that you want to do today. You might represent a group or a friend. You'll also be practical and sensible. Tonight: An interesting discussion.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Financial discussions will go well today. You might see ways to boost your income. At work you will persevere and won't overlook details. People will listen to you. Tonight: Check your possessions.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): You're in the driver's seat today. You know what you want to achieve and you will do so even if you are interrupted by someone unusual and unexpected. Tonight: You're in charge.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Today you might use the resources of someone else, perhaps a partner, to help someone in need. This person who is in need might be a family member, or they could be someone far way in a distant land. Lately, you are involved with creative, younger people, perhaps from your past. Tonight: Enjoy solitude.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): You might attract someone a bit aggressive to you today. However, this person might help you deal with friends and groups to get things done, especially if you want to help someone in need. Tonight: Be friendly.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): People will notice you today. They see you as sympathetic, strong and proactive, which is a good thing. This puts you in a position where you can convince others to listen to your ideas and perhaps jump on your bandwagon and fight for a worthy cause. Tonight: Be modest.

HARYANA REAL ESTATE REGULATORY AUTHORITY
New Mini Secretariat, 2nd Floor, Sector-1, Panchkula.
E-mail: hrerapkl-hry@gov.in, officer.rera.hry@gmail.com
Website: www.haryanarera.gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

For kind attention of allottees of the Real Estate Project "Ozone Square (Zone E & EWS)", a Group Housing Colony on land measuring 2.0643 acres (FSI of 3.0 acres) forming a part of total licensed area measuring 48.038 acres situated in Sector 89, Faridabad being developed by Heritage Cottages Private Limited.

1. The above-mentioned project was registered with HRERA Panchkula vide Registration No. HRERA-PKL-FBD-645-2024 dated 23.12.2024 valid upto 31.12.2026. After considering four months extension due to impact of West Asia War as per Office order dated 19.08.2026, the registration stands extended upto 30.04.2027 under Section-6 of RERA Act, 2016.
2. The promoter has requested the Authority that instead of revoking the registration on its expiry, the Authority may permit it to remain in force upto 30.04.2028 subject to such further terms and conditions as it thinks fit to impose in the interest of the allottees and any such terms and conditions so imposed shall be binding upon the promoter.
3. The Authority is considering the application of the promoter to permit continuation of registration under section 7(3) of the Act for this project. However, the first right of refusal for carrying out of the remaining development works is that of the association of allottees. Therefore, the Authority hereby invites objections from the association of allottees in particular and any other concerned persons in general.
4. The objections shall be filed in the registry of the Authority before 28.10.2026 which will be considered by the Authority under section 7(3) of the Act.

Secretary (Acting)
No. 50163/HRY **HRERA Panchkula**

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ONLINE TENDERING
Project Implementation Unit, Gandhinagar (Health & Family Welfare Dept.)
TENDER NOTICE PIU-96 (2026-27)

Online tenders for Health Care facilities Civil works of Various Districts Gujarat as below are invited by the Superintending Engineer, Project Implementation Unit, NRHM/PIU Building 4th Floor, Civil Hospital Campus, Gandhinagar. 382012, Ph. 079-23231434, 23231393,

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Est.Cost in Lacs (Rs.)	Tender Fee/EMD (Rs.)	Approved Regst. Class	Time Limit in Months	ID NO
1	Renovation of Office of The Health and Family Welfare Department, 7th Block, Sachivalaya, Gandhinagar	900.02	12000/ 900100	A & Above	4	

On Line Submission Dtd. 03.11.2026 upto 18.00 hrs.
Submission of Tender Fee, EMD & Other Original Documents on Dtd. 03.11.2026 Online (Documents Shall have to be Scanned & put up Online. The Original Documents shall have to be submitted within 7 days through R.P.A.D Only)
Bid Opening of tender dtd. 04.11.2026 upto 12.00 hrs. **INF-1551-2026-27**

भारतीय कंटेनर निगम लिमिटेड
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
(भारत सरकार का नवरत्न उपक्रम) (A Navratna Undertaking of Govt. of India)
NSIC New MDBP Building, 3rd Floor, Okhla Industrial Estate, Delhi-110020

PUBLIC AUCTION/TENDER NOTICE
DISPOSAL OF UNCLEARED/UNCLAIMED IMPORTED CARGO THROUGH E- AUCTION

Container Corporation of India Ltd. shall be auctioning scrap items, empty damage containers and unclaimed/uncleared imported cargo landed at the terminals of Area 1 those containers arrived on or before 31.03.2026 through e-auction on **30.10.2026** on **"AS IS WHERE IS BASIS"**. All details **along with Terms & Conditions of auction sale & cargo details will be available on www.concorindia.co.in & www.mstcecommerce.com w.e.f. 16.10.2026.** All importers including Government Undertakings/ Departments whose containers/goods are lying unclaimed/uncleared and falling in the said list uploaded in website at respective terminals, because of any dispute, stay by Court/ Tribunal/others or any such reason may accordingly inform the concerned Area Head at Area 1 of CONCOR as well as Commissioner of Customs of the concerned Commissionaires, and file their objections/claims regarding disposal of such goods within **7 (Seven Days)** of this notice failing which the goods will be auctioned on **"AS IS WHERE IS BASIS"** without any further notice. For full details please log on to www.concorindia.co.in & www.mstcecommerce.com

Area Head, Area 1

कार्यालय अधिष्ठाता
पशुचिकित्सा विज्ञान एवं पशुपालन महाविद्यालय, महू

ई-निविदा सूचना

ई-निविदा सूचना क्र: 5095/Pur./Tender/ET-01/2026-27, दिनांक 12.10.2026

पशुचिकित्सा विज्ञान एवं पशुपालन महाविद्यालय, महू (म.प्र.) द्वारा निम्न दर्शाये कार्य हेतु पंजीकृत फर्मों/ संस्थाओं से खुली निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाती है। विस्तृत निविदा ई-निविदा पोर्टल www.mptenders.gov.in पर देखी व भरी जा सकेगी। ई-निविदा प्रकाशन उपरान्त निविदा में कोई संशोधन या परिवर्तन किया जाता है तो वह मात्र उपरोक्त उल्लेखित ई-निविदा पोर्टल पर उपलब्ध रहेगा। कार्यों का विवरण निम्नानुसार है :-

क्र.	कार्य का नाम
01	पशुचिकित्सा विज्ञान एवं पशुपालन महाविद्यालय, महू (म. प्र.) मे (कम्प्यूटर पार्ट्स, फोटोकापी पार्ट्स, प्रिंटर पार्ट्स/प्रिंटर टोनर कार्ट्रेज एवं रिफिलिंग) हेतु दर निर्धारण।

- निविदा ऑनलाईन भरने की प्रारंभिक तिथि13.10.2026 से एवं अंतिम तिथि 03.11.2026
- निविदा की हार्ड कॉपी मोहर बंद लिफाफे में कार्यालय में पहुंचने की अंतिम तिथि 10.11.2026

मध्यप्रदेश पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम
कार्यालय परियोजना यंत्री, भदभदा रोड, संभाग भोपाल-01
Mobile No. 9425601545
Email ID : pe.policehousingbpl1@mp.gov.in
क्र.-मप्रपुआअविनि/1276/पयं/भोपाल-01/तशा/2026
भोपाल, दिनांक : 13.10.2026

प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

भोपाल संभाग-01 अंतर्गत निर्माण कार्य 96 आरक्षक (Stilt+6) आवासगृह पुलिस लाइन शाहजहाँनाबाद एवं 64 आरक्षक (Stilt+8) आवासगृह खजूरी सड़क जिला भोपाल हेतु निविदा क्रमांक-19/2026-27 (ऑनलाइन निविदा क्रमांक-542824, 542826 आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 06.11.2026 सायं 5:00 बजे तक ऑनलाइन खरीदे एवं दस्तावेज अपलोड किये जा सकते हैं। विस्तृत निविदा सूचना एवं अन्य विवरण **Portal : https://www.mptenders.gov.in** पर देखे जा सकते हैं।

म.प्र. माध्यम/128571/2026 **परियोजना यंत्री**

ANDHRA PRADESH CAPITAL REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (APCRDA)
Project office, Rayapudi (V), Thullur (M), Amaravati-522237, A.P.

E PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

NIT No. NIT No. 66/MAU61-ADMN0STG(OTH)/11/2026-STG, 13-10-2026
Name of Work: APCRDA - " Request for Proposal (RfP) Programme Management Consultant (PgMC) for the Amaravati Capital City Development Programme". The bid may be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from a day after approval of NIT with 21 days schedule. For further details please refer to **www.apeprocurement.gov.in** and **www.crda.ap.gov.in**

Sd/- Commissioner, APCRDA, Rayapudi

HARYANA REAL ESTATE REGULATORY AUTHORITY
New Mini Secretariat, 2nd Floor, Sector-1, Panchkula.
E-mail: hrerapkl-hry@gov.in, officer.rera.hry@gmail.com
Website: www.haryanarera.gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

For kind attention of allottees of the Real Estate Project "Royal Residency", a Group Housing Colony on land measuring 3.4568 acres (FSI of 5.0 acres) forming a part of total licensed area measuring 48.038 acres situated in Sector 89, Faridabad being developed by ORS Infrastructure Pvt. Ltd.

1. The above-mentioned project was registered with HRERA Panchkula vide Registration No. HRERA-PKL-FBD-646-2024 dated 23.12.2024 valid upto 31.12.2026. After considering four months extension due to impact of West Asia War as per Office order dated 19.08.2026, the registration stands extended upto 30.04.2027 under Section-6 of RERA Act, 2016.
2. The promoter has requested the Authority that instead of revoking the registration on its expiry, the Authority may permit it to remain in force upto 30.04.2028 subject to such further terms and conditions as it thinks fit to impose in the interest of the allottees and any such terms and conditions so imposed shall be binding upon the promoter.
3. The Authority is considering the application of the promoter to permit continuation of registration under section 7(3) of the Act for this project. However, the first right of refusal for carrying out of the remaining development works is that of the association of allottees. Therefore, the Authority hereby invites objections from the association of allottees in particular and any other concerned persons in general.
4. The objections shall be filed in the registry of the Authority before 28.10.2026 which will be considered by the Authority under section 7(3) of the Act.

Secretary (Acting)
No. 50162/HRY **HRERA Panchkula**

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE AMBALA DISTRICT COOP. MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED	FABRICATION /CONSTRUCTION OF MILK BOOTHS /MILK PARLORS CUM AMRIT PHARMACY /MILK PARLORS FOR MILK UNION, AMBALA	14.10.2026 27.10.2026	2,00,000/-	vita.haryana.gov.in	9729875323 milkplant@vitaambala.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50156/HRY

कार्यालय अधिष्ठाता
पशुचिकित्सा विज्ञान एवं पशुपालन महाविद्यालय, महू

ई-निविदा सूचना

ई-निविदा सूचना क्र: 5091/Pur./Tender/ET-01/2026-27, दिनांक 12.10.2026

पशुचिकित्सा विज्ञान एवं पशुपालन महाविद्यालय, महू (म.प्र.) द्वारा निम्न दर्शाये कार्य हेतु पंजीकृत फर्मों / संस्थाओं से खुली निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाती है। विस्तृत निविदा ई-निविदा पोर्टल www.mptenders.gov.in पर देखी व भरी जा सकेगी। ई-निविदा प्रकाशन उपरान्त निविदा में कोई संशोधन या परिवर्तन किया जाता है तो वह मात्र उपरोक्त उल्लेखित ई-निविदा पोर्टल पर उपलब्ध रहेगा। कार्यों का विवरण निम्नानुसार है :-

क्र.	कार्य का नाम
01	पशुचिकित्सा विज्ञान एवं पशुपालन महाविद्यालय, महू (म. प्र.) मे (प्रिंटिंग कार्य) हेतु दर निर्धारण

- निविदा ऑनलाईन भरने की प्रारंभिक तिथि13.10.2026 से एवं अंतिम तिथि 03.11.2026
- निविदा की हार्ड कॉपी मोहर बंद लिफाफे में कार्यालय में पहुंचने की अंतिम तिथि 10.11.2026

HARYANA REAL ESTATE REGULATORY AUTHORITY
New Mini Secretariat, 2nd Floor, Sector-1, Panchkula.
E-mail: hrerapkl-hry@gov.in, officer.rera.hry@gmail.com
Website: www.haryanarera.gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

For kind attention of allottees of the Real Estate Project "Amolik Plaza-81", a Commercial Plotted Colony on land measuring 5.04975 acres situated in the revenue estate of village Bhatola, Sector-81, Faridabad being developed by Amolik Buildcon LLP.

1. The above-mentioned project was registered with HRERA Panchkula vide Registration No. HRERA-PKL-FBD-241-2021 Dated: 05.04.2021 Valid upto 01.03.2026. Extension for a period of 87 days (as per Office Order dated 26.05.2020 and Resolution passed by the Authority on 02.08.2021 vide Item No. SPL-I) as a force majeure event due to Covid-19 granted upto 27.05.2026.
2. The promoter has requested the Authority that instead of revoking the registration on its expiry, the Authority may permit it to remain in force upto 27.09.2027 subject to such further terms and conditions as it thinks fit to impose in the interest of the allottees and any such terms and conditions so imposed shall be binding upon the promoter.
3. The Authority is considering the application of the promoter to permit continuation of registration under section 7(3) of the Act for this project. However, the first right of refusal for carrying out of the remaining development works is that of the association of allottees. Therefore, the Authority hereby invites objections from the association of allottees in particular and any other concerned persons in general.

The objections shall be filed in the registry of the Authority before 28.10.2026 which will be considered by the Authority under section 7(3) of the Act.

Secretary (Acting)
No. 50164/HRY **HRERA Panchkula**

BCCI postpones meeting with IPL stakeholders

Express News Service
Mumbai, October 13

THE BCCI has postponed its October 15 meeting with IPL franchise owners, CEOs, broadcasters and host state associations in Mumbai as its officials will attend the felicitation of the Indian men's and women's teams by Prime Minister Narendra Modi for winning gold medals in cricket at the 2026 Asian Games in New Delhi on Thursday.

In a letter to the stakeholders, BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia said, "The Hon'ble Prime Minister of India is scheduled to felicitate the Indian men's and women's teams for their outstanding performances at the recently concluded 20th Asian Games on October 15, 2026, in New Delhi. Accordingly, BCCI officials will be required to attend the felicitation ceremony."

The BCCI also said it had received requests from various stakeholders to postpone the meeting for maximum participation. "Additionally, requests have been received from various stakeholders seeking a postponement of the meeting. In view of the above, and with a view to facilitating maximum participation in person, it has been decided to postpone the meeting. The revised date and venue will be communicated in due course," Saikia said.

The Indian Express had reported last week that the BCCI had invited IPL stakeholders for a meeting as the league prepares to enter its 20th season in 2027.

After many years, the BCCI had invited state associations that hosted IPL matches, besides franchise owners, CEOs and broadcasters. The board sought their views on hosting, venue operations and match-day coordination.

The board is also expected to take a call on the Impact Player rule in the coming weeks.

After many years, the BCCI had invited state associations that hosted IPL matches, besides franchise owners, CEOs and broadcasters. The board sought their views on hosting and other affairs.

WORKING ON HIS WEAKNESS

Abhishek mixes caution with aggression to tackle off-spinners

Coaches Simon Helmot and Amit Uniyal on the room he gives himself & 'good positions' he gets into

Tanishq Vaddi
Hyderabad, October 13



Abhishek Sharma's average against off-spinners post T20 World Cup is 42 — a significant jump from the 10.6 in that tournament. CREIMAS

SALMAN AGHA, Aryan Dutt and Will Jacks have one thing in common, aside from being off-spinners: each took Abhishek Sharma's wicket at the 2026 T20 World Cup. He averaged 10.6 against that type of bowler in the tournament.

But something has changed since then.

In Indore, off-spinner Roston Chase bowled the first over to Abhishek. Usually audacious in his shot selection, Abhishek left his attacking instinct alone and played with caution.

Then Chase came back for his second over. Abhishek gave himself room and carved the ball through the off side for boundaries.

Shades of the new approach appeared in the semi-final against England, when Jacks was deployed early. In the two earlier dismissals, to Agha and Dutt, Abhishek had played with his feet stuck at the wicket. Against Jacks he gave himself room and went down the track, trying to be proactive. He was dismissed that day too, and looked jittery doing it.

It showed during the IPL. His average and strike rate against off-spinners climbed to 62 and 230. "What he's done really well is assess the situation...he might be conservative with the first one or two deliveries. But then once he understands the pace of the pitch and if there's turn, then he goes to work," Sunrisers Hyderabad assistant coach Simon Helmot said, speaking to *The Indian Express*.

His head coach at the Punjab domestic team, Amit Uniyal, said Abhishek has understood that he must play with the turn rather than against it. "For example, if the ball is going away from the body, playing across the line becomes dangerous. Now he has that like clarity; he is reading whether there is a turn or not. Where there is no turn, he goes straight. Where there is a turn, he goes over-cover."

"He's so strong down the ground, you know, from extra cover or cover to mid-wicket against spin. But then if he thinks it's turning more, he'll adjust his feet more, either across the crease or by backing away to give himself room to then access other areas," Helmot said.

The willingness to see those first few deliveries early against off-spin started to pay off for the southpaw. In Indian colours since the World Cup, he has averaged 42 and struck at 237 across 14 innings. He has been dismissed four times by off-spinners, two of them by Chase in the ongoing series against West Indies.

Measured approach

The intent to take a measured approach was there on both occasions. In Ranchi he had his feet stuck at the crease and tried to hit across the line, and was caught at mid-on, the flaw that troubled him at the World Cup. In Lucknow the dismissal came from the method he was trying to use, getting into "good positions". He gave himself room, but the ball caught the toe-end and carried to long-off. It did not work that day, but it was a tactic that bore fruit in the IPL and in the third T20I.

"Good positions means giving himself some room or getting inside the line and hitting it over backward square where there's no boundary rider," Helmot said. While the SRH coach acknowledges that hitting down the ground is one of Abhishek's strengths, bowlers have tried to cramp him for room by bowling on his pads, to which he also had to adapt.

"It's not just straight down the wicket...when Abhishek's opening the batting to off-spin, they try and tuck him up. And there might be a deep-mid wicket and a deep-mid on. So, for him, it's about how he tries to expose the field... And that's where Abhi has extreme skill," Helmot added.

Abhishek is well aware of what the opposition will dangle to force an error. "He looks to be, at times, an expansive, carefree player. But he's very tactical," Helmot said. "He is very much aware of what the opposition are going to do to him. And whether he needs some data analytics to assist in that or needs a teammate discussion."

"Preparation is really important. If I want to continue playing like this and utilise the powerplay, as the team wants me to, preparation really matters. I always believe it depends on which team I'm going to play against and which bowlers I'm going to face.," Abhishek said in the post-match press conference after his 30-ball 69-run innings in the third T20I. His father, Rajkumar Sharma, is not worried. "Abhishek does not see off-spinners as a threat. He has the game and shots in his book to counter off-spinners...batsmen also fall against pacers, and that's normal."

(With inputs from Nitin Sharma)



"What he's done really well is assess the situation. He might be conservative with the first one or two deliveries. But then once he understands the pace of the pitch.. he goes to work"

SIMON HELMOT
SRH ASSISTANT COACH



"Abhishek does not see off-spinners as a threat. He has the game and shots in his book to counter off-spinners...batsmen also fall against pacers, and that's normal"

RAJKUMAR SHARMA
ABHISHEK SHARMA'S FATHER

INDIA VS WEST INDIES, THIRD T20I: Live on Star Sports Network and JioHotstar from 7 PM.

INTERVIEW: WI BOWLING COACH

On flat wickets, pacers must aim for more yorkers: Rampaul

Tanishq Vaddi
Hyderabad, October 13

AHEAD OF the fourth T20I between India and West Indies, the visitors' bowling coach, Ravi Rampaul, in an interview with *The Indian Express* talks about the pitches in India, his favourite bowler, and what do Indian batsmen do better to score big despite hitting fewer sixes than the West Indies. Excerpts:

Pitches in India have been flat. What is your view?

When we came to India in the past, it was always batting-friendly wickets. The margin for error is very slim against a good Indian batting line-up. As West Indies bowlers, we have to be on top of our game with our execution and skill to perform in these Indian conditions.

As the white ball doesn't swing much, what are other options for bowlers?

You can't do much in the powerplay. Normally, in the powerplay with the new ball, they tend to use the swing. There isn't much swing in these conditions in India. But when the pitch is this good and so conducive to batting, we fast bowlers try to take the pitch out of the equation and try to bowl more yorkers. As we saw in the last game (3rd T20I in Indore), the percentage of yorkers increased for both teams.

What is the role of Shamar Joseph, who has express pace?

Shamar has been one of our death bowlers. We used him in the World Cup and previous T20 games as a death bowler delivering that yorker.

But seeing that the conditions are so good for batting, we try to use his extra pace in the powerplay and see if we can get some wickets using that pace and his aggression. So, that's why his role changed.

He's one we look for in Test matches. And he's now feeling his way in the white-ball game. So, definitely, with more experience and him understanding his strengths in the white-ball game, it will help him.

Gaining the experience he will get in this series, I'm sure he'll come back a much more experienced player who knows exactly what he needs to do in white-ball cricket.

"Shamar is the one we look for in Test matches. And he's now feeling his way in the white-ball game. So, definitely, with more experience and him understanding his strengths in the white-ball game, it will help him"

RAVI RAMPAUL
WEST INDIES BOWLING COACH.

Roston Chase has done very well. What works for him?

I think his consistency. Roston plans a lot regarding his bowling and the opposition. But in this series, he is trying to do different things. As you can see, he tries to bowl a lot of yorkers now, seeing that the pitch isn't spinning. So, he has a variety of skills.

How do you think balance between bat and ball can be brought?

Obviously, the pitches have a lot to do with it. Because we need assistance, whether it be swing, a little more grass on the pitch or a little bit slower, where the spinners can come into play with slower balls. That's the only way you can get bowlers coming into the game. We know how good these pitches and surfaces are. So, we just have to find a way to compete as a bowling group.

Who is the most impressive bowler from India for you?

Arshdeep Singh has been doing well as a fast bowler. With the new ball, we can see that he tries to use all his variations. When he bowls, the slower balls are effective. He is not afraid of using his yorkers in the powerplay as well.

Despite hitting lesser number of sixes in this series, how does India achieve big scores?

They are not big six hitters. But they find a way to get boundaries and rotate the strike. And they try to score all round the ground. Not just one particular area.

Acclimatised at 6, Tilak proves there's nothing in a number

Express News Service
Hyderabad, October 13

TILAK VARMA has revealed his favourite batting position several times. "I love to bat at number three; I have said that many times." He reasons: "You have the freedom. Two fielders are outside..."

His numbers are glittering at one drop. In 21 innings, he averages 43.40 at a strike rate of 150.69 with two centuries to his name. "You will get to bat in the powerplay. You don't have any expectations; you can swing well. So, every batsman enjoys playing that role," Tilak explains.

Some of his sublime knocks were etched from that position. Like the 55-ball 72-run knock in Chennai against England and a polar opposite innings against South Africa in Johannesburg, where he smacked a 47-ball-120.

As spectacular as his numbers are, his stocks are higher at number six and seven. There are reasons for the same. There is a long queue for able top order batsmen, but not many possess Tilak's shape-shifting capacity in the middle order and the knack of closing out games. He averages 65.66 batting at number six at a strike rate of 195.04 in nine outings. Both 5 and 6 combined, he averages 46 at a strike rate of 158 in 26 innings. These numbers are hard to achieve even in the ODI format, forget the T20Is. He has straddle roles, from anchor to accumulator and destroyer. He is arguably India's best rotator of strike in this format.



Tilak Varma has adjusted well to life in the middle order. CREIMAS

But his Ranji teammates are not surprised. "If he takes some responsibility, he will definitely achieve it," says Hyderabad colleague Chama Milind. "What he excels at is that, when the team is under pressure, he is the one who delivers. That is his speciality."

The audience is more than aware of his tenacity in duress. The Asia Cup final in 2025 is a classic instance. Through that tournament, his batting was pushed around, but in the final, when India was in a pickle at 2/10, he walked in, kept his composure; despite the wickets falling around him, he soaked the pressure and scored a match-winning 53-ball 69. He strode in at number four.

Again, whether batting at three or batting down the order, he has shown his versatility and ability to adjust.

The knock against Pakistan in that final in Dubai saw a calmer side, but he showed his full range in the final of the Asian Games in Nisshin last month, where he smacked a 22-ball 51 to deliver a killer blow to an already bruised Pakistan side.



Ravi Rampaul feels bowlers must adapt on batting-friendly decks. X

Atal ton earns Afghans draw against Bangla

Press Trust of India
Abu Dhabi, October 13

SEDIQULLAH ATAL'S maiden test century led Afghanistan to an epic draw against Bangladesh in a one-off cricket test on Tuesday.

Afghanistan batted for 142 overs, 92 on the fifth and final day, in its second innings to force a sensational draw. It began the day on a dodgy 132-3, lost five more wickets, but fought on to hold out to stumps at 346-8.

First drop Atal, in his third test, ate up most of the chase as he faced 332 balls over 8 1/2 hours to score 111. He was caught close to the wicket after tea, the seventh man out.

Afghanistan still had 23 overs with just tailenders left. But 34-year-old Yamin Ahmadzai faced 85 balls for a career-best 19, and Qais Ahmad, who has played franchise cricket in eight countries, faced 80 to finish with an unbeaten career-best 49.

Even No. 10 batter Zia-ur-Rehman chipped in by taking 12 deliveries.

Ahmad was dropped on 29 by Hasan Mahmud and made the ending more dramatic when he collapsed clutching his left hamstring. He soldiered on and finished the match with a six over midwicket.

Bangladesh wicketkeeper Litton set a new record of nine dismissals, a century and a half-century in the match.

Atal became the first Afghan batter to score a fourth innings Test century after he pulled Miraz to the boundary as Bangladesh struggled to get his wicket.

BRIEF SCORES: Bangladesh 346 & 372/7 declared drew against **Afghanistan** 240 & 346/8 (Sediquillah Atal 111; Ebadot Hossain 3/50).

HOW'S THE JOSH?

Hazlewood cleans up SA as Australia win first Test

Associated Press
Durban, October 13

JOSH HAZLEWOOD'S career-best 6-49 finished off world champion South Africa and helped Australia win the first cricket test by 214 runs at Kingsmead on the final day Tuesday.

Hazlewood took four of the six wickets Australia was hunting for on day five.

A target of 421 was always improbable for the Proteas and, from 102-4 overnight, they were cleaned up for 206 less than an hour after lunch and within five overs of Australia taking the second new ball.

Australia earned a fourth successive win at Kingsmead and gave South Africa, playing its first test in 11 months, a first loss in five home tests.

Middle-order batter Matt Renshaw was easily the standout player. Australia was in strife at 124-6 on day one but his 190 turned the momentum. He added 82 in the declared second innings and netted the first two wickets of a test career that began 10 years ago.

"I'm pretty tired," Renshaw said. "Been a while since I played a five-day test. Wanted to stay out as long as I could on day one. Got lucky in the second innings, got edges away. I never expected to bowl or pick up wickets but I am happy to do whatever the team needs."

South Africa captain Temba Bavuma said they needed someone to bat like Renshaw, and hopes his side can rally in the second of three tests starting on Sunday in Gqeberha.

Opening batter Aiden Markram led South Africa's fourth-innings resistance for nearly six hours with a 237-ball knock for 75 before he was ninth man out. Markram was caught behind off an inside edge to Mitchell Starc.

Hazlewood broke the defiant stand between Markram and Wiaan Mulder that started late Monday and endured for nearly two hours on Tuesday.



Josh Hazlewood took six wickets in the 2nd innings. AP

Mulder was strangled down the leg side and wicketkeeper Alex Carey snatched a low, one-handed catch. The end of Mulder's 110-ball innings for 29, after resuming on 5, brought in Kyle Verreynne, who was dismissed on 1 three balls later.

Renshaw also began a second bowling stint and Verreynne tried to cut him but gave Steve Smith a slips catch and Renshaw his second wicket of the innings, and of his career.

Markram and Marco Jansen safely reached lunch after a morning session in which South Africa scored only 64 runs in 32 overs, banking on survival against an Australia attack that was squeezing the Proteas on a fifth-day pitch that did not break up as expected.

South Africa's hopes were pinned on Markram, who has a history of thwarting the Australians in the fourth innings. He defied them for 143 in another lost cause in Durban in 2018 and scored 136 to overcome Australia in the 2025 World Test Championship final at Lord's. This was the first test between the teams since then.

In the morning, he became only the second batter in the match after Renshaw to score a half-century. But he lost partners rapidly after Australia took the new ball in the 82nd over.

Jansen was beaten through the gate by a Hazlewood nipbacker on 35, and Simon Harmer went in the same over to a riser that brushed his glove and shoulder and that Carey had to leap high for. That gave Hazlewood his 15th test five-for.

"Hazlewood is known for being consistent but that undersells him as he can reverse the ball, get the pace up, bowl anywhere," captain Pat Cummins said. "He's the captain's dream."

Markram went in the next over and the match finished in the over after that when Hazlewood claimed his sixth wicket of the innings. Renshaw had 2-30 and Starc and Cummins a wicket each.

BRIEF SCORES: Australia 390 & 314/6 beat **South Africa** 284 & 206 (Aiden Markram 75; Josh Hazlewood 6/49) by 214 runs.

WTC Points Table after Durban Test

Pos	Team	Matches	Won	Lost	Draw	PCT*
1	AUS	11	9	2	0	81.82
2	NZ	6	4	1	1	72.22
3	SA	5	3	2	0	60
4	BAN	6	3	2	1	55.56
5	IND	11	5	4	2	51.52

*PERCENTAGE OF POINTS WON FROM TOTAL POINTS CONTESTED

Ranji Day 3: A day of runs, rain and rearguards

DELHI FIGHTBACK

Ayush Badoni took five wickets as Delhi came back into the game, but Bengal still hold the upper hand in the Ranji Trophy Round 1 match at Kalyani. Bengal began Day 3 on 304/3 with a chance to bat Delhi out of the contest. Centurions Sudip Kumar Gharami and Abhishek Porel added little to their overnight scores, and only Sumanta Gupta reached 50 after that as Bengal were bowled out for 429, a lead of 189. Delhi's top order failed again. The Bengal seamers took three early wickets, and Yash Dhull retired hurt after facing one ball.

BRIEF SCORES: Delhi 240 & 101/3 trail Bengal 429 (Abhishek Porel 149, Sudip Kumar Gharami 133, Sumanta Gupta 50; Ayush Badoni 5/43) by 88 runs.

S'RASHTRA FRUSTRATED

At Rajkot, Chhattisgarh stuck to their template of batting long and slow, but Saurashtra still took the first-innings lead. The match is heading for a draw. Resuming on 122/3, Chhattisgarh were bowled out for 312 in 121.5 overs. Mayank Verma ground out 68 off 209 balls. Rahul Pradhan plugged in 41. Saurashtra lead by 80.

BRIEF SCORES: Saurashtra 392 & 45/0 lead Chhattisgarh 312 (Mayank Verma 68, Rahul Pradhan 41; Ravindra Jadeja 3/40) by 125 runs.

RAIN ALLOWS 35 OVERS

Rain and bad light allowed only 35 overs between Madhya Pradesh and Jammu and Kashmir at the Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium in Srinagar. Both sides had gone into the day believing they could take charge of an evenly poised game. Captain Shubham Sharma's unbeaten 51 took MP to 151/5 and stretched their lead to 227. J&K would back themselves to chase if MP's lead is kept below 250.

BRIEF SCORES: MP 196 & 151/5 (Shubham Sharma 51 n.o) lead J&K 120 (Aryan Pandey 3/29, Avesh Khan 3/44) by 227 runs.

KARUN TO THE RESCUE

Karun Nair's unbeaten 81 helped Karnataka recover from an early wobble against Andhra at Vijayawada, where Andhra had built a first-innings lead of 144. Resuming on 331/6, Andhra were bowled out for 418, with overnight centurion Seeram Rahul finishing on 119. Karnataka started badly again as KL Rahul fell early. They were 43/3, then 137/4, before Karun and captain Ravichandran Smaran stopped the slide. Karnataka ended Day 3 with a lead of 32.

BRIEF SCORES: Karnataka 274 & 176/4 (Karun Nair 81 n.o, Manvanth Kumar 44; Saurabh Kumar 3/41) lead Andhra 418 (Seeram Rahul 191; Shikhar Shetty 6/115) by 32 runs.

KERALA BATTLE ON

Against Jharkhand at Jamshedpur, Kerala got off to a strong start through opener Abhishek Nair's 126. Jharkhand's patience paid off in the second half of the day. After watching them bat for two days and reach 587, Kerala ended Day 3 on 269/6.

BRIEF SCORES: Kerala 269/6 (Abhishek Nair 126; Utkarsh Singh 3/44) trail Jharkhand 587 by 318 runs. ENS

RANJI TROPHY

Ajay steals Suthar's thunder

Left-arm spinner upstages his more famous teammate with 5/51; Rajasthan 170 runs ahead

Bhuvan Gupta
Jaipur, October 13

WHEN MANAV Suthar took centrestage, Ajay Singh Kukna got relegated to a supporting act for Rajasthan. Manav, a left-arm spinner from Sri Ganganagar like Ajay, has had a rapid rise to India Test stardom, moving ahead in the pecking order despite making his Ranji Trophy debut seven years after Ajay.

The situation is not new for the latter. He had been out of the team for four-odd years in the past. He persevered, made a comeback and became Rajasthan's leading wicket-taker in the 2025-26 season. That earned him a spot in Central Zone's squad for the Duleep Trophy final. But he didn't make the playing XI.

On Tuesday, Ajay finally earned the limelight ahead of Manav. His five-wicket haul brought a meandering match to life and handed the hosts a vital first-innings lead. Tamil Nadu, even after rocking Rajasthan's top order in the third innings, had their backs against the wall at stumps on Day 3. Aided by an 89-run first-innings lead, Rajasthan ended the day with an overall advantage of 170 with six wickets in hand.

The game sped up in the second session when seven wickets fell. Ajay was the catalyst, getting the ball to grip from the North End and clean-bowling three batters. A pitch that favoured the batsmen for seven sessions suddenly seemed to turn on them. The 29-year-old later said it was not a sudden change but a result of pressure built by some tight bowling.



Ajay Singh Kukna picked up five wickets for Rajasthan. EXPRESS

"The wicket was good. At such times, partnerships often form, so if you aren't giving runs, it creates pressure. When a new batsman comes, it takes time for him to settle down as well, but we kept getting wickets and the pressure on them kept mounting," Ajay said after the day's play.

The rough formed by the footmarks of left-arm seamers like Akash Singh also came into play, according to Ajay. "Patches developed outside the off-stump, so there was a slight benefit of that in a couple of wickets that we got."

The years he spent in the wilderness affected Ajay, but support from friends and fellow cricketers kept him going.

"I have stayed with (former Ranji player) Arjit Gupta since childhood. He always motivated me, saying that whenever you get an opportunity, don't miss out due to your own mistakes. There shouldn't be any regret for later in life," the 29-year-old said.

Slow start

Overnight TN batters Andre Siddharth and Sonu Yadav were ultra-cautious in the morning. Their objective was clear: cut out risk, wear down the Rajasthan bowling and trudge towards a potential first-innings lead.

It took 103 balls for the first four of the day. Siddharth punched debutant Hemant Kumar off the backfoot through the covers. It was also the only boundary before lunch.

After an obdurate 36-run stand off 152 balls, Sonu slipped while going for a second run and sacrificed his wicket.

In walked Washington Sundar, equipped to counter-attack but staying sedate nevertheless. Siddharth broke the shackles in the second session, hitting four fours to move into the 80s. That's when he went for one shot too many and perished. The TN vice-captain tried to cut a length ball from Kukna. The width wasn't there; he was cramped for room and the ball snuck past his horizontal bat onto the stumps.

Rajasthan smelled blood. Akash found his channel outside off. He had all-rounder Nidhish Rajagopal caught at cover and Sai Kishore nicking to wide slip. Ajay's guile was too much for tailenders Deepesh Devendran and Saravana Kumar, both cleaned up while attempting ambitious hoicks. Sundar was left stranded as the visitors lost their last four wickets for 10 runs.

If Rajasthan had begun entertaining thoughts of victory, Sai Kishore had thoughts of his own. Seeing Ajay's rich returns, the TN skipper took the new ball and was vindicated immediately as Sachin Yadav, going for a booming drive, got castled off the second delivery.

Pacers Saravana Kumar and Sonu Yadav chipped in with the wickets of Sumit Godara and Karan Lamba. Sai Kishore then lured a resolute Rohan Rajbhar out of his crease and 'keeper N Jagadeesan did the rest. Rajasthan were reeling at 31 for 4.

Kartik Sharma and Mahipal Lomror then combined to forge an unbeaten 50-run partnership that steadied the hosts' ship and stretched their lead to 170.

With six wickets in hand and three sessions of cricket left, they would first aim to take the prospect of defeat out of the equation. If the first session goes wicketless, Ajay said, Rajasthan might even try for an outright win.

BRIEF SCORES: Rajasthan 363 and 81 for 4 in 34 overs (Kartik Sharma 30 not out; Sai Kishore 2/25) lead Tamil Nadu 274 all out in 98.4 overs (Andre Siddharth 81; Ajay Singh Kukna 5/51) by 170 runs

Mhatre out for two months

Devendra Pandey
Mumbai, October 13

MUMBAI VICE-CAPTAIN and opening batsman Ayush Mhatre has been ruled out for nearly two months after suffering a Grade 4 hamstring tear. The right-hander played in Mumbai's opening Ranji Trophy game against Chandigarh at the Wankhede Stadium, where the hosts registered a convincing innings and 155-run win.

Mhatre's injury comes as a setback, especially after he had spent three months at the Centre of Excellence (CoE) in Bengaluru recovering from an earlier injury.

"He suffered pain while running a couple. The exact report is yet to come and how long he will be unavailable will be known later. But it is sad. He was training with us and was keen to make a good comeback this season. He is used to travelling from Virar just to train with us. He used to train with me only. He was pushing himself and was eager to do well," Mumbai captain Siddhesh Lad said after the game. Mhatre had suffered a similar hamstring injury during the IPL, which ruled him out of the tournament and competitive cricket for more than three months.

He took part in match simulations and played a few practice games before the Mumbai Cricket Association named him vice-captain of Mumbai for this season. Mumbai will be missing the services of Mhatre and opener Yashasvi Jaiswal, who will travel to New Zealand as part of the India A squad.

BRIEF SCORES: Mumbai 429 beat Chandigarh 78 and 196 in 52.1 overs (Shivam Bhambri 44; Shams Mulani 3/69, Tanush Kotian 3/30, Tushar Deshpande 2/37) by an innings and 155 runs.

Sindhu, Sen exit Denmark Open in first round

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 13

PV SINDHU hung her head in despair as Yvonne Li's lift landed inside the back line, giving the German shuttler her first win over the two-time Olympic medallist at the Denmark Open Super 750 on Tuesday.

Sindhu lost to Yvonne Li of Germany 21-13, 23-25, 19-21 in her women's singles first-round match, which lasted one hour and five minutes at the SJF Bank Arena. In the deciding game, Sindhu had a five-point lead twice, but she failed to close it out on both occasions and eventually succumbed to defeat.

Coming on the back of a quarterfinal finish at the Arctic Open earlier this month, Sindhu was slated to play An Se-young. But following a re-draw, Li became her opponent. The first game was a signature Sindhu game, where she mixed her drops with down-the-line smashes and forced Li into errors at the net.

After taking a 3-0 lead in the opening exchanges, Sindhu kept the advantage at the mid-game break, leading 11-7. She won the last point with a drop and then took the game comfortably as Li erred on the final two points, hitting the shuttle wide on both occasions. The second game was a contrast to the first, with Li forcing Sindhu to play more at the net, resulting in more errors. The game went neck and neck as both shuttlers traded points to keep the scores level at 15-15.

Sindhu saved two game points at 18-20, with one powerful smash and one error from Li. The game then stretched from 20-20 to 23-23 as Li took the lead but could not convert her advantage. Two errors from Sindhu on either side of the court allowed Li to force a decider, winning the second game 25-23. Leading 12-7 in the final game, Sindhu lost five consecutive points through unforced errors, hitting the net twice and sending the shuttle sideways three times while attempting to deceive Li with her drop. However, she recovered from 15-15 and took four points to make it 19-15, moving to within two points of victory.

But Li employed a smart strategy at this juncture, forcing Sindhu to lift more and come close to the net by blocking her smashes. The ploy worked for the German, who won six points in a row to take the third game 21-19.

Vihaan makes transition from U-19 to Ranji cricket

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, October 13



Vihaan Malhotra scored 103 on his Ranji debut for Punjab. He was part of the team that won the 2026 U-19 World Cup. KAMLESHWAR SINGH

He first stitched together a 137-run partnership with fellow opener Harnoor Singh (54) before he added 58 runs with skipper Uday Saharan

THERE ARE plenty of India Under-19 cricketers who have fallen by the wayside after being unable to establish themselves in the upper tier of cricket. But going by the early signs, Punjab's Vihaan Malhotra won't be one of them. Opening the innings for Punjab, Vihaan, 19, scored a century in his First-Class debut against Assam.

The innings, comprising 11 fours, helped Punjab reach 287 for 5 in reply to Assam's 373. The knock gave Vihaan confidence, which will do him a world of good as he finds his feet in senior cricket.

During the IPL, Vihaan asked RCB mentor and batting coach Dinesh Karthik what he needs to keep in mind to make a smooth transition from juniors to seniors.

Kohli fan

"I was coming into the IPL after the Under-19 World Cup, and one of the major conversations I had with Dinesh Karthik sir was about how to be ready for all three formats and the transition from Under-19 to the senior level. After India's Under-19 World Cup win, my thoughts were on carrying that confidence into my first Ranji Trophy season. A century in my debut match gives a lot of confidence," Vihaan, a Virat Kohli and Shubman Gill fan, told *The Indian Express*.

Punjab were without opener Prabhsimran Singh, who is on India A duty, and Vihaan got his big break. He first stitched together a 137-run partnership with fellow opener Harnoor Singh (54) before he added 58 runs with skipper Uday Saharan.

Vihaan was a member of India's Under-19 team that won the title in February this year. His breakthrough came when he made 277 runs in two Youth Test matches in England last year.

In the Youth ODIs that followed, he made 243 runs in five matches, after which he was selected for the junior World Cup. He made 240 runs, including a hundred against Zimbabwe, and picked up five wickets, including a four-wicket haul against Bangladesh in India's title-winning campaign.

In the Punjab Cricket Association-organised Sher-E-Punjab league, he played for Shubman Gill's Fazilka Falcons. Vihaan scored 256 runs in eight matches at a strike rate of 179.02. His coach Kamal Sandhu said Vihaan has the skills to play in all three formats.

Shots in the 'V'

"Vihaan is a technically sound player. It was just about making some adjustments in his game for the multi-day format at the senior level. Straight after the Sher-E-Punjab league, he was in Patiala to train, and our focus was to make him bat on the centre wicket with side-arm bowlers bowling good-length balls mostly on the fifth and sixth-stump line, with an occasional bouncer every over. We would train with 10-12 new balls as well as semi-new balls. He had to train his mind to leave the balls early in his innings. He has almost all the shots in his book," Sandhu said.

The coach was happy that Vihaan played a lot of shots in the 'V' on Tuesday, but the youngster has also trained for unconventional cricket. "We also worked on his pull and sweep shots against the spinners with the red ball and also his switch hit against spinners," Sandhu said.

Vihaan said minor tweaks during practice were key to succeeding in different formats.

"It's vital that one trains for each format. Post the Sher-e-Punjab league, my aim was to prepare for the multi-day format because my aim was to score big in my breakthrough year," Vihaan said.

Ahead of the match, Punjab head coach Amit Uniyal told Vihaan to make this chance count. "Our talk was about how he can carry the U-19 confidence to the Ranji Trophy and how he is technically sound and just needs to understand the importance of playing the ball late and adjust to the movement of the ball. The key was to watch the ball till late. Vihaan showed that he is capable," Uniyal said.

BRIEF SCORES: Assam 373 vs Punjab 287/5 (Vihaan Malhotra 103, Harnoor Singh 54).



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